

An Old Babylonian Version of the Gilgamesh Epic

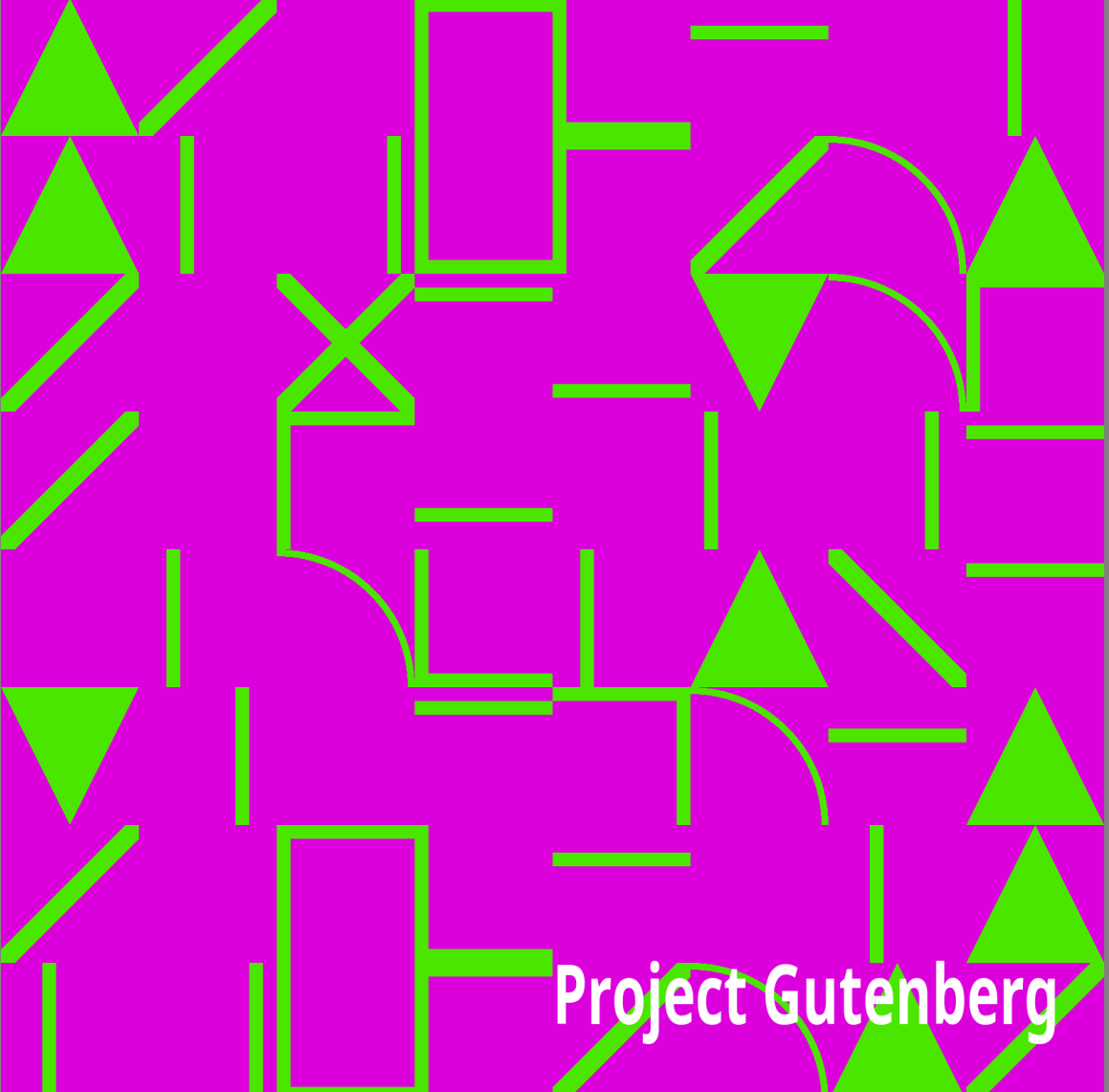
Morris Jastrow and Albert Tobias Clay

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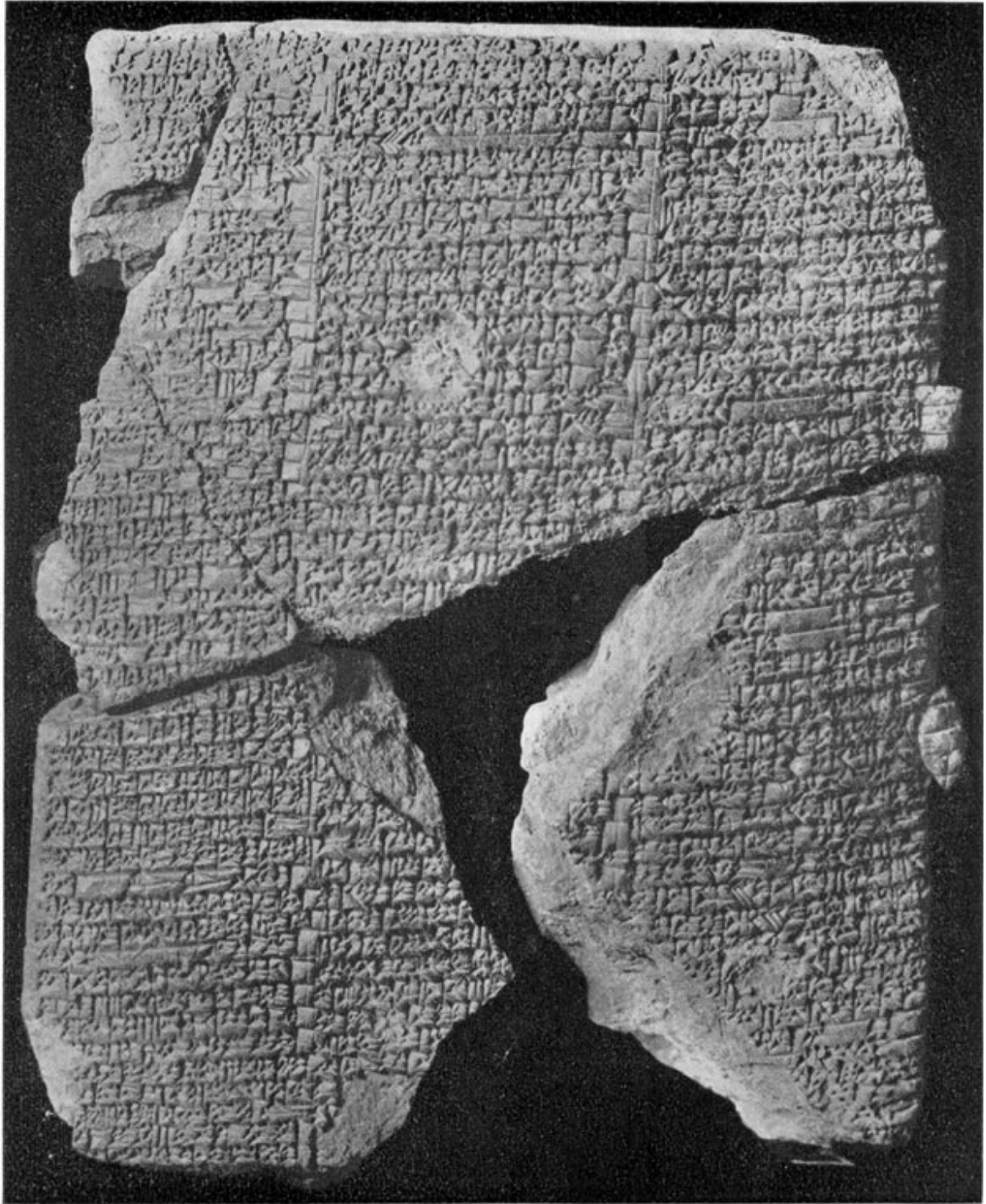
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The Yale Tablet of the Gilgamesh Epic

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**An Old Babylonian Version of the
Gilgamesh Epic**

**On the Basis of Recently Discovered
Texts**

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In Memory of
William Max Müller
(1863–1919)
Whose life was devoted to Egyptological research
which he greatly enriched
by many contributions

Prefatory Note

The Introduction, the Commentary to the two tablets, and the Appendix, are by Professor Jastrow, and for these he assumes the sole responsibility. The text of the Yale tablet is by Professor Clay. The transliteration and the translation of the two tablets represent the joint work of the two authors. In the transliteration of the two tablets, C. E. Keiser's "System of Accentuation for Sumero-Akkadian signs" (Yale Oriental Researches—VOL. IX, Appendix, New Haven, 1919) has been followed.

Introduction.

The Gilgamesh Epic is the most notable literary product of Babylonia as yet discovered in the mounds of Mesopotamia. It recounts the exploits and adventures of a favorite hero, and in its final form covers twelve tablets, each tablet consisting of six columns (three on the obverse and three on the reverse) of about 50 lines for each column, or a total of about 3600 lines. Of this total, however, barely more than one-half has been found among the remains of the great collection of cuneiform tablets gathered by King Ashurbanapal (668–626 B.C.) in his palace at Nineveh, and discovered by Layard in 1854¹ in the course of his excavations of the mound Kouyunjik (opposite Mosul). The fragments of the epic painfully gathered—chiefly by George Smith—from the *circa* 30,000 tablets and bits of tablets brought to the British Museum were published in model form by Professor Paul Haupt;² and that edition still remains the primary source for our study of the Epic.

For the sake of convenience we may call the form of the Epic in the fragments from the library of Ashurbanapal the Assyrian version, though like most of the literary productions in the library it not only reverts to a Babylonian original, but represents a late copy of a much older original. The absence of any reference to Assyria in the fragments recovered justifies us in assuming that the Assyrian version received its present form in Babylonia, perhaps in Erech; though it is of course possible that some of the late features, particularly the elaboration of the teachings of the theologians or schoolmen in the eleventh and twelfth tablets, may have been produced at least in part under Assyrian influence. A definite indication that the Gilgamesh Epic reverts to a period earlier than Hammurabi (or Hammurawi)³ i.e., beyond 2000 B. C., was furnished by the publication of a text clearly belonging to the first Babylonian dynasty (of which Hammurabi was the sixth member) in *CT. VI, 5*; which text Zimmern⁴

recognized as a part of the tale of Atra-ḫasis, one of the names given to the survivor of the deluge, recounted on the eleventh tablet of the Gilgamesh Epic.⁵ This was confirmed by the discovery⁶ of a fragment of the deluge story dated in the eleventh year of Ammisaduka, i.e., c. 1967 B.C. In this text, likewise, the name of the deluge hero appears as Atra-ḫasis (col. VIII, 4).⁷ But while these two tablets do not belong to the Gilgamesh Epic and merely introduce an episode which has also been incorporated into the Epic, Dr. Bruno Meissner in 1902 published a tablet, dating, as the writing and the internal evidence showed, from the Hammurabi period, which undoubtedly is a portion of what by way of distinction we may call an old Babylonian version.⁸ It was picked up by Dr. Meissner at a dealer's shop in Bagdad and acquired for the Berlin Museum. The tablet consists of four columns (two on the obverse and two on the reverse) and deals with the hero's wanderings in search of a cure from disease with which he has been smitten after the death of his companion Enkidu. The hero fears that the disease will be fatal and longs to escape death. It corresponds to a portion of Tablet X of the Assyrian version. Unfortunately, only the lower portion of the obverse and the upper of the reverse have been preserved (57 lines in all); and in default of a colophon we do not know the numeration of the tablet in this old Babylonian edition. Its chief value, apart from its furnishing a proof for the existence of the Epic as early as 2000 B. C., lies (a) in the writing *Gish* instead of Gish-gi(n)-mash in the Assyrian version, for the name of the hero, (b) in the writing En-ki-dū—abbreviated from dūg—(𒂗) “Enki is good” for En-ki-dú (𒂗) in the Assyrian version,⁹ and (c) in the remarkable address of the maiden Sabitum, dwelling at the seaside, to whom Gilgamesh comes in the course of his wanderings. From the Assyrian version we know that the hero tells the maiden of his grief for his lost companion, and of his longing to escape the dire fate of Enkidu. In the old Babylonian fragment the answer of Sabitum is given in full, and the sad note that it strikes, showing how hopeless it is for man to try to escape death which is in store for all mankind, is as remarkable as is the philosophy of “eat, drink and be merry” which Sabitum imparts. The address indicates how early the tendency arose to attach to ancient tales the current religious teachings.

“Why, O Gish, does thou run about?
The life that thou seekest, thou wilt not find.
When the gods created mankind,
Death they imposed on mankind;
Life they kept in their power.
Thou, O Gish, fill thy belly,
Day and night do thou rejoice,
Daily make a rejoicing!
Day and night a renewal of jollification!
Let thy clothes be clean,
Wash thy head and pour water over thee!
Care for the little one who takes hold of thy hand!
Let the wife rejoice in thy bosom!”

Such teachings, reminding us of the leading thought in the Biblical Book of Ecclesiastes,¹⁰ indicate the *didactic* character given to ancient tales that were of popular origin, but which were modified and elaborated under the influence of the schools which arose in connection with the Babylonian temples. The story itself belongs, therefore, to a still earlier period than the form it received in this old Babylonian version. The existence of this tendency at so early a date comes to us as a genuine surprise, and justifies the assumption that the attachment of a lesson to the deluge story in the Assyrian version, to wit, the limitation in attainment of immortality to those singled out by the gods as exceptions, dates likewise from the old Babylonian period. The same would apply to the twelfth tablet, which is almost entirely didactic, intended to illustrate the impossibility of learning anything of the fate of those who have passed out of this world. It also emphasizes the necessity of contenting oneself with the comfort that the care of the dead, by providing burial and food and drink offerings for them affords, as the only means of ensuring for them rest and freedom from the pangs of hunger and distress. However, it is of course possible that the twelfth tablet, which impresses one as a supplement to the adventures of Gilgamesh, ending with his return to Uruk (i.e., Erech) at the close of the eleventh tablet, may represent a *later* elaboration of the tendency to connect religious teachings with the exploits of a favorite hero.

We now have further evidence both of the extreme antiquity of the literary form of the Gilgamesh Epic and also of the disposition to make the Epic the medium of illustrating aspects of life and the destiny of mankind. The discovery by Dr. Arno Poebel of a Sumerian form of the tale of the descent of Ishtar to the lower world and her release¹¹—apparently a nature myth to illustrate the change of season from summer to winter and back again to spring—enables us to pass beyond the Akkadian (or Semitic) form of tales current in the Euphrates Valley to the Sumerian form. Furthermore, we are indebted to Dr. Langdon for the identification of two Sumerian fragments in the Nippur Collection which deal with the adventures of Gilgamesh, one in Constantinople,¹² the other in the collection of the University of Pennsylvania Museum.¹³ The former, of which only 25 lines are preserved (19 on the obverse and 6 on the reverse), appears to be a description of the weapons of Gilgamesh with which he arms himself for an encounter—presumably the encounter with Humbaba or Huwawa, the ruler of the cedar forest in the mountain.¹⁴ The latter deals with the building operations of Gilgamesh in the city of Erech. A text in Zimmern's *Sumerische Kultlieder aus altbabylonischer Zeit* (Leipzig, 1913), No. 196, appears likewise to be a fragment of the Sumerian version of the Gilgamesh Epic, bearing on the episode of Gilgamesh's and Enkidu's relations to the goddess Ishtar, covered in the sixth and seventh tablets of the Assyrian version.¹⁵

Until, however, further fragments shall have turned up, it would be hazardous to institute a comparison between the Sumerian and the Akkadian versions. All that can be said for the present is that there is every reason to believe in the existence of a literary form of the Epic in Sumerian which presumably antedated the Akkadian recension, just as we have a Sumerian form of Ishtar's descent into the nether world, and Sumerian versions of creation myths, as also of the Deluge tale.¹⁶ It does not follow, however, that the Akkadian versions of the Gilgamesh Epic are translations of the Sumerian, any more than that the Akkadian creation myths are translations of a Sumerian original. Indeed, in the case of the creation myths, the striking difference between the Sumerian and Akkadian views of

creation¹⁷ points to the independent production of creation stories on the part of the Semitic settlers of the Euphrates Valley, though no doubt these were worked out in part under Sumerian literary influences. The same is probably true of Deluge tales, which would be given a distinctly Akkadian coloring in being reproduced and steadily elaborated by the Babylonian *literati* attached to the temples. The presumption is, therefore, in favor of an independent *literary* origin for the Semitic versions of the Gilgamesh Epic, though naturally with a duplication of the episodes, or at least of some of them, in the Sumerian narrative. Nor does the existence of a Sumerian form of the Epic necessarily prove that it originated with the Sumerians in their earliest home before they came to the Euphrates Valley. They may have adopted it after their conquest of southern Babylonia from the Semites who, there are now substantial grounds for believing, were the earlier settlers in the Euphrates Valley.¹⁸ We must distinguish, therefore, between the earliest *literary* form, which was undoubtedly Sumerian, and the *origin* of the episodes embodied in the Epic, including the chief actors, Gilgamesh and his companion Enkidu. It will be shown that one of the chief episodes, the encounter of the two heroes with a powerful guardian or ruler of a cedar forest, points to a western region, more specifically to Amurru, as the scene. The names of the two chief actors, moreover, appear to have been “Sumerianized” by an artificial process,¹⁹ and if this view turns out to be correct, we would have a further ground for assuming the tale to have originated among the Akkadian settlers and to have been taken over from them by the Sumerians.

New light on the earliest Babylonian version of the Epic, as well as on the Assyrian version, has been shed by the recovery of two substantial fragments of the form which the Epic had assumed in Babylonia in the Hammurabi period. The study of this important new material also enables us to advance the interpretation of the Epic and to perfect the analysis into its component parts. In the spring of 1914, the Museum of the University of Pennsylvania acquired by purchase a large tablet, the writing of which as well as the style and the manner of spelling verbal forms and substantives pointed distinctly to the time of the first Babylonian dynasty. The tablet was

identified by Dr. Arno Poebel as part of the Gilgamesh Epic; and, as the colophon showed, it formed the second tablet of the series. He copied it with a view to publication, but the outbreak of the war which found him in Germany—his native country—prevented him from carrying out this intention.²⁰ He, however, utilized some of its contents in his discussion of the historical or semi-historical traditions about Gilgamesh, as revealed by the important list of partly mythical and partly historical dynasties, found among the tablets of the Nippur collection, in which Gilgamesh occurs²¹ as a King of an Erech dynasty, whose father was Â, a priest of Kulab.²²

The publication of the tablet was then undertaken by Dr. Stephen Langdon in monograph form under the title, “The Epic of Gilgamish.”²³ In a preliminary article on the tablet in the *Museum Journal*, Vol. VIII, pages 29–38, Dr. Langdon took the tablet to be of the late Persian period (i.e., between the sixth and third century B. C.), but his attention having been called to this error of some *1500 years*, he corrected it in his introduction to his edition of the text, though he neglected to change some of his notes in which he still refers to the text as “late.”²⁴ In addition to a copy of the text, accompanied by a good photograph, Dr. Langdon furnished a transliteration and translation with some notes and a brief introduction. The text is unfortunately badly copied, being full of errors; and the translation is likewise very defective. A careful collation with the original tablet was made with the assistance of Dr. Edward Chiera, and as a consequence we are in a position to offer to scholars a correct text. We beg to acknowledge our obligations to Dr. Gordon, the Director of the Museum of the University of Pennsylvania, for kindly placing the tablet at our disposal. Instead of republishing the text, I content myself with giving a full list of corrections in the appendix to this volume which will enable scholars to control our readings, and which will, I believe, justify the translation in the numerous passages in which it deviates from Dr. Langdon’s rendering. While credit should be given to Dr. Langdon for having made this important tablet accessible, the interests of science demand that attention be called to his failure to grasp the many important data furnished by the tablet, which escaped him because of his erroneous readings and faulty translations.

The tablet, consisting of six columns (three on the obverse and three on the reverse), comprised, according to the colophon, 240 lines²⁵ and formed the second tablet of the series. Of the total, 204 lines are preserved in full or in part, and of the missing thirty-six quite a number can be restored, so that we have a fairly complete tablet. The most serious break occurs at the top of the reverse, where about eight lines are missing. In consequence of this the connection between the end of the obverse (where about five lines are missing) and the beginning of the reverse is obscured, though not to the extent of our entirely losing the thread of the narrative.

About the same time that the University of Pennsylvania Museum purchased this second tablet of the Gilgamesh Series, Yale University obtained a tablet from the same dealer, which turned out to be a continuation of the University of Pennsylvania tablet. That the two belong to the same edition of the Epic is shown by their agreement in the dark brown color of the clay, in the writing as well as in the size of the tablet, though the characters on the Yale tablet are somewhat cramped and in consequence more difficult to read. Both tablets consist of six columns, three on the obverse and three on the reverse. The measurements of both are about the same, the Pennsylvania tablet being estimated at about 7 inches high, as against 7²/₁₆ inches for the Yale tablet, while the width of both is 6¹/₂ inches. The Yale tablet is, however, more closely written and therefore has a larger number of lines than the Pennsylvania tablet. The colophon to the Yale tablet is unfortunately missing, but from internal evidence it is quite certain that the Yale tablet follows immediately upon the Pennsylvania tablet and, therefore, may be set down as the third of the series. The obverse is very badly preserved, so that only a general view of its contents can be secured. The reverse contains serious gaps in the first and second columns. The scribe evidently had a copy before him which he tried to follow exactly, but finding that he could not get all of the copy before him in the six columns, he continued the last column on the edge. In this way we obtain for the sixth column 64 lines as against 45 for column IV, and 47 for column V, and a total of 292 lines for the six columns. Subtracting the 16 lines written on the edge leaves us 276 lines for our tablet as against 240 for its companion. The width of each column being the same on both tablets, the difference of 36 lines is made up by the closer writing.

Both tablets have peculiar knobs at the sides, the purpose of which is evidently not to facilitate holding the tablet in one's hand while writing or reading it, as Langdon assumed²⁶ (it would be quite impracticable for this purpose), but simply to protect the tablet in its position on a shelf, where it would naturally be placed on the edge, just as we arrange books on a shelf. Finally be it noted that these two tablets of the old Babylonian version do not belong to the same edition as the Meissner tablet above described, for the latter consists of two columns each on obverse and reverse, as against three columns each in the case of our two tablets. We thus have the interesting proof that as early as 2000 B.C. there were already several editions of the Epic. As to the provenance of our two tablets, there are no definite data, but it is likely that they were found by natives in the mounds at Warka, from which about the year 1913, many tablets came into the hands of dealers. It is likely that where two tablets of a series were found, others of the series were also dug up, and we may expect to find some further portions of this old Babylonian version turning up in the hands of other dealers or in museums.

Coming to the contents of the two tablets, the Pennsylvania tablet deals with the meeting of the two heroes, Gilgamesh and Enkidu, their conflict, followed by their reconciliation, while the Yale tablet in continuation takes up the preparations for the encounter of the two heroes with the guardian of the cedar forest, Humbaba—but probably pronounced Hubaba²⁷—or, as the name appears in the old Babylonian version, Huwawa. The two tablets correspond, therefore, to portions of Tablets I to V of the Assyrian version;²⁸ but, as will be shown in detail further on, the number of *completely* parallel passages is not large, and the Assyrian version shows an independence of the old Babylonian version that is larger than we had reason to expect. In general, it may be said that the Assyrian version is more elaborate, which points to its having received its present form at a considerably later period than the old Babylonian version.²⁹ On the other hand, we already find in the Babylonian version the tendency towards repetition, which is characteristic of Babylonian-Assyrian tales in general. Through the two Babylonian tablets we are enabled to fill out certain details

of the two episodes with which they deal: (1) the meeting of Gilgamesh and Enkidu, and (2) the encounter with Hūwawa; while their greatest value consists in the light that they throw on the gradual growth of the Epic until it reached its definite form in the text represented by the fragments in Ashurbanapal's Library. Let us now take up the detailed analysis, first of the Pennsylvania tablet and then of the Yale tablet. The Pennsylvania tablet begins with two dreams recounted by Gilgamesh to his mother, which the latter interprets as presaging the coming of Enkidu to Erech. In the one, something like a heavy meteor falls from heaven upon Gilgamesh and almost crushes him. With the help of the heroes of Erech, Gilgamesh carries the heavy burden to his mother Ninsun. The burden, his mother explains, symbolizes some one who, like Gilgamesh, is born in the mountains, to whom all will pay homage and of whom Gilgamesh will become enamoured with a love as strong as that for a woman. In a second dream, Gilgamesh sees some one who is like him, who brandishes an axe, and with whom he falls in love. This personage, the mother explains, is again Enkidu.

Langdon is of the opinion that these dreams are recounted to Enkidu by a woman with whom Enkidu cohabits for six days and seven nights and who weans Enkidu from association with animals. This, however, cannot be correct. The scene between Enkidu and the woman must have been recounted in detail in the first tablet, as in the Assyrian version,³⁰ whereas here in the second tablet we have the continuation of the tale with Gilgamesh recounting his dreams directly to his mother. The story then continues with the description of the coming of Enkidu, conducted by the woman to the outskirts of Erech, where food is given him. The main feature of the incident is the conversion of Enkidu to civilized life. Enkidu, who hitherto had gone about naked, is clothed by the woman. Instead of sucking milk and drinking from a trough like an animal, food and strong drink are placed before him, and he is taught how to eat and drink in human fashion. In human fashion he also becomes drunk, and his "spree" is naïvely described: "His heart became glad and his face shone."³¹ Like an animal, Enkidu's body had hitherto been covered with hair, which is now shaved off. He is anointed with oil, and clothed "like a man." Enkidu becomes a shepherd, protecting the fold against wild beasts, and his exploit in

dispatching lions is briefly told. At this point—the end of column 3 (on the obverse), i.e., line 117, and the beginning of column 4 (on the reverse), i.e., line 131—a gap of 13 lines—the tablet is obscure, but apparently the story of Enkidu's gradual transformation from savagery to civilized life is continued, with stress upon his introduction to domestic ways with the wife chosen or decreed for him, and with work as part of his fate. All this has no connection with Gilgamesh, and it is evident that the tale of Enkidu was originally an *independent* tale to illustrate the evolution of man's career and destiny, how through intercourse with a woman he awakens to the sense of human dignity, how he becomes accustomed to the ways of civilization, how he passes through the pastoral stage to higher walks of life, how the family is instituted, and how men come to be engaged in the labors associated with human activities. In order to connect this tale with the Gilgamesh story, the two heroes are brought together; the woman taking on herself, in addition to the rôle of civilizer, that of the medium through which Enkidu is brought to Gilgamesh. The woman leads Enkidu from the outskirts of Erech into the city itself, where the people on seeing him remark upon his likeness to Gilgamesh. He is the very counterpart of the latter, though somewhat smaller in stature. There follows the encounter between the two heroes in the streets of Erech, where they engage in a fierce combat. Gilgamesh is overcome by Enkidu and is enraged at being thrown to the ground. The tablet closes with the endeavor of Enkidu to pacify Gilgamesh. Enkidu declares that the mother of Gilgamesh has exalted her son above the ordinary mortal, and that Enlil himself has singled him out for royal prerogatives.

After this, we may assume, the two heroes become friends and together proceed to carry out certain exploits, the first of which is an attack upon the mighty guardian of the cedar forest. This is the main episode in the Yale tablet, which, therefore, forms the third tablet of the old Babylonian version.

In the first column of the obverse of the Yale tablet, which is badly preserved, it would appear that the elders of Erech (or perhaps the people) are endeavoring to dissuade Gilgamesh from making the attempt to penetrate to the abode of *Huwawa*. If this is correct, then the close of the

first column may represent a conversation between these elders and the woman who accompanies Enkidu. It would be the elders who are represented as “reporting the speech to the woman,” which is presumably the determination of Gilgamesh to fight Hūwawa. The elders apparently desire Enkidu to accompany Gilgamesh in this perilous adventure, and with this in view appeal to the woman. In the second column after an obscure reference to the mother of Gilgamesh—perhaps appealing to the sun-god—we find Gilgamesh and Enkidu again face to face. From the reference to Enkidu’s eyes “filled with tears,” we may conclude that he is moved to pity at the thought of what will happen to Gilgamesh if he insists upon carrying out his purpose. Enkidu, also, tries to dissuade Gilgamesh. This appears to be the main purport of the dialogue between the two, which begins about the middle of the second column and extends to the end of the third column. Enkidu pleads that even his strength is insufficient,

“My arms are lame,
My strength has become weak.” (lines 88–89)

Gilgamesh apparently asks for a description of the terrible tyrant who thus arouses the fear of Enkidu, and in reply Enkidu tells him how at one time, when he was roaming about with the cattle, he penetrated into the forest and heard the roar of Hūwawa which was like that of a deluge. The mouth of the tyrant emitted fire, and his breath was death. It is clear, as Professor Haupt has suggested,³² that Enkidu furnishes the description of a volcano in eruption, with its mighty roar, spitting forth fire and belching out a suffocating smoke. Gilgamesh is, however, undaunted and urges Enkidu to accompany him in the adventure.

“I will go down to the forest,” says Gilgamesh, if the conjectural restoration of the line in question (l. 126) is correct. Enkidu replies by again drawing a lurid picture of what will happen “When we go (together) to the forest.....” This speech of Enkidu is continued on the reverse. In reply Gilgamesh emphasizes his reliance upon the good will of Shamash and reproaches Enkidu with cowardice. He declares himself superior to Enkidu’s warning, and in bold terms says that he prefers to perish in the attempt to overcome Hūwawa rather than abandon it.

“Wherever terror is to be faced,
Thou, forsooth, art in fear of death.
Thy prowess lacks strength.
I will go before thee,
Though thy mouth shouts to me: ‘thou art afraid to
approach,’
If I fall, I will establish my name.” (lines 143–148)

There follows an interesting description of the forging of the weapons for the two heroes in preparation for the encounter.³³ The elders of Erech when they see these preparations are stricken with fear. They learn of *Huwawa*’s threat to annihilate Gilgamesh if he dares to enter the cedar forest, and once more try to dissuade Gilgamesh from the undertaking.

“Thou art young, O Gish, and thy heart carries thee
away,
Thou dost not know what thou proposest to do.” (lines
190–191)

They try to frighten Gilgamesh by repeating the description of the terrible *Huwawa*. Gilgamesh is still undaunted and prays to his patron deity Shamash, who apparently accords him a favorable “oracle” (*têtu*). The two heroes arm themselves for the fray, and the elders of Erech, now reconciled to the perilous undertaking, counsel Gilgamesh to take provision along for the undertaking. They urge Gilgamesh to allow Enkidu to take the lead, for

“He is acquainted with the way, he has trodden the
road
[to] the entrance of the forest.” (lines 252–253)

The elders dismiss Gilgamesh with fervent wishes that Enkidu may track out the “closed path” for Gilgamesh, and commit him to the care of Lugalbanda—here perhaps an epithet of Shamash. They advise Gilgamesh to perform certain rites, to wash his feet in the stream of *Huwawa* and to pour out a libation of water to Shamash. Enkidu follows in a speech likewise intended to encourage the hero; and with the actual beginning of

the expedition against Ḫuwawa the tablet ends. The encounter itself, with the triumph of the two heroes, must have been described in the fourth tablet.

Now before taking up the significance of the additions to our knowledge of the Epic gained through these two tablets, it will be well to discuss the forms in which the names of the two heroes and of the ruler of the cedar forest occur in our tablets.

As in the Meissner fragment, the chief hero is invariably designated as ^dGish in both the Pennsylvania and Yale tablets; and we may therefore conclude that this was the common form in the Hammurabi period, as against the writing ^dGish-gì(n)-mash³⁴ in the Assyrian version. Similarly, as in the Meissner fragment, the second hero's name is always written En-ki-dū³⁵ (abbreviated from dúg) as against En-ki-dú in the Assyrian version. Finally, we encounter in the Yale tablet for the first time the writing Ḫu-wa-wa as the name of the guardian of the cedar forest, as against Ḫum-ba-ba in the Assyrian version, though in the latter case, as we may now conclude from the Yale tablet, the name should rather be read Ḫu-ba-ba.³⁶ The variation in the writing of the latter name is interesting as pointing to the aspirate pronunciation of the labial in both instances. The name would thus present a complete parallel to the Hebrew name Ḫowawa (or Ḫobab) who appears as the brother-in-law of Moses in the P document, Numbers 10, 29.³⁷ Since the name also occurs, written precisely as in the Yale tablet, among the "Amoritic" names in the important lists published by Dr. Chiera,³⁸ there can be no doubt that Ḫuwawa or Ḫubaba is a West Semitic name. This important fact adds to the probability that the "cedar forest" in which Ḫuwawa dwells is none other than the Lebanon district, famed since early antiquity for its cedars. This explanation of the name Ḫuwawa disposes of suppositions hitherto brought forward for an Elamitic origin. Gressmann³⁹ still favors such an origin, though realizing that the description of the cedar forest points to the Amanus or Lebanon range. In further confirmation of the West Semitic origin of the name, we have in Lucian, *De Dea Syria*, § 19, the name Kombabos⁴⁰ (the guardian of

Stratonika), which forms a perfect parallel to ̒u(m)baba. Of the important bearings of this western character of the name ̒uwawa on the interpretation and origin of the Gilgamesh Epic, suggesting that the episode of the encounter between the tyrant and the two heroes rests upon a tradition of an expedition against the West or Amurru land, we shall have more to say further on.

The variation in the writing of the name Enkidu is likewise interesting. It is evident that the form in the old Babylonian version with the sign dũ (i.e., dúg) is the original, for it furnishes us with a suitable etymology “Enki is good.” The writing with dúg, pronounced dũ, also shows that the sign dú as the third element in the form which the name has in the Assyrian version is to be read dú, and that former readings like Ea-bani must be definitely abandoned.⁴¹ The form with dú is clearly a *phonetic* writing of the Sumerian name, the sign dú being chosen to indicate the *pronunciation* (not the ideograph) of the third element dúg. This is confirmed by the writing En-gi-dú in the syllabary CT XVIII, 30, 10. The phonetic writing is, therefore, a warning against any endeavor to read the name by an Akkadian transliteration of the signs. This would not of itself prove that Enkidu is of Sumerian *origin*, for it might well be that the writing En-ki-dú is an endeavor to give a Sumerian *aspect* to a name that *may* have been foreign. The element dúg corresponds to the Semitic *ṭābu*, “good,” and En-ki being originally a designation of a deity as the “lord of the land,” which would be the Sumerian manner of indicating a Semitic Baal, it is not at all impossible that En-ki-dúg may be the “Sumerianized” form of a Semitic בַּעַל טוֹב “Baal is good.” It will be recalled that in the third column of the Yale tablet, Enkidu speaks of himself in his earlier period while still living with cattle, as wandering into the cedar forest of ̒uwawa, while in another passage (ll. 252–253) he is described as “acquainted with the way ... to the entrance of the forest.” This would clearly point to the West as the original home of Enkidu. We are thus led once more to Amurru—taken as a general designation of the West—as playing an important role in the Gilgamesh Epic.⁴² If Gilgamesh’s expedition against ̒uwawa of the Lebanon district recalls a Babylonian campaign against Amurru, Enkidu’s coming from his home, where, as we read repeatedly in the Assyrian version,

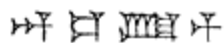
“He ate herbs with the gazelles,
Drank out of a trough with cattle,”⁴³

may rest on a tradition of an Amorite invasion of Babylonia. The fight between Gilgamesh and Enkidu would fit in with this tradition, while the subsequent reconciliation would be the form in which the tradition would represent the enforced union between the invaders and the older settlers.

Leaving this aside for the present, let us proceed to a consideration of the relationship of the form ^dGish, for the chief personage in the Epic in the old Babylonian version, to ^dGish-gi(n)-mash in the Assyrian version. Of the meaning of Gish there is fortunately no doubt. It is clearly the equivalent to the Akkadian *zikaru*, “man” (Brünnow No. 5707), or possibly *rabû*, “great” (Brünnow No. 5704). Among various equivalents, the preference is to be given to *itlu*, “hero.” The determinative for deity stamps the person so designated as deified, or as in part divine, and this is in accord with the express statement in the Assyrian version of the Gilgamesh Epic which describes the hero as

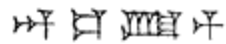
“Two-thirds god and one-third human.”⁴⁴

Gish is, therefore, the hero-god *par excellence*; and this shows that we are not dealing with a genuine proper name, but rather with a descriptive attribute. Proper names are not formed in this way, either in Sumerian or Akkadian. Now what relation does this form Gish bear to



as the name of the hero is invariably written in the Assyrian version, the form which was at first read ^dIz-tu-bar or ^dGish-du-bar by scholars, until Pinches found in a neo-Babylonian syllabary⁴⁵ the equation of it with Gi-il-ga-mesh? Pinches' discovery pointed conclusively to the popular pronunciation of the hero's name as Gilgamesh; and since Aelian (*De natura Animalium* XII, 2) mentions a Babylonian personage Gilgamos (though what he tells us of Gilgamos does not appear in our Epic, but seems to apply to Etana, another figure of Babylonian mythology), there seemed

to be no further reason to question that the problem had been solved. Besides, in a later Syriac list of Babylonian kings found in the Scholia of Theodor bar Koni, the name גלמגום with a variant גמיגמוס occurs,⁴⁶ and it is evident that we have here again the Gi-il-ga-mesh, discovered by Pinches. The existence of an old Babylonian hero Gilgamesh who was likewise a king is thus established, as well as his identification with



It is evident that we cannot read this name as Iz-tu-bar or Gish-du-bar, but that we must read the first sign as Gish and the third as Mash, while for the second we must assume a reading Gìn or Gi. This would give us Gish-gì(n)-mash which is clearly again (like En-ki-dú) not an etymological writing but a *phonetic* one, intended to convey an *approach* to the popular pronunciation. Gi-il-ga-mesh might well be merely a variant for Gish-ga-mesh, or *vice versa*, and this would come close to Gish-gi-mash. Now, when we have a name the pronunciation of which is not definite but approximate, and which is written in various ways, the probabilities are that the name is foreign. A foreign name might naturally be spelled in various ways. The Epic in the Assyrian version clearly depicts ^dGish-gì(n)-mash as a conqueror of Erech, who forces the people into subjection, and whose autocratic rule leads the people of Erech to implore the goddess Aruru to create a rival to him who may withstand him. In response to this appeal ^dEnkidu is formed out of dust by Aruru and eventually brought to Erech.⁴⁷ Gish-gì(n)-mash or Gilgamesh is therefore in all probability a foreigner; and the simplest solution suggested by the existence of the two forms (1) Gish in the old Babylonian version and (2) Gish-gì(n)-mash in the Assyrian version, is to regard the former as an abbreviation, which seemed appropriate, because the short name conveyed the idea of the “hero” *par excellence*. If Gish-gì(n)-mash is a foreign name, one would think in the first instance of Sumerian; but here we encounter a difficulty in the circumstance that outside of the Epic this conqueror and ruler of Erech appears in quite a different form, namely, as ^dGish-bil-ga-mesh, with ^dGish-gibil(or bìl)-ga-mesh and ^dGish-bil-ge-mesh as variants.⁴⁸ In the remarkable list of partly mythological and partly historical dynasties, published by

Poebel,⁴⁹ the fifth member of the first dynasty of Erech appears as ^dGish-bil-ga-mesh; and similarly in an inscription of the days of Sin-gamil, ^dGish-bil-ga-mesh is mentioned as the builder of the wall of Erech.⁵⁰ Moreover, in the several fragments of the Sumerian version of the Epic we have invariably the form ^dGish-bil-ga-mesh. It is evident, therefore, that this is the genuine form of the name in Sumerian and presumably, therefore, the oldest form. By way of further confirmation we have in the syllabary above referred to, CT, XVIII, 30, 6–8, three designations of our hero, viz:

- ^dGish-gibil(or bīl)-ga-mesh
- *muk-tab-lu* (“warrior”)
- *a-lik pa-na* (“leader”)

All three designations are set down as the equivalent of the Sumerian Esigga imin i.e., “the seven-fold hero.”

Of the same general character is the equation in another syllabary:⁵¹

Esigga-tuk and its equivalent Gish-tuk = “the one who is a hero.”

Furthermore, the name occurs frequently in “Temple” documents of the Ur dynasty in the form ^dGish-bil-ga-mesh⁵² with ^dGish-bil-gi(n)-mesh as a variant.⁵³ In a list of deities (*CT* XXV, 28, K 7659) we likewise encounter ^dGish-gibil(or bīl)-ga-mesh, and lastly in a syllabary we have the equation⁵⁴

^dGish-gi-mas-[si?] = ^dGish-bil-[ga-mesh].

The variant Gish-gibil for Gish-bil may be disposed of readily, in view of the frequent confusion or interchange of the two signs Bil (Brünnow No. 4566) and Gibil or Bīl (Brünnow No. 4642) which has also the value Gi (Brünnow 4641), so that we might also read Gish-gi-ga-mesh. Both signs convey the idea of “fire,” “renew,” etc.; both revert to the picture of flames of fire, in the one case with a bowl (or some such object) above it, in the other the flames issuing apparently from a torch.⁵⁵ The meaning of the name is not affected whether we read ^dGish-bil-ga-mesh or ^dGish-gibil(or

bíl)-ga-mesh, for the middle element in the latter case being identical with the fire-god, written ^dBil-gi and to be pronounced in the inverted form as Gibil with -ga (or ge) as the phonetic complement; it is equivalent, therefore, to the writing bil-ga in the former case. Now Gish-gibil or Gish-bíl conveys the idea of *abu*, “father” (Brünnow No. 5713), just as Bil (Brünnow No. 4579) has this meaning, while Pa-gibil-(ga) or Pa-bíl-ga is *abu abi*, “grandfather.”⁵⁶ This meaning may be derived from Gibil, as also from Bíl = *išatu*, “fire,” then *eššu*, “new,” then *abu*, “father,” as the renewer or creator. Gish with Bíl or Gibil would, therefore, be “the father-man” or “the father-hero,” i.e., again the hero *par excellence*, the original hero, just as in Hebrew and Arabic *ab* is used in this way.⁵⁷ The syllable *ga* being a phonetic complement, the element *mesh* is to be taken by itself and to be explained, as Poebel suggested, as “hero” (*itlu*. Brünnow No. 5967).

We would thus obtain an entirely artificial combination, “man (or hero), father, hero,” which would simply convey in an emphatic manner the idea of the *Ur-held*, the original hero, the father of heroes as it were—practically the same idea, therefore, as the one conveyed by Gish alone, as the hero *par excellence*. Our investigation thus leads us to a substantial identity between Gish and the longer form Gish-bil(or bíl)-ga-mesh, and the former might, therefore, well be used as an abbreviation of the latter. Both the shorter and the longer forms are *descriptive epithets* based on naive folk etymology, rather than personal names, just as in the designation of our hero as *muḫtablu*, the “fighter,” or as *âlik pâna*, “the leader,” or as *Esigga imin*, “the seven-fold hero,” or *Esigga tuk*, “the one who is a hero,” are descriptive epithets, and as Atra-ḫasis, “the very wise one,” is such an epithet for the hero of the deluge story. The case is different with Gi-il-ga-mesh, or Gish-gì(n)-mash, which represent the popular and actual pronunciation of the name, or at least the *approach* to such pronunciation. Such forms, stripped as they are of all artificiality, impress one as genuine names. The conclusion to which we are thus led is that Gish-bil(or bíl)-ga-mesh is a play upon the genuine name, to convey to those to whom the real name, as that of a foreigner, would suggest no meaning an interpretation *fitting in with his character*. In other words, Gish-bil-ga-mesh is a “Sumerianized” form of the name, introduced into the Sumerian version of the tale which became a

folk-possession in the Euphrates Valley. Such plays upon names to suggest the character of an individual or some incident are familiar to us from the narratives in Genesis.⁵⁸ They do not constitute genuine etymologies and are rarely of use in leading to a correct etymology. Reuben, e.g., certainly does not mean “Yahweh has seen my affliction,” which the mother is supposed to have exclaimed at the birth (Genesis 29, 32), with a play upon *ben* and *be’onyi*, any more than Judah means “I praise Yahweh” (v. 35), though it does contain the divine name (*Y^ehō*) as an element. The play on the name may be close or remote, as long as it fulfills its function of *suggesting* an etymology that is complimentary or appropriate.

In this way, an artificial division and at the same time a distortion of a foreign name like Gilgamesh into several elements, Gish-bil-ga-mesh, is no more violent than, for example, the explanation of Issachar or rather Issaschar as “God has given my hire” (Genesis 30, 18) with a play upon the element *s^echar*, and as though the name were to be divided into *Yah* (“God”) and *s^echar* (“hire”); or the popular name of Alexander among the Arabs as *Zu’l Karnaini*, “the possessor of the two horns.” with a suggestion of his conquest of two hemispheres, or what not.⁵⁹ The element Gil in Gilgamesh would be regarded as a contraction of Gish-bil or gi-bil, in order to furnish the meaning “father-hero,” or Gil might be looked upon as a variant for Gish, which would give us the “phonetic” form in the Assyrian version ^dGish-gi-mash,⁶⁰ as well as such a variant writing ^dGish-gi-mas-(si). Now a name like Gilgamesh, upon which we may definitely settle as coming closest to the genuine form, certainly impresses one as foreign, i.e., it is neither Sumerian nor Akkadian; and we have already suggested that the circumstance that the hero of the Epic is portrayed as a conqueror of Erech, and a rather ruthless one at that, points to a tradition of an invasion of the Euphrates Valley as the background for the episode in the first tablet of the series. Now it is significant that many of the names in the “mythical” dynasties, as they appear in Poebel’s list,⁶¹ are likewise foreign, such as Mes-ki-in-ga-še-ir, son of the god Shamash (and the founder of the “mythical” dynasty of Erech of which ^dGish-bil-ga-mesh is the fifth member),⁶² and En-me-ir-kár his son. In a still earlier “mythical” dynasty, we encounter names like Ga-lu-mu-um, Zu-ga-gi-ib, Ar-pi, E-ta-na,⁶³ which

are distinctly foreign, while such names as En-me(n)-nun-na and Bar-sal-nun-na strike one again as “Sumerianized” names rather than as genuine Sumerian formations.⁶⁴

Some of these names, as Galumum, Arpi and Etana, are so Amoritic in appearance, that one may hazard the conjecture of their western origin. May Gilgamesh likewise belong to the Amurru⁶⁵ region, or does he represent a foreigner from the East in contrast to Enkidu, whose name, we have seen, may have been Baal-Ṭôb in the West, with which region he is according to the Epic so familiar? It must be confessed that the second element *ga-mesh* would fit in well with a Semitic origin for the name, for the element impresses one as the participial form of a Semitic stem g-m-š, just as in the second element of Meskin-gašer we have such a form. Gil might then be the name of a West-Semitic deity. Such conjectures, however, can for the present not be substantiated, and we must content ourselves with the conclusion that Gilgamesh as the real name of the hero, or at least the form which comes closest to the real name, points to a foreign origin for the hero, and that such forms as ^dGish-bil-ga-mesh and ^dGish-bíl-gi-mesh and other variants are “Sumerianized” forms for which an artificial etymology was brought forward to convey the idea of the “original hero” or the hero *par excellence*. By means of this “play” on the name, which reverts to the compilers of the Sumerian version of the Epic, Gilgamesh was converted into a Sumerian figure, just as the name Enkidu may have been introduced as a Sumerian translation of his Amoritic name. ^dGish at all events is an abbreviated form of the “Sumerianized” name, introduced by the compilers of the earliest Akkadian version, which was produced naturally under the influence of the Sumerian version. Later, as the Epic continued to grow, a phonetic writing was introduced, ^dGish-gi-mash, which is in a measure a compromise between the genuine name and the “Sumerianized” form, but at the same time an *approach* to the real pronunciation.

Next to the new light thrown upon the names and original character of the two main figures of the Epic, one of the chief points of interest in the Pennsylvania fragment is the proof that it furnishes for a striking

resemblance of the two heroes, Gish and Enkidu, to one another. In interpreting the dream of Gish, his mother, Ninsun, lays stress upon the fact that the dream portends the coming of someone who is like Gish, “born in the field and reared in the mountain” (lines 18–19). Both, therefore, are shown by this description to have come to Babylonia from a mountainous region, i.e., they are foreigners; and in the case of Enkidu we have seen that the mountain in all probability refers to a region in the West, while the same may also be the case with Gish. The resemblance of the two heroes to one another extends to their personal appearance. When Enkidu appears on the streets of Erech, the people are struck by this resemblance. They remark that he is “like Gish,” though “shorter in stature” (lines 179–180). Enkidu is described as a rival or counterpart.⁶⁶

This relationship between the two is suggested also by the Assyrian version. In the creation of Enkidu by Aruru, the people urge the goddess to create the “counterpart” (*zikru*) of Gilgamesh, someone who will be like him (*ma-ši-il*) (Tablet I, 2, 31). Enkidu not only comes from the mountain,⁶⁷ but the mountain is specifically designated as his birth-place (I, 4, 2), precisely as in the Pennsylvania tablet, while in another passage he is also described, as in our tablet, as “born in the field.”⁶⁸ Still more significant is the designation of Gilgamesh as the *talimu*, “younger brother,” of Enkidu.⁶⁹ In accord with this, we find Gilgamesh in his lament over Enkidu describing him as a “younger brother” (*ku-ta-ni*);⁷⁰ and again in the last tablet of the Epic, Gilgamesh is referred to as the “brother” of Enkidu.⁷¹ This close relationship reverts to the Sumerian version, for the Constantinople fragment (Langdon, above, p. 13) begins with the designation of Gish-bil-ga-mesh as “his brother.” By “his” no doubt Enkidu is meant. Likewise in the Sumerian text published by Zimmern (above, p. 13) Gilgamesh appears as the brother of Enkidu (rev. 1, 17).

Turning to the numerous representations of Gilgamesh and Enkidu on Seal Cylinders,⁷² we find this resemblance of the two heroes to each other strikingly confirmed. Both are represented as bearded, with the strands arranged in the same fashion. The face in both cases is broad, with curls protruding at the side of the head, though at times these curls are lacking in

the case of Enkidu. What is particularly striking is to find Gilgamesh generally *a little taller* than Enkidu, thus bearing out the statement in the Pennsylvania tablet that Enkidu is “shorter in stature.” There are, to be sure, also some distinguishing marks between the two. Thus Enkidu is generally represented with animal hoofs, but not always.⁷³ Enkidu is commonly portrayed with the horns of a bison, but again this sign is wanting in quite a number of instances.⁷⁴ The hoofs and the horns mark the period when Enkidu lived with animals and much like an animal. Most remarkable, however, of all are cylinders on which we find the two heroes almost exactly alike as, for example, Ward No. 199 where two figures, the one a duplicate of the other (except that one is just a shade taller), are in conflict with each other. Dr. Ward was puzzled by this representation and sets it down as a “fantastic” scene in which “each Gilgamesh is stabbing the other.” In the light of the Pennsylvania tablet, this scene is clearly the conflict between the two heroes described in column 6, preliminary to their forming a friendship. Even in the realm of myth the human experience holds good that there is nothing like a good fight as a basis for a subsequent alliance. The fragment describes this conflict as a furious one in which Gilgamesh is worsted, and his wounded pride assuaged by the generous victor, who comforts his vanquished enemy by the assurance that he was destined for something higher than to be a mere “Hercules.” He was singled out for the exercise of royal authority. True to the description of the two heroes in the Pennsylvania tablet as alike, one the counterpart of the other, the seal cylinder portrays them almost exactly alike, as alike as two brothers could possibly be; with just enough distinction to make it clear on close inspection that two figures are intended and not one repeated for the sake of symmetry. There are slight variations in the manner in which the hair is worn, and slightly varying expressions of the face, just enough to make it evident that the one is intended for Gilgamesh and the other for Enkidu. When, therefore, in another specimen, No. 173, we find a Gilgamesh holding his counterpart by the legs, it is merely another aspect of the fight between the two heroes, one of whom is intended to represent Enkidu, and not, as Dr. Ward supposed, a grotesque repetition of Gilgamesh.⁷⁵

The description of Enkidu in the Pennsylvania tablet as a parallel figure to Gilgamesh leads us to a consideration of the relationship of the two figures to one another. Many years ago it was pointed out that the Gilgamesh Epic was a composite tale in which various stories of an independent origin had been combined and brought into more or less artificial connection with the *heros eponymos* of southern Babylonia.⁷⁶ We may now go a step further and point out that not only is Enkidu originally an entirely independent figure, having no connection with Gish or Gilgamesh, but that the latter is really depicted in the Epic as the counterpart of Enkidu, a reflection who has been given the traits of extraordinary physical power that belong to Enkidu. This is shown in the first place by the fact that in the encounter it is Enkidu who triumphs over Gilgamesh. The entire analysis of the episode of the meeting between the two heroes as given by Gressmann⁷⁷ must be revised. It is not Enkidu who is terrified and who is warned against the encounter. It is Gilgamesh who, during the night on his way from the house in which the goddess Ishhara lies, encounters Enkidu on the highway. Enkidu “blocks the path”⁷⁸ of Gilgamesh. He prevents Gilgamesh from re-entering the house,⁷⁹ and the two attack each other “like oxen.”⁸⁰ They grapple with each other, and Enkidu forces Gilgamesh to the ground. Enkidu is, therefore, the real hero whose traits of physical prowess are afterwards transferred to Gilgamesh.

Similarly in the next episode, the struggle against Huwawa, the Yale tablet makes it clear that in the original form of the tale Enkidu is the real hero. All warn Gish against the undertaking—the elders of Erech, Enkidu, and also the workmen. “Why dost thou desire to do this?”⁸¹ they say to him. “Thou art young, and thy heart carries thee away. Thou knowest not what thou proposest to do.”⁸² This part of the incident is now better known to us through the latest fragment of the Assyrian version discovered and published by King.⁸³ The elders say to Gilgamesh:

“Do not trust, O Gilgamesh, in thy strength!
Be warned(?) against trusting to thy attack!
The one who goes before will save his companion,⁸⁴
He who has foresight will save his friend.⁸⁵

Let Enkidu go before thee.
He knows the roads to the cedar forest;
He is skilled in battle and has seen fight.”

Gilgamesh is sufficiently impressed by this warning to invite Enkidu to accompany him on a visit to his mother, Ninsun, for the purpose of receiving her counsel.⁸⁶

It is only after Enkidu, who himself hesitates and tries to dissuade Gish, decides to accompany the latter that the elders of Erech are reconciled and encourage Gish for the fray. The two in concert proceed against H̄uwawa. Gilgamesh alone cannot carry out the plan. Now when a tale thus associates two figures in one deed, one of the two has been added to the original tale. In the present case there can be little doubt that Enkidu, without whom Gish cannot proceed, who is specifically described as “acquainted with the way ... to the entrance of the forest”⁸⁷ in which H̄uwawa dwells is the *original* vanquisher. Naturally, the Epic aims to conceal this fact as much as possible *ad maiorem gloriam* of Gilgamesh. It tries to put the one who became the favorite hero into the foreground. Therefore, in both the Babylonian and the Assyrian version Enkidu is represented as hesitating, and Gilgamesh as determined to go ahead. Gilgamesh, in fact, accuses Enkidu of cowardice and boldly declares that he will proceed even though failure stare him in the face.⁸⁸ Traces of the older view, however, in which Gilgamesh is the one for whom one fears the outcome, crop out; as, for example, in the complaint of Gilgamesh’s mother to Shamash that the latter has stirred the heart of her son to take the distant way to H̄u(m)baba,

“To a fight unknown to him, he advances,
An expedition unknown to him he undertakes.”⁸⁹

Ninsun evidently fears the consequences when her son informs her of his intention and asks her counsel. The answer of Shamash is not preserved, but no doubt it was of a reassuring character, as was the answer of the Sun-god to Gish’s appeal and prayer as set forth in the Yale tablet.⁹⁰

Again, as a further indication that Enkidu is the real conqueror of Huwawa, we find the coming contest revealed to Enkidu no less than three times in dreams, which Gilgamesh interprets.⁹¹ Since the person who dreams is always the one to whom the dream applies, we may see in these dreams a further trace of the primary rôle originally assigned to Enkidu.

Another exploit which, according to the Assyrian version, the two heroes perform in concert is the killing of a bull, sent by Anu at the instance of Ishtar to avenge an insult offered to the goddess by Gilgamesh, who rejects her offer of marriage. In the fragmentary description of the contest with the bull, we find Enkidu “seizing” the monster by “its tail.”⁹²

That Enkidu originally played the part of the slayer is also shown by the statement that it is he who insults Ishtar by throwing a piece of the carcass into the goddess’ face,⁹³ adding also an insulting speech; and this despite the fact that Ishtar in her rage accuses Gilgamesh of killing the bull.⁹⁴ It is thus evident that the Epic alters the original character of the episodes in order to find a place for Gilgamesh, with the further desire to assign to the latter the *chief* rôle. Be it noted also that Enkidu, not Gilgamesh, is punished for the insult to Ishtar. Enkidu must therefore in the original form of the episode have been the guilty party, who is stricken with mortal disease as a punishment to which after twelve days he succumbs.⁹⁵ In view of this, we may supply the name of Enkidu in the little song introduced at the close of the encounter with the bull, and not Gilgamesh as has hitherto been done.

“Who is distinguished among the heroes?
Who is glorious among men?
[Enkidu] is distinguished among heroes,
[Enkidu] is glorious among men.”⁹⁶

Finally, the killing of lions is directly ascribed to Enkidu in the Pennsylvania tablet:

“Lions he attacked
* * * * *

Lions he overcame”⁹⁷

whereas Gilgamesh appears to be afraid of lions. On his long search for Utnapishtim he says:

“On reaching the entrance of the mountain at night
I saw lions and was afraid.”⁹⁸

He prays to Sin and Ishtar to protect and save him. When, therefore, in another passage some one celebrates Gilgamesh as the one who overcame the “guardian,” who dispatched H̄u(m)baba in the cedar forest, who killed lions and overthrew the bull,⁹⁹ we have the completion of the process which transferred to Gilgamesh exploits and powers which originally belonged to Enkidu, though ordinarily the process stops short at making Gilgamesh a *sharer* in the exploits; with the natural tendency, to be sure, to enlarge the share of the favorite.

We can now understand why the two heroes are described in the Pennsylvania tablet as alike, as born in the same place, aye, as brothers. Gilgamesh in the Epic is merely a reflex of Enkidu. The latter is the real hero and presumably, therefore, the older figure.¹⁰⁰ Gilgamesh resembles Enkidu, because he *is* originally Enkidu. The “resemblance” *motif* is merely the manner in which in the course of the partly popular, partly literary transfer, the recollection is preserved that Enkidu is the original, and Gilgamesh the copy.

The artificiality of the process which brings the two heroes together is apparent in the dreams of Gilgamesh which are interpreted by his mother as portending the coming of Enkidu. Not the conflict is foreseen, but the subsequent close association, naïvely described as due to the personal charm which Enkidu exercises, which will lead Gilgamesh to fall in love with the one whom he is to meet. The two will become one, like man and wife.

On the basis of our investigations, we are now in a position to reconstruct in part the cycle of episodes that once formed part of an Enkidu Epic. The

fight between Enkidu and Gilgamesh, in which the former is the victor, is typical of the kind of tales told of Enkidu. He is the real prototype of the Greek Hercules. He slays lions, he overcomes a powerful opponent dwelling in the forests of Lebanon, he kills the bull, and he finally succumbs to disease sent as a punishment by an angry goddess. The death of Enkidu naturally formed the close of the Enkidu Epic, which in its original form may, of course, have included other exploits besides those taken over into the Gilgamesh Epic.

There is another aspect of the figure of Enkidu which is brought forward in the Pennsylvania tablet more clearly than had hitherto been the case. Many years ago attention was called to certain striking resemblances between Enkidu and the figure of the first man as described in the early chapters of Genesis.¹⁰¹ At that time we had merely the Assyrian version of the Gilgamesh Epic at our disposal, and the main point of contact was the description of Enkidu living with the animals, drinking and feeding like an animal, until a woman is brought to him with whom he engages in sexual intercourse. This suggested that Enkidu was a picture of primeval man, while the woman reminded one of Eve, who when she is brought to Adam becomes his helpmate and inseparable companion. The Biblical tale stands, of course, on a much higher level, and is introduced, as are other traditions and tales of primitive times, in the style of a parable to convey certain religious teachings. For all that, suggestions of earlier conceptions crop out in the picture of Adam surrounded by animals to which he assigns names. Such a phrase as “there was no helpmate corresponding to him” becomes intelligible on the supposition of an existing tradition or belief, that man once lived and, indeed, cohabited with animals. The tales in the early chapters of Genesis must rest on very early popular traditions, which have been cleared of mythological and other objectionable features in order to adapt them to the purpose of the Hebrew compilers, to serve as a medium for illustrating certain religious teachings regarding man’s place in nature and his higher destiny. From the resemblance between Enkidu and Adam it does not, of course, follow that the latter is modelled upon the former, but

only that both rest on similar traditions of the condition under which men lived in primeval days prior to the beginnings of human culture.

We may now pass beyond these general indications and recognize in the story of Enkidu as revealed by the Pennsylvania tablet an attempt to trace the evolution of primitive man from low beginnings to the regular and orderly family life associated with advanced culture. The new tablet furnishes a further illustration for the surprisingly early tendency among the Babylonian *literati* to connect with popular tales teachings of a religious or ethical character. Just as the episode between Gilgamesh and the maiden Sabitum is made the occasion for introducing reflections on the inevitable fate of man to encounter death, so the meeting of Enkidu with the woman becomes the medium of impressing the lesson of human progress through the substitution of bread and wine for milk and water, through the institution of the family, and through work and the laying up of resources. This is the significance of the address to Enkidu in column 4 of the Pennsylvania tablet, even though certain expressions in it are somewhat obscure. The connection of the entire episode of Enkidu and the woman with Gilgamesh is very artificial; and it becomes much more intelligible if we disassociate it from its present entanglement in the Epic. In Gilgamesh's dream, portending the meeting with Enkidu, nothing is said of the woman who is the companion of the latter. The passage in which Enkidu is created by Aruru to oppose Gilgamesh¹⁰² betrays evidence of having been worked over in order to bring Enkidu into association with the longing of the people of Erech to get rid of a tyrannical character. The people in their distress appeal to Aruru to create a rival to Gilgamesh. In response,

“Aruru upon hearing this created a man of Anu in her heart.”

Now this “man of Anu” cannot possibly be Enkidu, for the sufficient reason that a few lines further on Enkidu is described as an offspring of Ninib. Moreover, the being created is not a “counterpart” of Gilgamesh, but an animal-man, as the description that follows shows. We must separate lines 30–33 in which the creation of the “Anu man” is described from lines 34–41 in which the creation of Enkidu is narrated. Indeed, these lines strike one

as the proper *beginning* of the original Enkidu story, which would naturally start out with his birth and end with his death. The description is clearly an account of the creation of the first man, in which capacity Enkidu is brought forward.

“Aruru washed her hands, broke off clay,
threw it on the field¹⁰³
... created Enkidu, the hero, a lofty
offspring of the host of Ninib.”¹⁰⁴

The description of Enkidu follows, with his body covered with hair like an animal, and eating and drinking with the animals. There follows an episode¹⁰⁵ which has no connection whatsoever with the Gilgamesh Epic, but which is clearly intended to illustrate how Enkidu came to abandon the life with the animals. A hunter sees Enkidu and is amazed at the strange sight—an animal and yet a man. Enkidu, as though resenting his condition, becomes enraged at the sight of the hunter, and the latter goes to his father and tells him of the strange creature whom he is unable to catch. In reply, the father advises his son to take a woman with him when next he goes out on his pursuit, and to have the woman remove her dress in the presence of Enkidu, who will then approach her, and after intercourse with her will abandon the animals among whom he lives. By this device he will catch the strange creature. Lines 14–18 of column 3 in the first tablet in which the father of the hunter refers to Gilgamesh must be regarded as a later insertion, a part of the reconstruction of the tale to connect the episode with Gilgamesh. The advice of the father to his son, the hunter, begins, line 19,

“Go my hunter, take with thee a woman.”

In the reconstructed tale, the father tells his son to go to Gilgamesh to relate to him the strange appearance of the animal-man; but there is clearly no purpose in this, as is shown by the fact that when the hunter does so, Gilgamesh makes *precisely the same speech* as does the father of the hunter. Lines 40–44 of column 3, in which Gilgamesh is represented as speaking to the hunter form a complete *doublet* to lines 19–24, beginning

“Go, my hunter, take with thee a woman, etc.”

and similarly the description of Enkidu appears twice, lines 2–12 in an address of the hunter to his father, and lines 29–39 in the address of the hunter to Gilgamesh.

The artificiality of the process of introducing Gilgamesh into the episode is revealed by this awkward and entirely meaningless repetition. We may therefore reconstruct the first two scenes in the Enkidu Epic as follows:¹⁰⁶

Tablet I, col. 2, 34–35: Creation of Enkidu by Aruru.

36–41: Description of Enkidu’s hairy body and of his life with the animals.

42–50: The hunter sees Enkidu, who shows his anger, as also his woe, at his condition.

3, 1–12: The hunter tells his father of the strange being who pulls up the traps which the hunter digs, and who tears the nets so that the hunter is unable to catch him or the animals.

19–24: The father of the hunter advises his son on his next expedition to take a woman with him in order to lure the strange being from his life with the animals.

Line 25, beginning “On the advice of his father,” must have set forth, in the original form of the episode, how the hunter procured the woman and took her with him to meet Enkidu.

Column 4 gives in detail the meeting between the two, and naïvely describes how the woman exposes her charms to Enkidu, who is captivated by her and stays with her six days and seven nights. The animals see the change in Enkidu and run away from him. He has been transformed through the woman. So far the episode. In the Assyrian version there follows an address of the woman to Enkidu beginning (col. 4, 34):

“Beautiful art thou, Enkidu, like a god art thou.”

We find her urging him to go with her to Erech, there to meet Gilgamesh and to enjoy the pleasures of city life with plenty of beautiful maidens. Gilgamesh, she adds, will expect Enkidu, for the coming of the latter to Erech has been foretold in a dream. It is evident that here we have again the later transformation of the Enkidu Epic in order to bring the two heroes together. Will it be considered too bold if we assume that in the original form the address of the woman and the construction of the episode were such as we find preserved in part in columns 2 to 4 of the Pennsylvania tablet, which forms part of the new material that can now be added to the Epic? The address of the woman begins in line 51 of the Pennsylvania tablet:

“I gaze upon thee, Enkidu, like a god art thou.”

This corresponds to the line in the Assyrian version (I, 4, 34) as given above, just as lines 52–53:

“Why with the cattle
Dost thou roam across the field?”

correspond to I, 4, 35, of the Assyrian version. There follows in both the old Babylonian and the Assyrian version the appeal of the woman to Enkidu, to allow her to lead him to Erech where Gilgamesh dwells (Pennsylvania tablet lines 54–61 = Assyrian version I, 4, 36–39); but in the Pennsylvania tablet we now have a *second* speech (lines 62–63) beginning like the first one with *al-ka*, “come:”

“Come, arise from the accursed ground.”

Enkidu consents, and now the woman takes off her garments and clothes the naked Enkidu, while putting another garment on herself. She takes hold of his hand and leads him to the sheepfolds (not to Erech!!), where bread and wine are placed before him. Accustomed hitherto to sucking milk with cattle, Enkidu does not know what to do with the strange food until encouraged and instructed by the woman. The entire third column is taken up with this introduction of Enkidu to civilized life in a pastoral community, and the scene ends with Enkidu becoming a guardian of flocks. Now all this

has nothing to do with Gilgamesh, and clearly sets forth an entirely different idea from the one embodied in the meeting of the two heroes. In the original Enkidu tale, the animal-man is looked upon as the type of a primitive savage, and the point of the tale is to illustrate in the naïve manner characteristic of folklore the evolution to the higher form of pastoral life. This aspect of the incident is, therefore, to be separated from the other phase which has as its chief *motif* the bringing of the two heroes together.

We now obtain, thanks to the new section revealed by the Pennsylvania tablet, a further analogy¹⁰⁷ with the story of Adam and Eve, but with this striking difference, that whereas in the Babylonian tale the woman is the medium leading man to the higher life, in the Biblical story the woman is the tempter who brings misfortune to man. This contrast is, however, not inherent in the Biblical story, but due to the point of view of the Biblical writer, who is somewhat pessimistically inclined and looks upon primitive life, when man went naked and lived in a garden, eating of fruits that grew of themselves, as the blessed life in contrast to advanced culture which leads to agriculture and necessitates hard work as the means of securing one's substance. Hence the woman through whom Adam eats of the tree of knowledge and becomes conscious of being naked is looked upon as an evil tempter, entailing the loss of the primeval life of bliss in a gorgeous Paradise. The Babylonian point of view is optimistic. The change to civilized life—involving the wearing of clothes and the eating of food that is cultivated (bread and wine) is looked upon as an advance. Hence the woman is viewed as the medium of raising man to a higher level. The feature common to the Biblical and Babylonian tales is the attachment of a lesson to early folk-tales. The story of Adam and Eve,¹⁰⁸ as the story of Enkidu and the woman, is told *with a purpose*. Starting with early traditions of men's primitive life on earth, that may have arisen independently, Hebrew and Babylonian writers diverged, each group going its own way, each reflecting the particular point of view from which the evolution of human society was viewed.

Leaving the analogy between the Biblical and Babylonian tales aside, the main point of value for us in the Babylonian story of Enkidu and the woman is the proof furnished by the analysis, made possible through the

Pennsylvania tablet, that the tale can be separated from its subsequent connection with Gilgamesh. We can continue this process of separation in the fourth column, where the woman instructs Enkidu in the further duty of living his life with the woman decreed for him, to raise a family, to engage in work, to build cities and to gather resources. All this is looked upon in the same optimistic spirit as marking progress, whereas the Biblical writer, consistent with his point of view, looks upon work as a curse, and makes Cain, the murderer, also the founder of cities. The step to the higher forms of life is not an advance according to the J document. It is interesting to note that even the phrase the “cursed ground” occurs in both the Babylonian and Biblical tales; but whereas in the latter (Gen. 3, 17) it is because of the hard work entailed in raising the products of the earth that the ground is cursed, in the former (lines 62–63) it is the place in which Enkidu lives *before* he advances to the dignity of human life that is “cursed,” and which he is asked to leave. Adam is expelled from Paradise as a punishment, whereas Enkidu is implored to leave it as a necessary step towards *progress* to a higher form of existence. The contrast between the Babylonian and the Biblical writer extends to the view taken of viniculture. The Biblical writer (again the J document) looks upon Noah’s drunkenness as a disgrace. Noah loses his sense of shame and uncovers himself (Genesis 9, 21), whereas in the Babylonian description Enkidu’s jolly spirit after he has drunk seven jars of wine meets with approval. The Biblical point of view is that he who drinks wine becomes drunk;¹⁰⁹ the Babylonian says, if you drink wine you become happy.¹¹⁰

If the thesis here set forth of the original character and import of the episode of Enkidu with the woman is correct, we may again regard lines 149–153 of the Pennsylvania tablet, in which Gilgamesh is introduced, as a later addition to bring the two heroes into association. The episode in its original form ended with the introduction of Enkidu first to pastoral life, and then to the still higher city life with regulated forms of social existence.

Now, to be sure, this Enkidu has little in common with the Enkidu who is described as a powerful warrior, a Hercules, who kills lions, overcomes the giant Huwawa, and dispatches a great bull, but it is the nature of folklore everywhere to attach to traditions about a favorite hero all kinds of tales

with which originally he had nothing to do. Enkidu, as such a favorite, is viewed also as the type of primitive man,¹¹¹ and so there arose gradually an Epic which began with his birth, pictured him as half-animal half-man, told how he emerged from this state, how he became civilized, was clothed, learned to eat food and drink wine, how he shaved off the hair with which his body was covered,¹¹² anointed himself—in short,

“He became manlike.”¹¹³

Thereupon he is taught his duties as a husband, is introduced to the work of building, and to laying aside supplies, and the like. The fully-developed and full-fledged hero then engages in various exploits, of which *some* are now embodied in the Gilgamesh Epic. Who this Enkidu was, we are not in a position to determine, but the suggestion has been thrown out above that he is a personage foreign to Babylonia, that his home appears to be in the undefined Amurru district, and that he conquers that district. The original tale of Enkidu, if this view be correct, must therefore have been carried to the Euphrates Valley, at a very remote period, with one of the migratory waves that brought a western people as invaders into Babylonia. Here the tale was combined with stories current of another hero, Gilgamesh—perhaps also of Western origin—whose conquest of Erech likewise represents an invasion of Babylonia. The center of the Gilgamesh tale was Erech, and in the process of combining the stories of Enkidu and Gilgamesh, Enkidu is brought to Erech and the two perform exploits in common. In such a combination, the aim would be to utilize all the incidents of *both* tales. The woman who accompanies Enkidu, therefore, becomes the medium of bringing the two heroes together. The story of the evolution of primitive man to civilized life is transformed into the tale of Enkidu’s removal to Erech, and elaborated with all kinds of details, among which we have, as perhaps embodying a genuine historical tradition, the encounter of the two heroes.

Before passing on, we have merely to note the very large part taken in both the old Babylonian and the Assyrian version by the struggle against Huwawa. The entire Yale tablet—forming, as we have seen, the third of the series—is taken up with the preparation for the struggle, and with the

repeated warnings given to Gilgamesh against the dangerous undertaking. The fourth tablet must have recounted the struggle itself, and it is not improbable that this episode extended into the fifth tablet, since in the Assyrian version this is the case. The elaboration of the story is in itself an argument in favor of assuming some historical background for it—the recollection of the conquest of Amurru by some powerful warrior; and we have seen that this conquest must be ascribed to Enkidu and not to Gilgamesh.

If, now, Enkidu is not only the older figure but the one who is the real hero of the most notable episode in the Gilgamesh Epic; if, furthermore, Enkidu is the Hercules who kills lions and dispatches the bull sent by an enraged goddess, what becomes of Gilgamesh? What is left for him?

In the first place, he is definitely the conqueror of Erech. He builds the wall of Erech,¹¹⁴ and we may assume that the designation of the city as *Uruk supûri*, “the walled Erech,”¹¹⁵ rests upon this tradition. He is also associated with the great temple Eanna, “the heavenly house,” in Erech. To Gilgamesh belongs also the unenviable tradition of having exercised his rule in Erech so harshly that the people are impelled to implore Aruru to create a rival who may rid the district of the cruel tyrant, who is described as snatching sons and daughters from their families, and in other ways terrifying the population—an early example of “Schrecklichkeit.” Tablets II to V inclusive of the Assyrian version being taken up with the *Huwawa* episode, modified with a view of bringing the two heroes together, we come at once to the sixth tablet, which tells the story of how the goddess Ishtar wooed Gilgamesh, and of the latter’s rejection of her advances. This tale is distinctly a nature myth. The attempt of Gressmann¹¹⁶ to find some historical background to the episode is a failure. The goddess Ishtar symbolizes the earth which woos the sun in the spring, but whose love is fatal, for after a few months the sun’s power begins to wane. Gilgamesh, who in incantation hymns is invoked in terms which show that he was conceived as a sun-god,¹¹⁷ recalls to the goddess how she changed her lovers into animals, like Circe of Greek mythology, and brought them to

grief. Enraged at Gilgamesh's insult to her vanity, she flies to her father Anu and cries for revenge. At this point the episode of the creation of the bull is introduced, but if the analysis above given is correct it is Enkidu who is the hero in dispatching the bull, and we must assume that the sickness with which Gilgamesh is smitten is the punishment sent by Anu to avenge the insult to his daughter. This sickness symbolizes the waning strength of the sun after midsummer is past. The sun recedes from the earth, and this was pictured in the myth as the sun-god's rejection of Ishtar; Gilgamesh's fear of death marks the approach of the winter season, when the sun appears to have lost its vigor completely and is near to death. The entire episode is, therefore, a nature myth, symbolical of the passing of spring to midsummer and then to the bare season. The myth has been attached to Gilgamesh as a favorite figure, and then woven into a pattern with the episode of Enkidu and the bull. The bull episode can be detached from the nature myth without any loss to the symbolism of the tale of Ishtar and Gilgamesh.

As already suggested, with Enkidu's death after this conquest of the bull the original Enkidu Epic came to an end. In order to connect Gilgamesh with Enkidu, the former is represented as sharing in the struggle against the bull. Enkidu is punished with death, while Gilgamesh is smitten with disease. Since both shared equally in the guilt, the punishment should have been the same for both. The differentiation may be taken as an indication that Gilgamesh's disease has nothing to do with the bull episode, but is merely part of the nature myth.

Gilgamesh now begins a series of wanderings in search of the restoration of his vigor, and this *motif* is evidently a continuation of the nature myth to symbolize the sun's wanderings during the dark winter in the hope of renewed vigor with the coming of the spring. Professor Haupt's view is that the disease from which Gilgamesh is supposed to be suffering is of a venereal character, affecting the organs of reproduction. This would confirm the position here taken that the myth symbolizes the loss of the sun's vigor. The sun's rays are no longer strong enough to fertilize the earth. In accord with this, Gilgamesh's search for healing leads him to the dark regions¹¹⁸ in which the scorpion-men dwell. The terrors of the region symbolize the gloom of the winter season. At last Gilgamesh reaches a region of light

again, described as a landscape situated at the sea. The maiden in control of this region bolts the gate against Gilgamesh's approach, but the latter forces his entrance. It is the picture of the sun-god bursting through the darkness, to emerge as the youthful reinvigorated sun-god of the spring.

Now with the tendency to attach to popular tales and nature myths lessons illustrative of current beliefs and aspirations, Gilgamesh's search for renewal of life is viewed as man's longing for eternal life. The sun-god's waning power after midsummer is past suggests man's growing weakness after the meridian of life has been left behind. Winter is death, and man longs to escape it. Gilgamesh's wanderings are used as illustration of this longing, and accordingly the search for life becomes also the quest for immortality. Can the precious boon of eternal life be achieved? Popular fancy created the figure of a favorite of the gods who had escaped a destructive deluge in which all mankind had perished.¹¹⁹ Gilgamesh hears of this favorite and determines to seek him out and learn from him the secret of eternal life. The deluge story, again a pure nature myth, symbolical of the rainy season which destroys all life in nature, is thus attached to the Epic. Gilgamesh after many adventures finds himself in the presence of the survivor of the Deluge who, although human, enjoys immortal life among the gods. He asks the survivor how he came to escape the common fate of mankind, and in reply Utnapishtim tells the story of the catastrophe that brought about universal destruction. The moral of the tale is obvious. Only those singled out by the special favor of the gods can hope to be removed to the distant "source of the streams" and live forever. The rest of mankind must face death as the end of life.

That the story of the Deluge is told in the eleventh tablet of the series, corresponding to the eleventh month, known as the month of "rain curse"¹²⁰ and marking the height of the rainy season, may be intentional, just as it may not be accidental that Gilgamesh's rejection of Ishtar is recounted in the sixth tablet, corresponding to the sixth month,¹²¹ which marks the end of the summer season. The two tales may have formed part of a cycle of myths, distributed among the months of the year. The Gilgamesh Epic, however, does not form such a cycle. Both myths have been artificially attached to the adventures of the hero. For the deluge story we now have the

definite proof for its independent existence, through Dr. Poebel's publication of a Sumerian text which embodies the tale,¹²² and without any reference to Gilgamesh. Similarly, Scheil and Hilprecht have published fragments of deluge stories written in Akkadian and likewise without any connection with the Gilgamesh Epic.¹²³

In the Epic the story leads to another episode attached to Gilgamesh, namely, the search for a magic plant growing in deep water, which has the power of restoring old age to youth. Utnapishtim, the survivor of the deluge, is moved through pity for Gilgamesh, worn out by his long wanderings. At the request of his wife, Utnapishtim decides to tell Gilgamesh of this plant, and he succeeds in finding it. He plucks it and decides to take it back to Erech so that all may enjoy the benefit, but on his way stops to bathe in a cool cistern. A serpent comes along and snatches the plant from him, and he is forced to return to Erech with his purpose unachieved. Man cannot hope, when old age comes on, to escape death as the end of everything.

Lastly, the twelfth tablet of the Assyrian version of the Gilgamesh Epic is of a purely didactic character, bearing evidence of having been added as a further illustration of the current belief that there is no escape from the nether world to which all must go after life has come to an end. Proper burial and suitable care of the dead represent all that can be done in order to secure a fairly comfortable rest for those who have passed out of this world. Enkidu is once more introduced into this episode. His shade is invoked by Gilgamesh and rises up out of the lower world to give a discouraging reply to Gilgamesh's request,

“Tell me, my friend, tell me, my friend,
The law of the earth which thou hast
experienced, tell me,”

The mournful message comes back:

“I cannot tell thee, my friend, I cannot tell.”

Death is a mystery and must always remain such. The historical Gilgamesh has clearly no connection with the figure introduced into this twelfth tablet. Indeed, as already suggested, the Gilgamesh Epic must have ended with the return to Erech, as related at the close of the eleventh tablet. The twelfth tablet was added by some school-men of Babylonia (or perhaps of Assyria), purely for the purpose of conveying a summary of the teachings in regard to the fate of the dead. Whether these six episodes covering the sixth to the twelfth tablets, (1) the nature myth, (2) the killing of the divine bull, (3) the punishment of Gilgamesh and the death of Enkidu, (4) Gilgamesh's wanderings, (5) the Deluge, (6) the search for immortality, were all included at the time that the old Babylonian version was compiled cannot, of course, be determined until we have that version in a more complete form. Since the two tablets thus far recovered show that as early as 2000 B.C. the Enkidu tale had already been amalgamated with the current stories about Gilgamesh, and the endeavor made to transfer the traits of the former to the latter, it is eminently likely that the story of Ishtar's unhappy love adventure with Gilgamesh was included, as well as Gilgamesh's punishment and the death of Enkidu. With the evidence furnished by Meissner's fragment of a version of the old Babylonian revision and by our two tablets, of the early disposition to make popular tales the medium of illustrating current beliefs and the teachings of the temple schools, it may furthermore be concluded that the death of Enkidu and the punishment of Gilgamesh were utilized for didactic purposes in the old Babylonian version. On the other hand, the proof for the existence of the deluge story in the Hammurabi period and some centuries later, *independent* of any connection with the Gilgamesh Epic, raises the question whether in the old Babylonian version, of which our two tablets form a part, the deluge tale was already woven into the pattern of the Epic. At all events, till proof to the contrary is forthcoming, we may assume that the twelfth tablet of the Assyrian version, though also reverting to a Babylonian original, dates as the *latest* addition to the Epic from a period subsequent to 2000 B.C.; and that the same is probably the case with the eleventh tablet.

To sum up, there are four main currents that flow together in the Gilgamesh Epic even in its old Babylonian form: (1) the adventures of a mighty warrior Enkidu, resting perhaps on a faint tradition of the conquest of Amurru by the hero; (2) the more definite recollection of the exploits of a foreign invader of Babylonia by the name of Gilgamesh, whose home appears likewise to have been in the West;¹²⁴ (3) nature myths and didactic tales transferred to Enkidu and Gilgamesh as popular figures; and (4) the process of weaving the traditions, exploits, myths and didactic tales together, in the course of which process Gilgamesh becomes the main hero, and Enkidu his companion.

Furthermore, our investigation has shown that to Enkidu belongs the episode with the woman, used to illustrate the evolution of primitive man to the ways and conditions of civilized life, the conquest of Huwawa in the land of Amurru, the killing of lions and also of the bull, while Gilgamesh is the hero who conquers Erech. Identified with the sun-god, the nature myth of the union of the sun with the earth and the subsequent separation of the two is also transferred to him. The wanderings of the hero, smitten with disease, are a continuation of the nature myth, symbolizing the waning vigor of the sun with the approach of the wintry season.

The details of the process which led to making Gilgamesh the favorite figure, to whom the traits and exploits of Enkidu and of the sun-god are transferred, escape us, but of the fact that Enkidu is the *older* figure, of whom certain adventures were set forth in a tale that once had an independent existence, there can now be little doubt in the face of the evidence furnished by the two tablets of the old Babylonian version; just as the study of these tablets shows that in the combination of the tales of Enkidu and Gilgamesh, the former is the prototype of which Gilgamesh is the copy. If the two are regarded as brothers, as born in the same place, even resembling one another in appearance and carrying out their adventures in common, it is because in the process of combination Gilgamesh becomes the *reflex* of Enkidu. That Enkidu is not the figure created by Aruru to relieve Erech of its tyrannical ruler is also shown by the fact that Gilgamesh remains in control of Erech. It is to Erech that he returns when he fails of his purpose to learn the secret of escape from old age and death. Erech is,

therefore, not relieved of the presence of the ruthless ruler through Enkidu. The “Man of Anu” formed by Aruru as a deliverer is confused in the course of the growth of the Epic with Enkidu, the offspring of Ninib, and in this way we obtain the strange contradiction of Enkidu and Gilgamesh appearing first as bitter rivals and then as close and inseparable friends. It is of the nature of Epic compositions everywhere to eliminate unnecessary figures by concentrating on one favorite the traits belonging to another or to several others.

The close association of Enkidu and Gilgamesh which becomes one of the striking features in the combination of the tales of these two heroes naturally recalls the “Heavenly Twins” *motif*, which has been so fully and so suggestively treated by Professor J. Rendell Harris in his *Cult of the Heavenly Twins*, (London, 1906). Professor Harris has conclusively shown how widespread the tendency is to associate two divine or semi-divine beings in myths and legends as inseparable companions¹²⁵ or twins, like Castor and Pollux, Romulus and Remus,¹²⁶ the Acvins in the Rig-Veda,¹²⁷ Cain and Abel, Jacob and Esau in the Old Testament, the Kabiri of the Phoenicians,¹²⁸ Herakles and Iphikles in Greek mythology, Ambrica and Fidelio in Teutonic mythology, Patollo and Potrimpo in old Prussian mythology, Cautes and Cautopates in Mithraism, Jesus and Thomas (according to the Syriac Acts of Thomas), and the various illustrations of “Dioscuri in Christian Legends,” set forth by Dr. Harris in his work under this title, which carries the *motif* far down into the period of legends about Christian Saints who appear in pairs, including the reference to such a pair in Shakespeare’s Henry V:

“And Crispin Crispian shall ne’er go by
From that day to the ending of the world.”—(Act, IV,
3, 57–58.)

There are indeed certain parallels which suggest that Enkidu-Gilgamesh may represent a Babylonian counterpart to the “Heavenly Twins.” In the Indo-Iranian, Greek and Roman mythology, the twins almost invariably act together. In unison they proceed on expeditions to punish enemies.¹²⁹

But after all, the parallels are of too general a character to be of much moment; and moreover the parallels stop short at the critical point, for Gilgamesh though worsted is *not* killed by Enkidu, whereas one of the “Heavenly Twins” is always killed by the brother, as Abel is by Cain, and Iphikles by his twin brother Herakles. Even the trait which is frequent in the earliest forms of the “Heavenly Twins,” according to which one is immortal and the other is mortal, though applying in a measure to Enkidu who is killed by Ishtar, while Gilgamesh the offspring of a divine pair is only smitten with disease, is too unsubstantial to warrant more than a general comparison between the Enkidu-Gilgamesh pair and the various forms of the “twin” *motif* found throughout the ancient world. For all that, the point is of some interest that in the Gilgamesh Epic we should encounter two figures who are portrayed as possessing the same traits and accomplishing feats in common, which suggest a partial parallel to the various forms in which the twin-*motif* appears in the mythologies, folk-lore and legends of many nations; and it may be that in some of these instances the duplication is due, as in the case of Enkidu and Gilgamesh, to an actual transfer of the traits of one figure to another who usurped his place.

In concluding this study of the two recently discovered tablets of the old Babylonian version of the Gilgamesh Epic which has brought us several steps further in the interpretation and in our understanding of the method of composition of the most notable literary production of ancient Babylonia, it will be proper to consider the *literary* relationship of the old Babylonian to the Assyrian version.

We have already referred to the different form in which the names of the chief figures appear in the old Babylonian version, ^dGish as against ^dGish-gì(n)-mash, ^dEn-ki-dū as against ^dEn-ki-dú, ̕u-wa-wa as against ̕u(m)-ba-ba. Erech appears as *Uruk ribîtim*, “Erech of the Plazas,” as against *Uruk supûri*, “walled Erech” (or “Erech within the walls”), in the Assyrian version.¹³⁰ These variations point to an *independent* recension for the Assyrian revision; and this conclusion is confirmed by a comparison of parallel passages in our two tablets with the Assyrian version, for such

parallels rarely extend to verbal agreements in details, and, moreover, show that the Assyrian version has been elaborated.

Beginning with the Pennsylvania tablet, column I is covered in the Assyrian version by tablet I, 5, 25, to 6, 33, though, as pointed out above, in the Assyrian version we have the anticipation of the dreams of Gilgamesh and their interpretation through their recital to Enkidu by his female companion, whereas in the old Babylonian version we have the dreams *directly* given in a conversation between Gilgamesh and his mother. In the anticipation, there would naturally be some omissions. So lines 4–5 and 12–13 of the Pennsylvania tablet do not appear in the Assyrian version, but in their place is a line (I, 5, 35), to be restored to

”[I saw him and like] a woman I fell in love with him.”

which occurs in the old Babylonian version only in connection with the second dream. The point is of importance as showing that in the Babylonian version the first dream lays stress upon the omen of the falling meteor, as symbolizing the coming of Enkidu, whereas the second dream more specifically reveals Enkidu as a man,¹³¹ of whom Gilgamesh is instantly enamored. Strikingly variant lines, though conveying the same idea, are frequent. Thus line 14 of the Babylonian version reads

“I bore it and carried it to thee”

and appears in the Assyrian version (I, 5, 35^b supplied from 6, 26)

“I threw it (or him) at thy feet”¹³²

with an additional line in elaboration

“Thou didst bring him into contact with me”¹³³

which anticipates the speech of the mother

(Line 41 = Assyrian version I, 6, 33).

Line 10 of the Pennsylvania tablet has *pa-ḫi-ir* as against *iz-za-az* I, 5, 31.

Line 8 has *ik-ta-bi-it* as against *da-an* in the Assyrian version I, 5, 29.

More significant is the variant to line 9

“I became weak and its weight I could not bear”

as against I, 5, 30.

“Its strength was overpowering,¹³⁴ and I could not endure its weight.”

The important lines 31–36 are not found in the Assyrian version, with the exception of I, 6, 27, which corresponds to lines 33–34, but this lack of correspondence is probably due to the fact that the Assyrian version represents the anticipation of the dreams which, as already suggested, might well omit some details. As against this we have in the Assyrian version I, 6, 23–25, an elaboration of line 30 in the Pennsylvania tablet and taken over from the recital of the first dream. Through the Assyrian version I, 6, 31–32, we can restore the closing lines of column I of the Pennsylvania tablet, while with line 33 = line 45 of the Pennsylvania tablet, the parallel between the two versions comes to an end. Lines 34–43 of the Assyrian version (bringing tablet I to a close)¹³⁵ represent an elaboration of the speech of Ninsun, followed by a further address of Gilgamesh to his mother, and by the determination of Gilgamesh to seek out Enkidu.¹³⁶ Nothing of this sort appears to have been included in the old Babylonian version. Our text proceeds with the scene between Enkidu and the woman, in which the latter by her charms and her appeal endeavors to lead Enkidu away from his life with the animals. From the abrupt manner in which the scene is introduced in line 43 of the Pennsylvania tablet, it is evident that this cannot be the *first* mention of the woman. The meeting must have been recounted in the first tablet, as is the case in the Assyrian version.¹³⁷ The second tablet takes up the direct recital of the dreams of Gilgamesh and then continues the narrative. Whether in the old Babylonian version the scene between Enkidu and the woman was described with the same naïve details, as in the

Assyrian version, of the sexual intercourse between the two for six days and seven nights cannot of course be determined, though presumably the Assyrian version, with the tendency of epics to become more elaborate as they pass from age to age, added some realistic touches. Assuming that lines 44–63 of the Pennsylvania tablet—the cohabitation of Enkidu and the address of the woman—is a repetition of what was already described in the first tablet, the comparison with the Assyrian version I, 4, 16–41, not only points to the elaboration of the later version, but likewise to an independent recension, even where parallel lines can be picked out. Only lines 46–48 of the Pennsylvania tablet form a complete parallel to line 21 of column 4 of the Assyrian version. The description in lines 22–32 of column 4 is missing, though it may, of course, have been included in part in the recital in the first tablet of the old Babylonian version. Lines 49–59 of the Pennsylvania tablet are covered by 33–39, the only slight difference being the specific mention in line 58 of the Pennsylvania tablet of Eanna, the temple in Erech, described as “the dwelling of Anu,” whereas in the Assyrian version Eanna is merely referred to as the “holy house” and described as “the dwelling of Anu and Ishtar,” where Ishtar is clearly a later addition.

Leaving aside lines 60–61, which may be merely a variant (though independent) of line 39 of column 4 of the Assyrian version, we now have in the Pennsylvania tablet a second speech of the woman to Enkidu (not represented in the Assyrian version) beginning like the first one with *alka*, “Come” (lines 62–63), in which she asks Enkidu to leave the “accursed ground” in which he dwells. This speech, as the description which follows, extending into columns 3–4, and telling how the woman clothed Enkidu, how she brought him to the sheep folds, how she taught him to eat bread and to drink wine, and how she instructed him in the ways of civilization, must have been included in the second tablet of the Assyrian version which has come down to us in a very imperfect form. Nor is the scene in which Enkidu and Gilgamesh have their encounter found in the preserved portions of the second (or possibly the third) tablet of the Assyrian version, but only a brief reference to it in the fourth tablet,¹³⁸ in which in Epic style the story is repeated, leading up to the second exploit—the joint campaign of Enkidu and Gilgamesh against Huwawa. This reference, covering only seven lines, corresponds to lines 192–231 of the Pennsylvania tablet; but the former

being the repetition and the latter the original recital, the comparison to be instituted merely reveals again the independence of the Assyrian version, as shown in the use of *kibsu*, “tread” (IV, 2, 46), for *šêpu*, “foot” (l. 216), *i-na-uš*, “quake” (line 5C), as against *ir-tu-tu* (ll. 221 and 226).

Such variants as

^dGish êribam ûl iddin (l. 217)

against

^dGilgamesh ana šurûbi ûl namdin, (IV, 2, 47).

and again

iššabtûma kima lîm “they grappled at the gate of the family house” (IV, 2, 48),

against

iššabtûma ina bâb bît emuti, “they grappled at the gate of the family house” (IV, 2, 48),

all point once more to the literary independence of the Assyrian version. The end of the conflict and the reconciliation of the two heroes is likewise missing in the Assyrian version. It may have been referred to at the beginning of column 3¹³⁹ of Tablet IV.

Coming to the Yale tablet, the few passages in which a comparison may be instituted with the fourth tablet of the Assyrian version, to which in a general way it must correspond, are not sufficient to warrant any conclusions, beyond the confirmation of the literary independence of the Assyrian version. The section comprised within lines 72–89, where Enkidu’s grief at his friend’s decision to fight Huwawa is described¹⁴⁰, and he makes confession of his own physical exhaustion, may correspond to Tablet IV, column 4, of the Assyrian version. This would fit in with the beginning of the reverse, the first two lines of which (136–137) correspond

to column 5 of the fourth tablet of the Assyrian version, with a variation “seven-fold fear”¹⁴¹ as against “fear of men” in the Assyrian version. If lines 138–139 (in column 4) of the Yale tablet correspond to line 7 of column 5 of Tablet IV of the Assyrian version, we would again have an illustration of the elaboration of the later version by the addition of lines 3–6. But beyond this we have merely the comparison of the description of Huwawa

“Whose roar is a flood, whose mouth is fire, and
whose breath is death”

which occurs twice in the Yale tablet (lines 110–111 and 196–197), with the same phrase in the Assyrian version Tablet IV, 5, 3—but here, as just pointed out, with an elaboration.

Practically, therefore, the entire Yale tablet represents an addition to our knowledge of the Huwawa episode, and until we are fortunate enough to discover more fragments of the fourth tablet of the Assyrian version, we must content ourselves with the conclusions reached from a comparison of the Pennsylvania tablet with the parallels in the Assyrian version.

It may be noted as a general point of resemblance in the exterior form of the old Babylonian and Assyrian versions that both were inscribed on tablets containing six columns, three on the obverse and three on the reverse; and that the length of the tablets—an average of 40 to 50 lines—was about the same, thus revealing in the external form a conventional size for the tablets in the older period, which was carried over into later times.

¹ See for further details of this royal library, Jastrow, *Civilization of Babylonia and Assyria*, p. 21 seq.

² *Das Babylonische Nimrodepos* (Leipzig, 1884–1891), supplemented by Haupt’s article *Die Zwölfte Tafel des Babylonischen Nimrodepos* in *BA I*, pp. 48–79, containing the fragments of the twelfth tablet. The fragments of the Epic in Ashurbanapal’s library—some sixty—represent portions of several copies. Sin-liḫi-unnini—perhaps from Erech, since this name appears as that of a family in tablets from Erech (see Clay, *Legal Documents from Erech*, Index, p. 73)—is named in a list of texts

(K 9717—Haupt's edition No. 51, line 18) as the editor of the Epic, though probably he was not the only compiler. Since the publication of Haupt's edition, a few fragments were added by him as an appendix to Alfred Jeremias *Izdubar-Nimrod* (Leipzig, 1891) Plates II–IV, and two more are embodied in Jensen's transliteration of all the fragments in the *Keilinschriftliche Bibliothek* VI; pp. 116–265, with elaborate notes, pp. 421–531. Furthermore a fragment, obtained from supplementary excavations at Kouyunjik, has been published by L. W. King in his *Supplement to the Catalogue of the Cuneiform Tablets in the Kouyunjik Collection of the British Cuneiform Tablets in the Kouyunjik Collection of the British Museum* No. 56 and *PSBA* Vol. 36, pp. 64–68. Recently a fragment of the 6th tablet from the excavations at Assur has been published by Ebeling, *Keilschrifttexte aus Assur Religiösen Inhalts* No. 115, and one may expect further portions to turn up.

The designation “Nimrod Epic” on the supposition that the hero of the Babylonian Epic is identical with Nimrod, the “mighty hunter” of Genesis 10, has now been generally abandoned, in the absence of any evidence that the Babylonian hero bore a name like Nimrod. For all that, the description of Nimrod as the “mighty hunter” and the occurrence of a “hunter” in the Babylonian Epic (Assyrian version Tablet I)—though he is not the hero—points to a confusion in the Hebrew form of the borrowed tradition between Gilgamesh and Nimrod. The latest French translation of the Epic is by Dhorme, *Choix de Textes Religieux Assyro-Babyloniens* (Paris, 1907), pp. 182–325; the latest German translation by Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos* (Göttingen, 1911), with a valuable analysis and discussion. These two translations now supersede Jensen's translation in the *Keilinschriftliche Bibliothek*, which, however, is still valuable because of the detailed notes, containing a wealth of lexicographical material. Ungnad also gave a partial translation in Gressmann-Ranke, *Altorientalische Texte und Bilder* I, pp. 39–61. In English, we have translations of substantial portions by Muss-Arnolt in Harper's *Assyrian and Babylonian Literature* (New York, 1901), pp. 324–368; by Jastrow, *Religion of Babylonia and Assyria* (Boston, 1898), Chap. XXIII; by Clay in *Light on the Old Testament from Babel*, pp. 78–84; by Rogers in *Cuneiform Parallels to the Old Testament*, pp. 80–103; and most recently by Jastrow in *Sacred Books and Early Literature of the East* (ed. C. F. Horne, New York, 1917), Vol. I, pp. 187–220.

³ See Luckenbill in *JAOS*, Vol. 37, p. 452 seq. Prof. Clay, it should be added, clings to the older reading, Hammurabi, which is retained in this volume.

⁴ *ZA*, Vol. 14, pp. 277–292.

⁵ The survivor of the Deluge is usually designated as Ut-napishtim in the Epic, but in one passage (Assyrian version, Tablet XI, 196), he is designated as Atra-ḫasis “the very wise one.” Similarly, in a second version of the Deluge story, also found in Ashurbanapal's library (IV R² additions, p. 9,

line 11). The two names clearly point to two versions, which in accordance with the manner of ancient compositions were merged into one. See an article by Jastrow in *ZA*, Vol. 13, pp. 288–301.

6 Published by Scheil in *Recueil des Travaux*, etc. Vol. 20, pp. 55–58.

7 The text does not form part of the Gilgamesh Epic, as the colophon, differing from the one attached to the Epic, shows.

8 *Ein altbabylonisches Fragment des Gilgamosepos* (MVAG 1902, No. 1).

9 On these variant forms of the two names see the discussion below, [p. 24](#).

10 The passage is paralleled by Ecc. 9, 7–9. See Jastrow, *A Gentle Cynic*, p. 172 *seq.*

11 Among the Nippur tablets in the collection of the University of Pennsylvania Museum. The fragment was published by Dr. Poebel in his *Historical and Grammatical Texts* No. 23. See also Poebel in the *Museum Journal*, Vol. IV, p. 47, and an article by Dr. Langdon in the same Journal, Vol. VII, pp. 178–181, though Langdon fails to credit Dr. Poebel with the discovery and publication of the important tablet.

12 No. 55 in Langdon's *Historical and Religious Texts from the Temple Library of Nippur* (Munich, 1914).

13 No. 5 in his *Sumerian Liturgical Texts*. (Philadelphia, 1917)

14 See on this name below, [p. 23](#).

15 See further below, [p. 37 seq.](#)

16 See Poebel, *Historical and Grammatical Texts*, No. 1, and Jastrow in *JAOS*, Vol. 36, pp. 122–131 and 274–299.

17 See an article by Jastrow, *Sumerian and Akkadian Views of Beginnings* (*JAOS* Vol. 36, pp. 274–299).

18 See on this point Eduard Meyer, *Sumerier und Semiten in Babylonien* (Berlin, 1906), p. 107 *seq.*, whose view is followed in Jastrow, *Civilization of Babylonia and Assyria*, p. 121. See also Clay, *Empire of the Amorites* (Yale University Press, 1919), p. 23 *et seq.*

19 See the discussion below, [p. 24 seq.](#)

20 Dr. Poebel published an article on the tablet in *OLZ*, 1914, pp. 4–6, in which he called attention to the correct name for the mother of Gilgamesh, which was settled by the tablet as Ninsun.

21 *Historical Texts* No. 2, Column 2, 26. See the discussion in *Historical and Grammatical Texts*, p. 123, *seq.*

- 22 See Fostat in *OLZ*, 1915, p. 367.
- 23 *Publications of the University of Pennsylvania Museum, Babylonian Section*, Vol. X, No. 3 (Philadelphia, 1917). It is to be regretted that Dr. Langdon should not have given full credit to Dr. Poebel for his discovery of the tablet. He merely refers in an obscure footnote to Dr. Poebel's having made a copy.
- 24 E.g., in the very first note on page 211, and again in a note on page 213.
- 25 Dr. Langdon neglected to copy the signs 4 šú-si = 240 which appear on the edge of the tablet. He also misunderstood the word šú-tu-ur in the colophon which he translated "written," taking the word from a stem šaṭāru, "write." The form šú-tu-ur is III, 1, from atāru, "to be in excess of," and indicates, presumably, that the text is a copy "enlarged" from an older original. See the Commentary to the colophon, p. 86.
- 26 *Museum Journal*, Vol. VIII, p. 29.
- 27 See below, [p. 23](#).
- 28 I follow the enumeration of tablets, columns and lines in Jensen's edition, though some fragments appear to have been placed by him in a wrong position.
- 29 According to Bezold's investigation, *Verbalsuffixformen als Alterskriterien babylonisch-assyrischer Inschriften* (Heidelberg Akad. d. Wiss., Philos.-Histor. Klasse, 1910, 9^{te} Abhandlung), the bulk of the tablets in Ashurbanapal's library are copies of originals dating from about 1500 B.C. It does not follow, however, that all the copies date from originals of the same period. Bezold reaches the conclusion on the basis of various forms for verbal suffixes, that the fragments from the Ashurbanapal Library actually date from three distinct periods ranging from before c. 1450 to c. 700 B.C.
- 30 "Before thou comest from the mountain, Gilgamesh in Erech will see thy dreams," after which the dreams are recounted by the woman to Enkidu. The expression "thy dreams" means here "dreams about thee." (Tablet I, 5, 23–24).
- 31 Lines 100–101.
- 32 In a paper read before the American Oriental Society at New Haven, April 4, 1918.
- 33 See the commentary to col. 4 of the Yale tablet for further details.
- 34 This is no doubt the correct reading of the three signs which used to be read Iz-tu-bar or Gish-du-bar. The first sign has commonly the value Gish, the second can be read Gin or Gi (Brünnow No. 11900) and the third Mash as well as Bar. See Ungnad in Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos*, p. 76, and Poebel, *Historical and Grammatical Texts*, p. 123.

- 35 So also in Sumerian (Zimmern, *Sumerische Kultlieder aus altbabylonischer Zeit*, No. 196, rev. 14 and 16.)
- 36 The sign used, LUM (Brünnow No. 11183), could have the value *ḥu* as well as *ḥum*.
- 37 The addition “father-in-law of Moses” to the name *Ḥobab b. Re’uel* in this passage must refer to *Re’uel*, and not to *Ḥobab*. In Judges 4, 11, the gloss “of the Bene *Ḥobab*, the father-in-law of Moses” must be separated into two: (1) “Bene *Ḥobab*,” and (2) “father-in-law of Moses.” The latter addition rests on an erroneous tradition, or is intended as a brief reminder that *Ḥobab* is identical with the son of *Re’uel*.
- 38 See his *List of Personal Names from the Temple School of Nippur*, p. 122. *Ḥu-um-ba-bi-tu* and *ši-kin ḥu-wa-wa* also occur in Omen Texts (*CT XXVII*, 4, 8–9 = Pl. 3, 17 = Pl. 6, 3–4 = *CT XXVIII*, 14, 12). The contrast to *ḥuwawa* is *ligru*, “dwarf” (*CT XXVII*, 4, 12 and 14 = Pl. 6, 7.9 = Pl. 3, 19). See Jastrow, *Religion Babyloniens und Assyriens*, II, p. 913, Note 7. *Ḥuwawa*, therefore, has the force of “monster.”
- 39 Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos*, p. 111 *seq.*
- 40 Ungnad, 1. c. p. 77, called attention to this name, but failed to draw the conclusion that *Ḥu(m)baba* therefore belongs to the West and not to the East.
- 41 First pointed out by Ungnad in *OLZ* 1910, p. 306, on the basis of *CT XVIII*, 30, 10, where *En-gi-dú* appears in the column furnishing *phonetic* readings.
- 42 See Clay *Amurru*, pp. 74, 129, etc.
- 43 Tablet I, 2, 39–40; 3, 6–7 and 33–34; 4, 3–4.
- 44 Tablet I, 2, 1 and IX, 2, 16. Note also the statement about Gilgamesh that “his body is flesh of the gods” (Tablet IX, 2, 14; X, 1, 7).
- 45 *BOR IV*, p. 264.
- 46 Lewin, *Die Scholien des Theodor bar Koni zur Patriarchengeschichte* (Berlin, 1905), p. 2. See Gressmann in Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos*, p. 83, who points out that the first element of גלמגוס compared with the second of גמגמוס gives the exact form that we require, namely, Gilgames.
- 47 Tablet I, col. 2, is taken up with this episode.
- 48 See Poebel, *Historical and Grammatical Texts*, p. 123.
- 49 See Poebel, *Historical Texts* No. 2, col. 2, 26.
- 50 Hilprecht, *Old Babylonian Inscriptions I*, 1 No. 26.

- 51 Delitzsch, *Assyrische Lesestücke*, p. 88, VI, 2–3. Cf. also *CT XXV*, 28(K 7659) 3, where we must evidently supply [Esigga]-tuk, for which in the following line we have again Gish-bil-gamash as an equivalent. See Meissner, *OLZ* 1910, 99.
- 52 See, e.g., Barton, *Haverford Collection* II No. 27, Col. I, 14, etc.
- 53 Deimel, *Pantheon Babylonicum*, p. 95.
- 54 *CT XII*, 50 (K 4359) obv. 17.
- 55 See Barton, *Origin and Development of Babylonian Writing*, II, p. 99 *seq.*, for various explanations, though all centering around the same idea of the picture of fire in some form.
- 56 See the passages quoted by Poebel, *Historical and Grammatical Texts*, p. 126.
- 57 E.g., Genesis 4, 20, Jubal, “the father of tent-dwelling and cattle holding;” Jubal (4, 21), “the father of harp and pipe striking.”
- 58 See particularly the plays (in the J. Document) upon the names of the twelve sons of Jacob, which are brought forward either as tribal characteristics, or as suggested by some incident or utterance by the mother at the birth of each son.
- 59 The designation is variously explained by Arabic writers. See Beidhawi’s *Commentary* (ed. Fleischer), to *Súra* 18, 82.
- 60 The writing Gish-gi-mash as an approach to the pronunciation Gilgamesh would thus represent the beginning of the artificial process which seeks to interpret the first syllable as “hero.”
- 61 See above, [p. 27](#).
- 62 Poebel, *Historical Texts*, p. 115 *seq.*
- 63 Many years ago (*BA III*, p. 376) I equated Etana with Ethan in the Old Testament—therefore a West Semitic name.
- 64 See Clay, *The Empire of the Amorites*, p. 80.
- 65 Professor Clay strongly favors an Amoritic origin also for Gilgamesh. His explanation of the name is set forth in his recent work on *The Empire of the Amorites*, page 89, and is also referred to in his work on *Amurru*, page 79, and in his volume of *Miscellaneous Inscriptions in the Yale Babylonian Collection*, page 3, note. According to Professor Clay the original form of the hero’s name was West Semitic, and was something like *Bilga-Mash*, the meaning of which was perhaps “the offspring of Mash.” For the first element in this division of the name cf. *Piliqam*, the name of a ruler of an early dynasty, and *Balak* of the Old Testament. In view of the fact that the axe figures so prominently in the Epic as an instrument wielded by Gilgamesh, Professor Clay furthermore thinks it

reasonable to assume that the name was interpreted by the Babylonian scribe as “the axe of Mash.” In this way he would account for the use of the determinative for weapons, which is also the sign Gish, in the name. It is certainly noteworthy that the ideogram Gish-Tún in the later form of *Gish-Tún-mash* = *pašu*, “axe,” *CT* XVI, 38:14b, etc. *Tun* also = *pilaķu* “axe,” *CT* xii, 10:34b. Names with similar element (besides *Piliķam*) are *Belakū* of the Hammurabi period, *Bilaķķu* of the Cassite period, etc.

It is only proper to add that Professor Jastrow assumes the responsibility for the explanation of the form and etymology of the name Gilgamesh proposed in this volume. The question is one in regard to which legitimate differences of opinion will prevail among scholars until through some chance a definite decision, one way or the other, can be reached.

⁶⁶ *me-iķ-rù* (line 191).

⁶⁷ Tablet I, 5, 23. Cf. I, 3, 2 and 29.

⁶⁸ Tablet IV, 4, 7 and I, 5, 3.

⁶⁹ Assyrian version, Tablet II, 3b 34, in an address of Shamash to Enkidu.

⁷⁰ So Assyrian version, Tablet VIII, 3, 11. Also supplied VIII, 5, 20 and 21; and X, 1, 46–47 and 5, 6–7.

⁷¹ Tablet XII, 3, 25.

⁷² Ward, *Seal Cylinders of Western Asia*, Chap. X, and the same author’s *Cylinders and other Ancient Oriental Seals*—Morgan collection Nos. 19–50.

⁷³ E.g., Ward No. 192, Enkidu has human legs like Gilgamesh; also No. 189, where it is difficult to say which is Gilgamesh, and which is Enkidu. The clothed one is probably Gilgamesh, though not infrequently Gilgamesh is also represented as nude, or merely with a girdle around his waist.

⁷⁴ E.g., Ward, Nos. 173, 174, 190, 191, 195 as well as 189 and 192.

⁷⁵ On the other hand, in Ward Nos. 459 and 461, the conflict between the two heroes is depicted with the heroes distinguished in more conventional fashion, Enkidu having the hoofs of an animal, and also with a varying arrangement of beard and hair.

⁷⁶ See Jastrow, *Religion of Babylonia and Assyria* (Boston, 1898), p. 468 seq.

⁷⁷ Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos*, p. 90 seq.

⁷⁸ Pennsylvania tablet, l. 198 = Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 2, 37.

⁷⁹ “Enkidu blocked the gate” (Pennsylvania tablet, line 215) = Assyrian version Tablet IV, 2, 46: “Enkidu interposed his foot at the gate of the family house.”

- 80 Pennsylvania tablet, lines 218 and 224.
- 81 Yale tablet, line 198; also to be supplied lines 13–14.
- 82 Yale tablet, lines 190 and 191.
- 83 PSBA 1914, 65 *seq.* = Jensen III, 1^a, 4–11, which can now be completed and supplemented by the new fragment.
- 84 I.e., Enkidu will save Gilgamesh.
- 85 These two lines impress one as popular sayings—here applied to Enkidu.
- 86 King’s fragment, col. I, 13–27, which now enables us to complete Jensen III, 1^a, 12–21.
- 87 Yale tablet, lines [252–253](#).
- 88 Yale tablet, lines 143–148 = Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 6, 26 *seq.*
- 89 Assyrian version, Tablet III, 2^a, 13–14.
- 90 Lines 215–222.
- 91 Assyrian version, Tablet V, Columns 3–4. We have to assume that in line 13 of column 4 (Jensen, p. 164), Enkidu takes up the thread of conversation, as is shown by line 22: “Enkidu brought his dream to him and spoke to Gilgamesh.”
- 92 Assyrian version, Tablet VI, lines 146–147.
- 93 Lines 178–183.
- 94 Lines 176–177.
- 95 Tablet VII, Column 6.
- 96 Assyrian version, Tablet VI, 200–203. These words are put into the mouth of Gilgamesh (lines 198–199). It is, therefore, unlikely that he would sing his own praise. Both Jensen and Ungnad admit that Enkidu is to be supplied in at least one of the lines.
- 97 Lines 109 and 112.
- 98 Assyrian version, Tablet IX, 1, 8–9.
- 99 Tablet VIII, 5, 2–6.
- 100 So also Gressmann in Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos*, p. 97, regards Enkidu as the older figure.
- 101 See Jastrow, *Adam and Eve in Babylonian Literature*, *AJSL*, Vol. 15, pp. 193–214.

- 102 Assyrian version, Tablet I, 2, 31–36.
- 103 It will be recalled that Enkidu is always spoken of as “born in the field.”
- 104 Note the repetition *ibtani* “created” in line 33 of the “man of Anu” and in line 35 of the offspring of Ninib. The creation of the former is by the “heart,” i.e., by the will of Aruru, the creation of the latter is an act of moulding out of clay.
- 105 Tablet I, Column 3.
- 106 Following as usual the enumeration of lines in Jensen’s edition.
- 107 An analogy does not involve a dependence of one tale upon the other, but merely that both rest on similar traditions, which *may* have arisen independently.
- 108 Note that the name of Eve is not mentioned till after the fall (Genesis 3, 20). Before that she is merely *ishsha*, i.e., “woman,” just as in the Babylonian tale the woman who guides Enkidu is *ḥarimtu*, “woman.”
- 109 “And he drank and became drunk” (Genesis 9, 21).
- 110 “His heart became glad and his face shone” (Pennsylvania Tablet, lines 100–101).
- 111 That in the combination of this Enkidu with tales of primitive man, inconsistent features should have been introduced, such as the union of Enkidu with the woman as the beginning of a higher life, whereas the presence of a hunter and his father shows that human society was already in existence, is characteristic of folk-tales, which are indifferent to details that may be contradictory to the general setting of the story.
- 112 Pennsylvania tablet, lines 102–104.
- 113 Line 105.
- 114 Tablet I, 1, 9. See also the reference to the wall of Erech as an “old construction” of Gilgamesh, in the inscription of An-Am in the days of Sin-gamil (Hilprecht, *Old Babylonian Inscriptions*, I, No. 26.) Cf IV R² 52, 3, 53.
- 115 The invariable designation in the Assyrian version as against *Uruk ribîtim*, “Erech of the plazas,” in the old Babylonian version.
- 116 In Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos*, p. 123 seq.
- 117 See Jensen, p. 266. Gilgamesh is addressed as “judge,” as the one who inspects the divisions of the earth, precisely as Shamash is celebrated. In line 8 of the hymn in question, Gilgamesh is in fact addressed as Shamash.

The darkness is emphasized with each advance in the hero’s wanderings (Tablet IX, col. 5).

- 118 119 This tale is again a nature myth, marking the change from the dry to the rainy season. The Deluge is an annual occurrence in the Euphrates Valley through the overflow of the two rivers. Only the canal system, directing the overflow into the fields, changed the curse into a blessing. In contrast to the Deluge, we have in the Assyrian creation story the drying up of the primeval waters so that the earth makes its appearance with the change from the rainy to the dry season. The world is created in the spring, according to the Akkadian view which is reflected in the Biblical creation story, as related in the P. document. See Jastrow, *Sumerian and Akkadian Views of Beginnings* (JAOS, Vol 36, p. 295 seq.).
- 120 Aš-am in Sumerian corresponding to the Akkadian Šabaṭu, which conveys the idea of destruction.
- 121 The month is known as the “Mission of Ishtar” in Sumerian, in allusion to another nature myth which describes Ishtar’s disappearance from earth and her mission to the lower world.
- 122 *Historical Texts* No. 1. The Sumerian name of the survivor is Zi-ū-gíd-du or perhaps Zi-ū-sū-du (cf. King, *Legends of Babylon and Egypt*, p. 65, note 4), signifying “He who lengthened the day of life,” i.e., the one of long life, of which Ut-napishtim (“Day of Life”) in the Assyrian version seems to be an abbreviated Akkadian rendering, with the omission of the verb. So King’s view, which is here followed. See also CT XVIII, 30, 9, and Langdon, *Sumerian Epic of Paradise*, p. 90, who, however, enters upon further speculations that are fanciful.
- 123 See the translation in Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos*, pp. 69, seq. and 73.
- 124 According to Professor Clay, quite certainly Amurru, just as in the case of Enkidu.
- 125 Gressmann in Ungnad-Gressmann, *Das Gilgamesch-Epos*, p. 100 seq. touches upon this *motif*, but fails to see the main point that the companions are also twins or at least brothers. Hence such examples as Abraham and Lot, David and Jonathan, Achilles and Patroclus, Eteokles and Polyneikes, are not parallels to Gilgamesh-Enkidu, but belong to the *enlargement* of the *motif* so as to include companions who are *not* regarded as brothers.
- 126 Or Romus. See Rendell Harris, l. c., p. 59, note 2.
- 127 One might also include the primeval pair Yama-Yami with their equivalents in Iranian mythology (Carnoy, *Iranian Mythology*, p. 294 seq.).
- 128 Becoming, however, a triad and later increased to seven. Cf. Rendell Harris, l. c., p. 32.
- 129 I am indebted to my friend, Professor A. J. Carnoy, of the University of Louvain, for having kindly gathered and placed at my disposal material on the “twin-brother” *motif* from Indo-European sources, supplemental to Rendell Harris’ work.

- 130 On the other hand, *Uruk mâtum* for the district of Erech, i.e., the territory over which the city holds sway, appears in both versions (Pennsylvania tablet, 1. 10 = Assyrian version I, 5, 36).
- 131 “My likeness” (line 27). It should be noted, however, that lines 32–44 of I, 5, in Jensen’s edition are part of a fragment K 9245 (not published, but merely copied by Bezold and Johns, and placed at Jensen’s disposal), which may represent a *duplicate* to I, 6, 23–34, with which it agrees entirely except for one line, viz., line 34 of K 9245 which is not found in column 6, 23–34. If this be correct, then there is lacking after line 31 of column 5, the interpretation of the dream given in the Pennsylvania tablet in lines 17–23.
- 132 *ina šap-li-ki*, literally, “below thee,” whereas in the old Babylonian version we have *ana ši-ri-ka*, “towards thee.”
- 133 Repeated I, 6, 28.
- 134 *ul-tap-rid ki-is-su-šú-ma*. The verb is from *parâdu*, “violent.” For *kissu*, “strong,” see CT XVI, 25, 48–49. Langdon (*Gilgamesh Epic*, p. 211, note 5) renders the phrase: “he shook his murderous weapon!!”—another illustration of his haphazard way of translating texts.
- 135 Shown by the colophon (Jeremias, *Izdubar-Nimrod*, Plate IV.)
- 136 Lines 42–43 must be taken as part of the narrative of the compiler, who tells us that after the woman had informed Enkidu that Gilgamesh already knew of Enkidu’s coming through dreams interpreted by Ninsun, Gilgamesh actually set out and encountered Enkidu.
- 137 Tablet I, col. 4. See also above, [p. 19](#).
- 138 IV, 2, 44–50. The word *ullanum*, (l.43) “once” or “since,” points to the following being a reference to a former recital, and not an original recital.
- 139 Only the lower half (Haupt’s edition, p. 82) is preserved.
- 140 “The eyes of Enkidu were filled with tears,” corresponding to IV, 4, 10.
- 141 Unless indeed the number “seven” is a slip for the sign *ša*. See the commentary to the line.

Pennsylvania Tablet

The 240 lines of the six columns of the text are enumerated in succession, with an indication on the margin where a new column begins. This method, followed also in the case of the Yale tablet, seems preferable to Langdon's breaking up of the text into Obverse and Reverse, with a separate enumeration for each of the six columns. In order, however, to facilitate a comparison with Langdon's edition, a table is added:

Obverse Col.	I, 1	= Line	1 of our text.
„	I, 5	= „	5 „ „ „
„	I, 10	= „	10 „ „ „
„	I, 15	= „	15 „ „ „
„	I, 20	= „	20 „ „ „
„	I, 25	= „	25 „ „ „
„	I, 30	= „	30 „ „ „
„	I, 35	= „	35 „ „ „
Col.	II, 1	= Line	41 „ „ „
„	II, 5	= „	45 „ „ „
„	II, 10	= „	50 „ „ „
„	II, 15	= „	55 „ „ „
„	II, 20	= „	60 „ „ „
„	II, 25	= „	65 „ „ „
„	II, 30	= „	70 „ „ „
„	II, 35	= „	75 „ „ „
Col.	III, 1	= Line	81 „ „ „
„	III, 5	= „	85 „ „ „
„	III, 10	= „	90 „ „ „
„	III, 15	= „	95 „ „ „

„	III, 26	= „	100 „ „ „
„	III, 25	= „	105 „ „ „
„	III, 30	= „	110 „ „ „
„	III, 35	= „	115 „ „ „
Reverse Col.	I, 1 (= Col. IV)	= Line	131 of our text.
„	I, 5	= „	135 „ „ „
„	I, 10	= „	140 „ „ „
„	I, 15	= „	145 „ „ „
„	I, 20	= „	150 „ „ „
„	I, 25	= „	155 „ „ „
„	I, 30	= „	160 „ „ „
„	II, 1 (= Col. V)	= Line	171 „ „ „
„	II, 5	= „	175 „ „ „
„	II, 10	= „	180 „ „ „
„	II, 15	= „	185 „ „ „
„	II, 20	= „	190 „ „ „
„	II, 25	= „	195 „ „ „
„	II, 30	= „	200 „ „ „
„	III, 1 (= Col. VI)	= Line	208 „ „ „
„	III, 5	= „	212 „ „ „
„	III, 10	= „	217 „ „ „
„	III, 15	= „	222 „ „ „
„	III, 20	= „	227 „ „ „
„	III, 25	= „	232 „ „ „
„	III, 30	= „	237 „ „ „
„	III, 33	= „	240 „ „ „

Pennsylvania Tablet.

Transliteration.

Col. I.

1it-bi-e-ma ^dGiš šú-na-tam i-pa-áš-šar
2iz-za-kàr-am a-na um-mi-šú
3um-mi i-na šá-at mu-ši-ti-ia
4šá-am-ḥa-ku-ma at-ta-na-al-la-ak
5i-na bi-ri-it it-lu-tim
6ib-ba-šú-nim-ma ka-ka-bu šá-ma-i
7[ki]-iṣ-rù šá A-nim im-ḫu-ut a-na ṣi-ri-ia
8áš-ši-šú-ma ik-ta-bi-it e-li-ia
9ú-ni-iš-šú-ma nu-uš-šá-šú ú-ul il-ti-'i
10Uruk^{ki} ma-tum pa-ḥi-ir e-li-šú
11it-lu-tum ú-na-šá-ku ši-pi-šú
12ú-um-mi-id-ma pu-ti
13i-mi-du ia-ti
14áš-ši-a-šú-ma ab-ba-la-áš-šú a-na ṣi-ri-ki
15um-mi ^dGiš mu-di-a-at ka-la-ma
16iz-za-kàr-am a-na ^dGiš
17mi-in-di ^dGiš šá ki-ma ka-ti
18i-na ṣi-ri i-wa-li-id-ma
19ú-ra-ab-bi-šú šá-du-ú
20ta-mar-šú-ma [kima Sal(?)] ta-ḥa-du at-ta

21it-lu-tum ú-na-šá-ku ši-pi-šú
22tí-iṭ-ṭi-ra-áš-[šú tu-ut]-tu-ú-ma
23ta-tar-ra-[as-su] a-na ši-[ri]-ia
24[uš]-ti-nim-ma i-ta-mar šá-ni-tam
25[šú-na]-ta i-ta-wa-a-am a-na um-mi-šú
26[um-mi] a-ta-mar šá-ni-tam
27[šú-na-tu a-ta]-mar e-mi-a i-na su-ḫi-im
28[šá Uruk]^{ki} ri-bi-tim
29ḫa-aṣ-ṣi-nu na-di-i-ma
30e-li-šú pa-aḫ-ru
31ḫa-aṣ-ṣi-nu-um-ma šá-ni bu-nu-šú
32a-mur-šú-ma aḫ-ta-du a-na-ku
33a-ra-am-šú-ma ki-ma áš-šá-tim
34a-ḫa-ab-bu-ub el-šú
35el-ki-šú-ma áš-ta-ka-an-šú
36a-na a-ḫi-ia
37um-mi ^dGiš mu-da-at [ka]-la-ma
38[iz-za-kàr-am a-na ^dGiš]
39[^dGiš šá ta-mu-ru amêlu]
40[ta-ḫa-ab-bu-ub ki-ma áš-šá-tim el-šú]

Col. II.

41áš-šum uš-[ta]-ma-ḫa-ru it-ti-ka
42^dGiš šú-na-tam i-pa-šar
43^dEn-ki-[dũ wa]-ši-ib ma-ḫar ḫa-ri-im-tim
44ur-[šá ir]-ḫa-mu di-da-šá(?) ip-tí-[e]
45[^dEn-ki]-dũ im-ta-ši a-šar i-wa-al-du
46ûm, 6 ù 7 mu-ši-a-tim
47^dEn-[ki-dũ] ti-bi-i-ma
48šá-[am-ka-ta] ir-ḫi

49ḥa-[ri-im-tum pa-a]-šá i-pu-šá-am-ma
 50iz-za-[kàr-am] a-na ^dEn-ki-dū
 51a-na-tal-ka ^dEn-ki-dū ki-ma ili ta-ba-áš-ši
 52am-mi-nim it-ti na-ma-áš-te-e
 53ta-at-ta-[na-al]-ak ši-ra-am
 54al-kam lu-úr-di-ka
 55a-na libbi [Uruk^{ki}] ri-bi-tim
 56a-na bît [el]-lim mu-šá-bi šá A-nim
 57^dEn-ki-dū ti-bi lu-ru-ka
 58a-na Ê-[an]-na mu-šá-bi šá A-nim
 59a-šar [^dGiš gi]-it-ma-[lu] ne-pi-ši-tim
 60ù at-[ta] ki-[ma Sal ta-ḥa]-bu-[ub]-šú
 61ta-[ra-am-šú ki-ma] ra-ma-an-ka
 62al-ka ti-ba i-[na] ga-ag-ga-ri
 63ma-a-ag-ri-i-im
 64iš-me a-wa-as-sa im-ta-ḥar ga-ba-šá
 65mi-il-[kum] šá aššatim
 66im-ta-ḫu-ut a-na libbi-šú
 67iš-ḫu-ut li-ib-šá-am
 68iš-ti-nam ú-la-ab-bi-iš-sú
 69li-ib-[šá-am] šá-ni-a-am
 70ši-i it-ta-al-ba-áš
 71ša-ab-tat ga-as-su
 72ki-ma [ili] i-ri-id-di-šú
 73a-na gu-up-ri šá-ri-i-im
 74a-šar tar-ba-ši-im
 75i-na [áš]-ri-šú [im]-ḫu-ruri-ia-ú
 76[ù šú-u ^dEn-ki-dū i-lit-ta-šú šá-du-um-ma]
 77[it-ti šabâti-ma ik-ka-la šam-ma]
 78[it-ti bu-lim maš-ḫa-a i-šat-ti]
 79[it-ti na-ma-áš-te-e mê i-ṭab lib-ba-šú]

(Perhaps one additional line missing.)

Col. III.

81ši-iz-ba šá na-ma-áš-te-e
82i-te-en-ni-ik
83a-ka-lam iš-ku-nu ma-ḥar-šú
84ib-tí-ik-ma i-na-at-tal
85ù ip-pa-al-la-as
86ú-ul i-di ^dEn-ki-dū
87aklam a-na a-ka-lim
88šikaram a-na šá-te-e-im
89la-a lum-mu-ud
90ḥa-ri-im-tum pi-šá i-pu-šá-am-ma
91iz-za-kàr-am a-na ^dEn-ki-dū
92a-ku-ul ak-lam ^dEn-ki-dū
93zi-ma-at ba-la-ṭi-im
94šikaram ši-ti ši-im-ti ma-ti
95i-ku-ul a-ak-lam ^dEn-ki-dū
96a-di ši-bi-e-šú
97šikaram iš-ti-a-am
987 aš-ša-am-mi-im
99it-tap-šar kab-ta-tum i-na-an-gu
100i-li-iš libba-šú-ma
101pa-nu-šú [it]-tam-ru
102ul-tap-pi-it [^{lù}ŠÚ]-I
103šú-ḥu-ra-am pa-ga-ar-šú
104šá-am-nam ip-ta-šá-áš-ma
105a-we-li-iš i-we
106il-ba-áš li-ib-šá-am
107ki-ma mu-ti i-ba-áš-ši
108il-ki ka-ak-ka-šú
109la-bi ú-gi-ir-ri

110uš-sa-ak-pu re'ûti mu-ši-a-tim
111ut-tap-pi-iš šib-ba-ri
112la-bi uk-ta-ši-id
113it-ti-[lu] na-ki-[di-e] ra-bu-tum
114^dEn-ki-dū ma-aš-ša-ar-šú-nu
115a-we-lum giš-ru-um
116iš-te-en it-lum
117a-na [na-ki-di-e(?) i]-za-ak-ki-ir

(About five lines missing.)

Col. IV.

(About eight lines missing.)

131i-ip-pu-uš ul-ša-am
132iš-ši-ma i-ni-i-šú
133i-ta-mar a-we-lam
134iz-za-kàr-am a-na ḥarimtim
135šá-am-ka-at uk-ki-ši a-we-lam
136a-na mi-nim il-li-kam
137zi-ki-ir-šú lu-uš-šú
138ḥa-ri-im-tum iš-ta-si a-we-lam
139i-ba-uš-su-um-ma i-ta-mar-šú
140e-di-il e-eš ta-ḥi-[il-la]-am
141lim-nu a-la-ku ma-na-aḥ-[ti]-ka
142e-pi-šú i-pu-šá-am-ma
143iz-za-kàr-am a-na ^dEn-[ki-dū]
144bi-ti-iš e-mu-tim ik
145ši-ma-a-at ni-ši-i-ma
146tu-a(?) -ar e-lu-tim
147a-na âli(?) dup-šak-ki-i e-ši-en

148uk-la-at âli(?) e-mi-sa a-a-ḥa-tim
149a-na šarri šá Uruk^{ki} ri-bi-tim
150pi-ti pu-uk epiši(-ši) a-na ḥa-a-a-ri
151a-na ^dGiš šarri šá Uruk^{ki} ri-bi-tim
152pi-ti pu-uk epiši(-ši)
153a-na ḥa-a-a-ri
154áš-ša-at ši-ma-tim i-ra-aḥ-ḥi
155šú-ú pa-na-nu-um-ma
156mu-uk wa-ar-ka-nu
157i-na mi-il-ki šá ili ga-bi-ma
158i-na bi-ti-iḫ a-bu-un-na-ti-šú
159ši-ma-as-su
160a-na zi-ik-ri it-li-im
161i-ri-ku pa-nu-šú

(About three lines missing.)

Col. V.

(About six lines missing.)

171i-il-la-ak [^dEn-ki-dū i-na pa-ni]
172u-šá-am-ka-at [wa]-ar-ki-šú
173i-ru-ub-ma a-na libbi Uruk^{ki} ri-bi-tim
174ip-ḥur um-ma-nu-um i-na ši-ri-šú
175iz-zi-za-am-ma i-na su-ḫi-im
176šá Uruk^{ki} ri-bi-tim
177pa-aḥ-ra-a-ma ni-šú
178i-ta-wa-a i-na ši-ri-šú
179a-na ṣalam ^dGiš ma-ši-il pi-it-tam
180la-nam šá-pi-il

181si-ma [šá-ki-i pu]-uk-ku-ul
 182..... i-pa-ka-du
 183i-[na mâti da-an e-mu]-ki i-wa
 184ši-iz-ba šá na-ma-aš-te-e
 185i-te-en-ni-ik
 186ka-a-a-na i-na [libbi] Uruk^{ki} kak-ki-a-tum
 187it-lu-tum ú-te-el-li-lu
 188šá-ki-in ur-šá-nu
 189a-na itli šá i-šá-ru zi-mu-šú
 190a-na ^dGiš ki-ma i-li-im
 191šá-ki-iš-šum me-iḫ-rù
 192a-na ^dIš-ḫa-ra ma-a-a-lum
 193na-di-i-ma
 194^dGiš it-[ti-il-ma wa-ar-ka-tim]
 195i-na mu-ši in-ni-[ib-bi]-it
 196i-na-ag-šá-am-ma
 197it-ta-[zi-iz dEn-ki-dū] i-na sūḫim
 198ip-ta-ra-[aṣ a-la]-ak-tam
 199šá ^dGiš
 200[a-na e-pi-iš] da-na-ni-iš-šú

(About three lines missing.)

Col. VI.

(About four lines missing.)

208šar(?)-ḫa
 209^dGiš ...
 210i-na ṣi-ri-[šú il-li-ka-am ^dEn-ki-dū]
 211i-ḫa-an-ni-ib [pi-ir-ta-šú]

212it-bi-ma [il-li-ik]
213a-na pa-ni-šú
214it-tam-ḥa-ru i-na ri-bi-tum ma-ti
215^dEn-ki-dū ba-ba-am ip-ta-ri-ik
216i-na ši-pi-šú
217^dGiš e-ri-ba-am ú-ul id-di-in
218iṣ-ša-ab-tu-ma ki-ma li-i-im
219i-lu-du
220zi-ip-pa-am 'i-bu-tu
221i-ga-rum ir-tu-tu
222^dGiš ù ^dEn-ki-dū
223iṣ-ša-ab-tu-ú-ma
224ki-ma li-i-im i-lu-du
225zi-ip-pa-am 'i-bu-tu
226i-ga-rum ir-tu-tú
227ik-mi-is-ma ^dGiš
228i-na ga-ag-ga-ri ši-ip-šú
229ip-ši-iḥ uz-za-šú-ma
230i-ni-iḥ i-ra-as-su
231iš-tu i-ra-su i-ni-ḥu
232^dEn-ki-dū a-na šá-ši-im
233iz-za-kàr-am a-na ^dGiš
234ki-ma iš-te-en-ma um-ma-ka
235ú-li-id-ka
236ri-im-tum šá su-pu-ri
237^dNin-sun-na
238ul-lu e-li mu-ti ri-eš-ka
239šar-ru-tú šá ni-ši
240i-ši-im-kum ^dEn-lil
241 duppu 2 kam-ma
242šú-tu-ur e-li
243 4 šú-ši

Translation.

Col. I.

1Gish sought to interpret the dream;
2Spoke to his mother:
3“My mother, during my night
4I became strong and moved about
5among the heroes;
6And from the starry heaven
7A meteor(?) of Anu fell upon me:
8I bore it and it grew heavy upon me,
9I became weak and its weight I could not endure.
10The land of Erech gathered about it.
11The heroes kissed its feet.¹
12It was raised up before me.
13They stood me up.²
14I bore it and carried it to thee.”
15The mother of Gish, who knows all things,
16Spoke to Gish:
17“Some one, O Gish, who like thee
18In the field was born and
19Whom the mountain has reared,
20Thou wilt see (him) and [like a woman(?)] thou wilt
rejoice.
21Heroes will kiss his feet.
22Thou wilt spare [him and wilt endeavor]
23To lead him to me.”
24He slept and saw another

25 Dream, which he reported to his mother:
26 [“My mother,] I have seen another
27 [Dream.] My likeness I have seen in the streets
28 [Of Erech] of the plazas.
29 An axe was brandished, and
30 They gathered about him;
31 And the axe made him angry.
32 I saw him and I rejoiced,
33 I loved him as a woman,
34 I embraced him.
35 I took him and regarded him
36 As my brother.”
37 The mother of Gish, who knows all things,
38 [Spoke to Gish]:
39 [“O Gish, the man whom thou sawest,
40 [Whom thou didst embrace like a woman].

Col II.

41 (means) that he is to be associated with thee.”
42 Gish understood the dream.
43 [As] Enki[du] was sitting before the woman,
44 [Her] loins(?) he embraced, her vagina(?) he opened.
45 [Enkidu] forgot the place where he was born.
46 Six days and seven nights
47 Enkidu continued
48 To cohabit with [the courtesan].
49 [The woman] opened her [mouth] and
50 Spoke to Enkidu:
51 “I gaze upon thee, O Enkidu, like a god art thou!
52 Why with the cattle

53Dost thou [roam] across the field?
54Come, let me lead thee
55into [Erech] of the plazas,
56to the holy house, the dwelling of Anu,
57O, Enkidu arise, let me conduct thee
58To Eanna, the dwelling of Anu,
59The place [where Gish is, perfect] in vitality.
60And thou [like a wife wilt embrace] him.
61Thou [wilt love him like] thyself.
62Come, arise from the ground
63(that is) cursed.”
64He heard her word and accepted her speech.
65The counsel of the woman
66Entered his heart.
67She stripped off a garment,
68Clothed him with one.
69Another garment
70She kept on herself.
71She took hold of his hand.
72Like [a god(?)] she brought him
73To the fertile meadow,
74The place of the sheepfolds.
75In that place they received food;
76[For he, Enkidu, whose birthplace was the
mountain,]
77[With the gazelles he was accustomed to eat herbs,]
78[With the cattle to drink water,]
79[With the water beings he was happy.]

(Perhaps one additional line missing.)

Col. III.

81Milk of the cattle
82He was accustomed to suck.
83Food they placed before him,
84He broke (it) off and looked
85And gazed.
86Enkidu had not known
87To eat food.
88To drink wine
89He had not been taught.
90The woman opened her mouth and
91Spoke to Enkidu:
92“Eat food, O Enkidu,
93The provender of life!
94Drink wine, the custom of the land!”
95Enkidu ate food
96Till he was satiated.
97Wine he drank,
98Seven goblets.
99His spirit was loosened, he became hilarious.
100His heart became glad and
101His face shone.
102[The barber(?)] removed
103The hair on his body.
104He was anointed with oil.
105He became manlike.
106He put on a garment,
107He was like a man.
108He took his weapon;
109Lions he attacked,
110(so that) the night shepherds could rest.
111He plunged the dagger;
112Lions he overcame.
113The great [shepherds] lay down;

114 Enkidu was their protector.
115 The strong man,
116 The unique hero,
117 To [the shepherds(?)] he speaks:

(About five lines missing.)

Col. IV.

(About eight lines missing.)

131 Making merry.
132 He lifted up his eyes,
133 He sees the man.
134 He spoke to the woman:
135 “O, courtesan, lure on the man.
136 Why has he come to me?
137 His name I will destroy.”
138 The woman called to the man
139 Who approaches to him³ and he beholds him.
140 “Away! why dost thou [quake(?)]
141 Evil is the course of thy activity.”⁴
142 Then he⁵ opened his mouth and
143 Spoke to Enkidu:
144 “[To have (?)] a family home
145 Is the destiny of men, and
146 The prerogative(?) of the nobles.
147 For the city(?) load the workbaskets!
148 Food supply for the city lay to one side!
149 For the King of Erech of the plazas,
150 Open the hymen(?), perform the marriage act!
151 For Gish, the King of Erech of the plazas,

152Open the hymen(?),
153Perform the marriage act!
154With the legitimate wife one should cohabit.
155So before,
156As well as in the future.⁶
157By the decree pronounced by a god,
158From the cutting of his umbilical cord
159(Such) is his fate.”
160At the speech of the hero
161His face grew pale.

(About three lines missing.)

Col. V.

(About six lines missing.)

171[Enkidu] went [in front],
172And the courtesan behind him.
173He entered into Erech of the plazas.
174The people gathered about him.
175As he stood in the streets
176Of Erech of the plazas,
177The men gathered,
178Saying in regard to him:
179“Like the form of Gish he has suddenly become;
180shorter in stature.
181[In his structure high(?)], powerful,
182..... overseeing(?)
183In the land strong of power has he become.
184Milk of cattle
185He was accustomed to suck.”

186Steadily(?) in Erech
187The heroes rejoiced.
188He became a leader.
189To the hero of fine appearance,
190To Gish, like a god,
191He became a rival to him.⁷
192For Ishhara a couch
193Was stretched, and
194Gish [lay down, and afterwards(?)]
195In the night he fled.
196He approaches and
197[Enkidu stood] in the streets.
198He blocked the path
199of Gish.
200At the exhibit of his power,

(About three lines missing.)

Col. VI.

(About four lines missing.)

208Strong(?) ...
209Gish
210Against him [Enkidu proceeded],
211[His hair] luxuriant.
212He started [to go]
213Towards him.
214They met in the plaza of the district.
215Enkidu blocked the gate
216With his foot,
217Not permitting Gish to enter.

218 They seized (each other), like oxen,
 219 They fought.
 220 The threshold they demolished;
 221 The wall they impaired.
 222 Gish and Enkidu
 223 Seized (each other).
 224 Like oxen they fought.
 225 The threshold they demolished;
 226 The wall they impaired.
 227 Gish bent
 228 His foot to the ground,⁸
 229 His wrath was appeased,
 230 His breast was quieted.
 231 When his breast was quieted,
 232 Enkidu to him
 233 Spoke, to Gish:
 234 “As a unique one, thy mother
 235 bore thee.
 236 The wild cow of the stall,⁹
 237 Ninsun,
 238 Has exalted thy head above men.
 239 Kingship over men
 240 Enlil has decreed for thee.
 241 Second tablet,
 242 enlarged beyond [the original(?)].
 243 240 lines.

1 I.e., paid homage to the meteor.

2 I.e., the heroes of Erech raised me to my feet, or perhaps in the sense of “supported me.”

3 I.e., Enkidu.

4 I.e., “thy way of life.”

5 I.e., the man.

- 6 I.e., an idiomatic phrase meaning “for all times.”
- 7 I.e., Enkidu became like Gish, godlike. Cf. col. 2, 11.
- 8 He was thrown and therefore vanquished.
- 9 Epithet given to Ninsun. See the commentary to the line.

Commentary on the Pennsylvania Tablet.

[Line 1.](#) The verb *tibû* with *pašâru* expresses the aim of Gish to secure an interpretation for his dream. This disposes of Langdon's note 1 on page 211 of his edition, in which he also erroneously speaks of our text as "late." *Pašâru* is not a variant of *zakâru*. Both verbs occur just as here in the Assyrian version I, 5, 25.

[Line 3.](#) *ina šât mušitia*, "in this my night," i.e., in the course of this night of mine. A curious way of putting it, but the expression occurs also in the Assyrian version, e.g., I, 5, 26 (parallel passage to ours) and II, 4^a, 14. In the Yale tablet we find, similarly, *mu-ši-it-ka* (l. 262), "thy night," i.e., "at night to thee."

[Line 5.](#) Before Langdon put down the strange statement of Gish "wandering about in the midst of omens" (misreading *id-da-tim* for *it-lu-tim*), he might have asked himself the question, what it could possibly mean. How can one walk among omens?

[Line 6.](#) *ka-ka-bu šá-ma-i* must be taken as a compound term for "starry heaven." The parallel passage in the Assyrian version (Tablet I, 5, 27) has the ideograph for star, with the plural sign as a variant. Literally, therefore, "The starry heaven (or "the stars in heaven") was there," etc. Langdon's note 2 on page 211 rests on an erroneous reading.

[Line 7.](#) *kišru šá Anim*, "mass of Anu," appears to be the designation of a meteor, which might well be described as a "mass" coming from Anu, i.e., from the god of heaven who becomes the personification of the heavens in general. In the Assyrian version (I, 5, 28) we have *kima ki-iš-rù*, i.e., "something like a mass of heaven." Note also I, 3, 16, where in a description of Gilgamesh, his strength is said to be "strong like a mass (i.e., a meteor) of heaven."

[Line 9](#). For *nuššašu ûl iltê* we have a parallel in the Hebrew phrase נִלְפָּטָנוּ וְנִשְׁפָּטָנוּ (Isaiah 1, 14).

[Line 10](#). *Uruk mâtum*, as the designation for the district of Erech, occurs in the Assyrian version, e.g., I, 5, 31, and IV, 2, 38; also to be supplied, I, 6, 23.

For *paḥir* the parallel in the Assyrian version has *iz-za-az* (I, 5, 31), but VI, 197, we find *paḥ-ru* and *paḥ-ra*.

[Line 17](#). *mi-in-di* does not mean “truly” as Langdon translates, but “some one.” It occurs also in the Assyrian version X, 1, 13, *mi-in-di-e ma-an-nu-u*, “this is some one who,” etc.

[Line 18](#). Cf. Assyrian version I, 5, 3, and IV, 4, 7, *ina širi âlid*—both passages referring to Enkidu.

[Line 21](#). Cf. Assyrian version II, 3^b, 38, with *malkê*, “kings,” as a synonym of *itlutum*.

[Line 23](#). *ta-tar-ra-as-sú* from *tarâšu*, “direct,” “guide,” etc.

[Line 24](#). I take *uš-ti-nim-ma* as III, 2, from *išênu* (׀׃), the verb underlying *šittu*, “sleep,” and *šuttu*, “dream.”

[Line 26](#). Cf. Assyrian version I, 6, 21—a complete parallel.

[Line 28](#). *Uruk ri-bi-tim*, the standing phrase in both tablets of the old Babylonian version, for which in the Assyrian version we have *Uruk su-pu-ri*. The former term suggests the “broad space” outside of the city or the “common” in a village community, while *supûri*, “enclosed,” would refer to the city within the walls. Dr. W. F. Albright (in a private communication) suggests “Erech of the plazas” as a suitable translation for *Uruk ribîtim*. A third term, *Uruk mâtum* (see above, note to line 10), though designating rather the district of which Erech was the capital, appears to be used as a synonym to *Uruk ribîtim*, as may be concluded from the phrase *i-na ri-bi-tum ma-ti* (l. 214 of the Pennsylvania tablet), which clearly means the

“plaza” of the city. One naturally thinks of רְחוֹבַת עִיר in Genesis 10, 11—the equivalent of Babylonian *ri-bi-tu âli*—which can hardly be the name of a city. It appears to be a gloss, as is הַיִּפֶּס הָעִיר הַגְּדֹלָה at the end of v. 12. The latter gloss is misplaced, since it clearly describes “Nineveh,” mentioned in v. 11. Inasmuch as רְחוֹבַת עִיר immediately follows the mention of Nineveh, it seems simplest to take the phrase as designating the “outside” or “suburbs” of the city, a complete parallel, therefore, to *ri-bi-tu mâti* in our text. Nineveh, together with the “suburbs,” forms the “great city.” *Uruk ribîtim* is, therefore, a designation for “greater Erech,” proper to a capital city, which by its gradual growth would take in more than its original confines. “Erech of the plazas” must have come to be used as a honorific designation of this important center as early as 2000 B. C., whereas later, perhaps because of its decline, the epithet no longer seemed appropriate and was replaced by the more modest designation of “walled Erech,” with an allusion to the tradition which ascribed the building of the wall of the city to Gilgamesh. At all events, all three expressions, “Erech of the plazas,” “Erech walled” and “Erech land,” are to be regarded as synonymous. The position once held by Erech follows also from its ideographic designation (Brünnow No. 4796) by the sign “house” with a “gunufied” extension, which conveys the idea of *Unu = šubtu*, or “dwelling” *par excellence*. The pronunciation Unug or Unuk (see the gloss *u-nu-uk*, VR 23, 8^a), composed of *unu*, “dwelling,” and *ki*, “place,” is hardly to be regarded as older than Uruk, which is to be resolved into *uru*, “city,” and *ki*, “place,” but rather as a play upon the name, both *Unu + ki* and *Uru + ki* conveying the same idea of the city or the dwelling place *par excellence*. As the seat of the second oldest dynasty according to Babylonian traditions (see Poebel’s list in *Historical and Grammatical Texts* No. 2), Erech no doubt was regarded as having been at one time “the city,” i.e., the capital of the entire Euphrates Valley.

[Line 31](#). A difficult line for which Langdon proposes the translation: “Another axe seemed his visage”!!—which may be picturesque, but hardly a description befitting a hero. How can a man’s face seem to be an axe? Langdon attaches *šá-ni* in the sense of “second” to the preceding word “axe,” whereas *šanî bunušu*, “change of his countenance” or “his countenance being changed,” is to be taken as a phrase to convey the idea

of “being disturbed,” “displeased” or “angry.” The phrase is of the same kind as the well-known *šunnu tēmu*, “changing of reason,” to denote “insanity.” See the passages in Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, pp. 355 and 1068. In Hebrew, too, we have the same two phrases, e.g., וַיִּשְׁנֶה פָּתָחַ (I Sam. 21, 14 = Ps. 34, 1), “and he changed his reason,” i.e., feigned insanity and הִשְׁתַּחֲוֶה פָּנָיו (Job 14, 20), “changing his face,” to indicate a radical alteration in the frame of mind. There is a still closer parallel in Biblical Aramaic: Dan. 3, 19, “The form of his visage was changed,” meaning “he was enraged.” Fortunately, the same phrase occurs also in the Yale tablet (l. 192), *šá-nu-ú bu-nu-šú*, in a connection which leaves no doubt that the aroused fury of the tyrant *Ḫuwawa* is described by it:

”*Ḫuwawa* heard and his face was changed”

precisely, therefore, as we should say—following Biblical usage—“his countenance fell.” Cf. also the phrase *pānušu arpu*, “his countenance was darkened” (Assyrian version I, 2, 48), to express “anger.” The line, therefore, in the Pennsylvania tablet must describe *Enkidu*’s anger. With the brandishing of the axe the hero’s anger was also stirred up. The touch was added to prepare us for the continuation in which *Gish* describes how, despite this (or perhaps just because of it), *Enkidu* seemed so attractive that *Gish* instantly fell in love with him. May perhaps the emphatic form *ḫaṣinumma* (line 31) against *ḫaṣinu* (line 29) have been used to indicate “The axe it was,” or “because of the axe?” It would be worth while to examine other texts of the *Hammurabi* period with a view of determining the scope in the use and meaning of the emphatic *ma* when added to a substantive.

[Line 32](#). The combination *amur ù aḫtadu* occurs also in the *El-Amarna* Letters, No. 18, 12.

[Line 34](#). In view of the common Hebrew, Syriac and Arabic קָבַח “to love,” it seems preferable to read here, as in the other passages in the Assyrian versions (I, 4, 15; 4, 35; 6, 27, etc.), *a-ḫa-ab-bu-ub*, *aḫ-bu-ub*, *iḫ-bu-bu*, etc. (instead of with *p*), and to render “embrace.”

[Lines 38](#)–40, completing the column, may be supplied from the Assyrian version I, 6, 30–32, in conjunction with lines 33–34 of our text. The beginning of line 32 in Jensen’s version is therefore to be filled out [*ta-ra-am-šú ki*]-i.

[Line 43](#). The restoration at the beginning of this line

En-ki-[dũ wa]-ši-ib ma-ḥar ḥa-ri-im-tim

enables us to restore also the beginning of the second tablet of the Assyrian version (cf. the colophon of the fragment 81, 7–27, 93, in Jeremias, *Izdubar-Nimrod*, plate IV = Jensen, p. 134),

[^d*En-ki-dũ wa-ši-ib*] *ma-ḥar-šá*.

[Line 44](#). The restoration of this line is largely conjectural, based on the supposition that its contents correspond in a general way to I, 4, 16, of the Assyrian version. The reading *di-da* is quite certain, as is also *ip-ti-[e]*; and since both words occur in the line of the Assyrian version in question, it is tempting to supply at the beginning *ur-[šá]* = “her loins” (cf. Holma, *Namen der Körperteile*, etc., p. 101), which is likewise found in the same line of the Assyrian version. At all events the line describes the fascination exercised upon Enkidu by the woman’s bodily charms, which make him forget everything else.

[Lines 46](#)–47 form a parallel to I, 4, 21, of the Assyrian version. The form *šamkatu*, “courtesan,” is constant in the old Babylonian version (II, 135 and 172), as against *šamḥatu* in the Assyrian version (I, 3, 19, 40, 45; 4, 16), which also uses the plural *šam-ḥa-a-ti* (II, 3^b, 40). The interchange between *ḥ* and *k* is not without precedent (cf. Meissner, *Altbabylonisches Privatrecht*, page 107, note 2, and more particularly Chiera, *List of Personal Names*, page 37).

In view of the evidence, set forth in the Introduction, for the assumption that the Enkidu story has been combined with a tale of the evolution of primitive man to civilized life, it is reasonable to suggest that in the original Enkidu story the female companion was called *šamkatu*, “courtesan,”

whereas in the tale of the primitive man, which was transferred to Enkidu, the associate was *ḫarimtu*, a “woman,” just as in the Genesis tale, the companion of Adam is simply called *ishshâ*, “woman.” Note that in the Assyrian parallel (Tablet I, 4, 26) we have two readings, *ir-ḫi* (imperf.) and a variant *i-ri-ḫi* (present). The former is the better reading, as our tablet shows.

[Lines 49](#)–59 run parallel to the Assyrian version I, 4, 33–38, with slight variations which have been discussed above, p. 58, and from which we may conclude that the Assyrian version represents an independent redaction. Since in our tablet we have presumably the repetition of what may have been in part at least set forth in the first tablet of the old Babylonian version, we must not press the parallelism with the first tablet of the Assyrian version too far; but it is noticeable nevertheless (1) that our tablet contains lines 57–58 which are not represented in the Assyrian version, and (2) that the second speech of the “woman” beginning, line 62, with *al-ka*, “come” (just as the first speech, line 54), is likewise not found in the first tablet of the Assyrian version; which on the other hand contains a line (39) not in the Babylonian version, besides the detailed answer of Enkidu (I 4, 42–5, 5). Line 6, which reads “Enkidu and the woman went (*il-li-ku*) to walled Erech,” is also not found in the second tablet of the old Babylonian version.

[Line 63](#). For *magrû*, “accursed,” see the frequent use in Astrological texts (Jastrow, *Religion Babyloniens und Assyriens* II, page 450, note 2). Langdon, by his strange error in separating *ma-a-ag-ri-im* into two words *ma-a-ak* and *ri-i-im*, with a still stranger rendering: “unto the place yonder of the shepherds!!”, naturally misses the point of this important speech.

[Line 64](#) corresponds to I, 4, 40, of the Assyrian version, which has an additional line, leading to the answer of Enkidu. From here on, our tablet furnishes material not represented in the Assyrian version, but which was no doubt included in the second tablet of that version of which we have only a few fragments.

[Line 70](#) must be interpreted as indicating that the woman kept one garment for herself. *Ittalbaš* would accordingly mean, “she kept on.” The female dress appears to have consisted of an upper and a lower garment.

[Line 72](#). The restoration “like a god” is favored by [line 51](#), where Enkidu is likened to a god, and is further confirmed by l. 190.

[Line 73](#). *gupru* is identical with *gu-up-ri* (Thompson, *Reports of the Magicians and Astrologers*, etc., 223 rev. 2 and 223^a rev. 8), and must be correlated to *gipâru* (Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, p. 229^a), “planted field,” “meadow,” and the like. Thompson’s translation “men” (as though a synonym of *gabru*) is to be corrected accordingly.

[Line 74](#). There is nothing missing between *a-šar* and *tar-ba-ši-im*.

[Line 75](#). *ri-ia-ú*, which Langdon renders “shepherd,” is the equivalent of the Arabic *ri’y* and Hebrew רִיעָה “pasturage,” “fodder.” We have usually the feminine form *ri-i-tu* (Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, p. 990^b). The break at the end of the second column is not serious. Evidently Enkidu, still accustomed to live like an animal, is first led to the sheepfolds, and this suggests a repetition of the description of his former life. Of the four or five lines missing, we may conjecturally restore four, on the basis of the Assyrian version, Tablet I, 4, 2–5, or I, 2, 39–41. This would then join on well to the beginning of column 3.

[Line 81](#). Both here and in [l. 52](#) our text has *na-ma-áš-te-e*, as against *nam-maš-ši-i* in the Assyrian version, e.g., Tablet I, 2, 41; 4, 5, etc.,—the feminine form, therefore, as against the masculine. Langdon’s note 3 on page 213 is misleading. In astrological texts we also find *nam-maš-te*; e.g., Thompson, *Reports of the Magicians and Astrologers*, etc., No. 200, Obv. 2.

[Line 93](#). *zi-ma-at* (for *simat*) *ba-la-ṭi-im* is not “conformity of life” as Langdon renders, but that which “belongs to life” like *si-mat pag-ri-šá*, “belonging to her body,” in the Assyrian version III, 2^a, 3 (Jensen, page 146). “Food,” says the woman, “is the staff of life.”

[Line 94](#). Langdon's strange rendering "of the conditions and fate of the land" rests upon an erroneous reading (see the corrections, Appendix I), which is the more inexcusable because in line 97 the same ideogram, Kàš = *šikaru*, "wine," occurs, and is correctly rendered by him. *Šimti mâti* is not the "fate of the land," but the "fixed custom of the land."

[Line 98](#). *aš-ša-mi-im* (plural of *aššamu*), which Langdon takes as an adverb in the sense of "times," is a well-known word for a large "goblet," which occurs in Incantation texts, e.g., *CT XVI*, 24, obv. 1, 19, *mê a-ša-am-mi-e šú-puk*, "pour out goblets of water." Line 18 of the passage shoves that *ašammu* is a Sumerian loan word.

[Line 99](#). *it-tap-šar*, I, 2, from *pašâru*, "loosen." In combination with *kabtatum* (from *kabitatum*, yielding two forms: *kabtatum*, by elision of *i*, and *kabittu*, by elision of *a*), "liver," *pašâru* has the force of becoming cheerful. Cf. *ka-bit-ta-ki lip-pa-šir* (*ZA V.*, p. 67, line 14).

[Line 100](#), note the customary combination of "liver" (*kabtatum*) and "heart" (*libbu*) for "disposition" and "mind," just as in the standing phrase in penitential prayers: "May thy liver be appeased, thy heart be quieted."

[Line 102](#). The restoration [^{lù}ŠÚ]-I = *gallabu* "barber" (Delitzsch, *Sumer. Glossar*, p. 267) was suggested to me by Dr. H. F. Lutz. The ideographic writing "raising the hand" is interesting as recalling the gesture of shaving or cutting. Cf. a reference to a barber in Lutz, *Early Babylonian Letters from Larsa*, No. 109, 6.

[Line 103](#). Langdon has correctly rendered *šuhuru* as "hair," and has seen that we have here a loan-word from the Sumerian *Suḫur* = *kimmatu*, "hair," according to the Syllabary S^b 357 (cf. Delitzsch, *Sumer. Glossar.*, p. 253). For *kimmatu*, "hair," more specifically hair of the head and face, see Holma, *Namen der Körperteile*, page 3. The same sign *Suḫur* or *Suḫ* (Brünnow No. 8615), with *Lal*, i.e., "hanging hair," designates the "beard" (*ziknu*, cf. Brünnow, No. 8620, and Holma, l. c., p. 36), and it is interesting to note that we have *šuhuru* (introduced as a loan-word) for the barbershop, according to II R, 21, 27^c (= *CT XII*, 41).

Ê suḥur(ra) (i.e., house of the hair) = šú-ḫu-ru.

In view of all this, we may regard as assured Holma's conjecture to read šú-[ḫur-ma-šú] in the list 93074 obv. (MVAG 1904, p. 203; and Holma, *Beiträge z. Assyrl. Lexikon*, p. 36), as the Akkadian equivalent to Suḥur-Maš-Ḫa and the name of a fish, so called because it appeared to have a double "beard" (cf. Holma, *Namen der Körperteile*). One is tempted, furthermore, to see in the difficult word שְׂכִירָה (Isaiah 7, 20) a loan-word from our šuḥuru, and to take the words פֶּסֶת־הַרְפָּסִשׁ וְשַׁעַר הַרְגָּלִים "the head and hair of the feet" (euphemistic for the hair around the privates), as an explanatory gloss to the rare word שְׂכִירָה for "hair" of the body in general—just as in the passage in the Pennsylvania tablet. The verse in Isaiah would then read, "The Lord on that day will shave with the razor the hair (הַשְׂכִּירָה), and even the beard will be removed." The rest of the verse would represent a series of explanatory glosses: (a) "Beyond the river" (i.e., Assyria), a gloss to יְגִלָּה (b) "with the king of Assyria," a gloss to בְּתַעַר "with a razor;" and (c) "the hair of the head and hair of the feet," a gloss to הַשְׂכִּירָה. For "hair of the feet" we have an interesting equivalent in Babylonian šu-ḫur (and šú-ḫu-ur) šêpi (CT XII, 41, 23–24 c-d). Cf. also Boissier, *Documents Assyriens relatifs aux Présages*, p. 258, 4–5. The Babylonian phrase is like the Hebrew one to be interpreted as a euphemism for the hair around the male or female organ. To be sure, the change from ה to כ in הַשְׂכִּירָה constitutes an objection, but not a serious one in the case of a loan-word, which would aim to give the *pronunciation* of the original word, rather than the correct etymological equivalent. The writing with aspirated כ fulfills this condition. (Cf. šamkatum and šamḫatum, above p. 73). The passage in Isaiah being a reference to Assyria, the prophet might be tempted to use a foreign word to make his point more emphatic. To take הַשְׂכִּירָה as "hired," as has hitherto been done, and to translate "with a hired razor," is not only to suppose a very wooden metaphor, but is grammatically difficult, since הַשְׂכִּירָה would be a feminine adjective attached to a masculine substantive.

Coming back to our passage in the Pennsylvania tablet, it is to be noted that Enkidu is described as covered "all over his body with hair" (Assyrian version, Tablet I, 2, 36) like an animal. To convert him into a civilized man, the hair is removed.

[Line 107](#). *mutu* does not mean “husband” here, as Langdon supposes, but must be taken as in [l. 238](#) in the more general sense of “man,” for which there is good evidence.

[Line 109](#). *la-bi* (plural form) are “lions”—not “panthers” as Langdon has it. The verb *ú-gi-ir-ri* is from *gâru*, “to attack.” Langdon by separating *ú* from *gi-ir-ri* gets a totally wrong and indeed absurd meaning. See the corrections in the Appendix. He takes the sign *ú* for the copula (!!) which of course is impossible.

[Line 110](#). Read *uš-sa-ak-pu*, III, 1, of *sakâpu*, which is frequently used for “lying down” and is in fact a synonym of *šalâlu*. See Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, page 758^a. The original has very clearly *Sîb* (= *rê’u*, “shepherd”) with the plural sign. The “shepherds of the night,” who could now rest since Enkidu had killed the lions, are of course the shepherds who were accustomed to watch the flocks during the night.

[Line 111](#). *ut-tap-pi-iš* is II, 2, *napâšu*, “to make a hole,” hence “to plunge” in connection with a weapon. *Šib-ba-ri* is, of course, not “mountain goats,” as Langdon renders, but a by-form to *šibbiru*, “stick,” and designates some special weapon. Since on seal cylinders depicting Enkidu killing lions and other animals the hero is armed with a dagger, this is presumably the weapon *šibbaru*.

[Line 113](#). Langdon’s translation is again out of the question and purely fanciful. The traces favor the restoration *na-ki-[di-e]*, “shepherds,” and since the line appears to be a parallel to line 110, I venture to suggest at the beginning *[it-ti]-lu* from *na’âlu*, “lie down”—a synonym, therefore, to *sakâpu* in line 110. The shepherds can sleep quietly after Enkidu has become the “guardian” of the flocks. In the Assyrian version (tablet II, 3^a, 4) Enkidu is called a *na-kid*, “shepherd,” and in the preceding line we likewise have ^{lu}Na-Kid with the plural sign, i.e., “shepherds.” This would point to *nakidu* being a Sumerian loan-word, unless it is *vice versa*, a word that has gone over into the Sumerian from Akkadian. Is perhaps the fragment in question (K 8574) in the Assyrian version (Haupt’s ed. No. 25) the *parallel* to our passage? If in line 4 of this fragment we could read *šú*

for *sa*, i.e., *na-kid-šú-nu*, “their shepherd, we would have a parallel to line 114 of the Pennsylvania tablet, with *na-kid* as a synonym to *maššaru*, “protector.” The preceding line would then be completed as follows:

[*it-ti-lu*]-*nim-ma na-kid*^{meš} [*ra-bu-tum*]

(or perhaps only *it-ti-lu-ma*, since the *nim* is not certain) and would correspond to [line 113](#) of the Pennsylvania tablet. Inasmuch as the writing on the tiny fragment is very much blurred, it is quite possible that in line 2 we must read *šib-ba-ri* (instead of *bar-ba-ri*), which would furnish a parallel to line 111 of the Pennsylvania tablet. The difference between Bar and Šib is slight, and the one sign might easily be mistaken for the other in the case of close writing. The continuation of line 2 of the fragment would then correspond to line 112 of the Pennsylvania tablet, while line 1 of the fragment might be completed [*re-e*]-*u-ti*(?) *šá* [*mu-ši-a-tim*], though this is by no means certain.

The break at the close of column 3 (about 5 lines) and the top of column 4 (about 8 lines) is a most serious interruption in the narrative, and makes it difficult to pick up the thread where the tablet again becomes readable. We cannot be certain whether the “strong man, the unique hero” who addresses some one (lines 115–117) is Enkidu or Gish or some other personage, but presumably Gish is meant. In the Assyrian version, Tablet I, 3, 2 and 29, we find Gilgamesh described as the “unique hero” and in l. 234 of the Pennsylvania tablet Gish is called “unique,” while again, in the Assyrian version, Tablet I, 2, 15 and 26, he is designated as *gašru* as in our text. Assuming this, whom does he address? Perhaps the shepherds? In either case he receives an answer that rejoices him. If the fragment of the Assyrian version (K 8574) above discussed is the equivalent to the close of column 3 of the Pennsylvania tablet, we may go one step further, and with some measure of assurance assume that Gish is told of Enkidu’s exploits and that the latter is approaching Erech. This pleases Gish, but Enkidu when he sees Gish(?) is stirred to anger and wants to annihilate him. At this point, the “man” (who is probably Gish, though the possibility of a third personage must be admitted) intervenes and in a long speech sets forth the destiny and higher aims of mankind. The contrast between Enkidu and Gish (or the

third party) is that between the primitive savage and the civilized being. The contrast is put in the form of an opposition between the two. The primitive man is the stronger and wishes to destroy the one whom he regards as a natural foe and rival. On the other hand, the one who stands on a higher plane wants to lift his fellow up. The whole of column 4, therefore, forms part of the lesson attached to the story of Enkidu, who, identified with man in a primitive stage, is made the medium of illustrating how the higher plane is reached through the guiding influences of the woman's hold on man, an influence exercised, to be sure, with the help of her bodily charms.

[Line 135](#). *uk-ki-ši* (imperative form) does not mean “take away,” as Langdon (who entirely misses the point of the whole passage) renders, but on the contrary, “lure him on,” “entrap him,” and the like. The verb occurs also in the Yale tablet, ll. 183 and 186.

[Line 137](#). Langdon's note to *lu-uš-šú* had better be passed over in silence. The form is II. 1, from *ešû*, “destroy.”

[Line 139](#). Since the man whom the woman calls approaches Enkidu, the subject of both verbs is the man, and the object is Enkidu; i.e., therefore, “The man approaches Enkidu and beholds him.”

[Line 140](#). Langdon's interpretation of this line again is purely fanciful. *E-di-il* cannot, of course, be a “phonetic variant” of *edir*; and certainly the line does not describe the state of mind of the woman. Lines 140–141 are to be taken as an expression of amazement at Enkidu's appearance. The first word appears to be an imperative in the sense of “Be off,” “Away,” from *dâlu*, “move, roam.” The second word *e-eš*, “why,” occurs with the same verb *dâlu* in the Meissner fragment: *e-eš ta-da-al* (column 3, 1), “why dost thou roam about?” The verb at the end of the line may perhaps be completed to *ta-ḫi-il-la-am*. The last sign appears to be *am*, but may be *ma*, in which case we should have to complete simply *ta-ḫi-il-ma*. *Taḫîl* would be the second person present of *ḫîlu*. Cf. *i-ḫi-il*, frequently in astrological texts, e.g., Virolleaud, *Adad* No. 3, lines 21 and 33.

[Line 141](#). The reading *lim-nu* at the beginning, instead of Langdon's *mi-nu*, is quite certain, as is also *ma-na-aḥ-ti-ka* instead of what Langdon proposes, which gives no sense whatever. *Manaḥtu* in the sense of the "toil" and "activity of life" (like ܠܡܢܬܐ throughout the Book of Ecclesiastes) occurs in the introductory lines to the Assyrian version of the Epic I, 1, 8, *ka-lu ma-na-aḥ-ti-[šū]*, "all of his toil," i.e., all of his career.

[Line 142](#). The subject of the verb cannot be the woman, as Langdon supposes, for the text in that case, e.g., line 49, would have said *pi-šá* ("her mouth") not *pi-šú* ("his mouth"). The long speech, detailing the function and destiny of civilized man, is placed in the mouth of the man who meets Enkidu.

In the Introduction it has been pointed out that [lines 149](#) and [151](#) of the speech appear to be due to later modifications of the speech designed to connect the episode with Gish. Assuming this to be the case, the speech sets forth the following five distinct aims of human life: (1) establishing a home (line 144), (2) work (line 147), (3) storing up resources (line 148), (4) marriage (line 150), (5) monogamy (line 154); all of which is put down as established for all time by divine decree (lines 155–157), and as man's fate from his birth (lines 158–159).

[Line 144](#). *bi-ti-iš e-mu-ti* is for *bîti šá e-mu-ti*, just as *ḵab-lu-uš Ti-a-ma-ti* (Assyrian Creation Myth, IV, 65) stands for *ḵablu šá Tiamti*. Cf. *bîti e-mu-ti* (Assyrian version, IV, 2, 46 and 48). The end of the line is lost beyond recovery, but the general sense is clear.

[Line 146](#). *tu-a-ar* is a possible reading. It may be the construct of *tu-a-ru*, of frequent occurrence in legal texts and having some such meaning as "right," "claim" or "prerogative." See the passages given by Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, p. 1139^b.

[Line 148](#). The reading *uk-la-at*, "food," and then in the wider sense "food supply," "provisions," is quite certain. The fourth sign looks like the one for "city." *E-mi-sa* may stand for *e-mid-sa*, "place it." The general sense of the line, at all events, is clear, as giving the advice to gather resources. It fits in

with the Babylonian outlook on life to regard work and wealth as the fruits of work and as a proper purpose in life.

[Line 150](#) (repeated [lines 152](#)–153) is a puzzling line. To render *piti pûk epši* (or *epiši*), as Langdon proposes, “open, addressing thy speech,” is philologically and in every other respect inadmissible. The word *pu-uk* (which Langdon takes for “thy mouth”!!) can, of course, be nothing but the construct form of *pukku*, which occurs in the Assyrian version in the sense of “net” (*pu-uk-ku* I, 2, 9 and 21, and also in the colophon to the eleventh tablet furnishing the beginning of the twelfth tablet (Haupt’s edition No. 56), as well as in column 2, 29, and column 3, 6, of this twelfth tablet). In the two last named passages *pukku* is a synonym of *mekû*, which from the general meaning of “enclosure” comes to be a euphemistic expression for the female organ. So, for example, in the Assyrian Creation Myth, Tablet IV, 66 (synonym of *ḫablu*, “waist,” etc.). See Holma, *Namen der Körperteile*, page 158. Our word *pukku* must be taken in this same sense as a designation of the female organ—perhaps more specifically the “hymen” as the “net,” though the womb in general might also be designated as a “net” or “enclosure.” *Kak-(ši)* is no doubt to be read *epši*, as Langdon correctly saw; or perhaps better, *epiši*. An expression like *ip-ši-šú lul-la-a* (Assyrian version, I, 4, 13; also line 19, *i-pu-us-su-ma lul-la-a*), with the explanation *šipir zinništi*, “the work of woman” (i.e., after the fashion of woman), shows that *epêšu* is used in connection with the sexual act. The phrase *pitî pûk epiši a-na ḫa-a-a-ri*, literally “open the net, perform the act for marriage,” therefore designates the fulfillment of the marriage act, and the line is intended to point to marriage with the accompanying sexual intercourse as one of the duties of man. While the general meaning is thus clear, the introduction of Gish is puzzling, except on the supposition that lines 149 and 151 represent later additions to connect the speech, detailing the advance to civilized life, with the hero. See above, p. 45 *seq.*

[Line 154.](#) *aššat šimâtîm* is the “legitimate wife,” and the line inculcates monogamy as against promiscuous sexual intercourse. We know that monogamy was the rule in Babylonia, though a man could in addition to the wife recognized as the legalized spouse take a concubine, or his wife could give her husband a slave as a concubine. Even in that case, according to the

Hammurabi Code, §§145–146, the wife retained her status. The Code throughout assumes that a man has only *one* wife—the *aššat šimâtim* of our text. The phrase “so” (or “that”) before “as afterwards” is to be taken as an idiomatic expression—“so it was and so it should be for all times”—somewhat like the phrase *maḥriam û arkiam*, “for all times,” in legal documents (CT VIII, 38^c, 22–23). For the use of *mûk* see Behrens, *Assyrisch-Babylonische Briefe*, p. 3.

[Line 158](#). *i-na bi-ti-iḫ a-bu-un-na-ti-šú*. Another puzzling line, for which Langdon proposes “in the work of his presence,” which is as obscure as the original. In a note he says that *apunnâti* means “nostrils,” which is certainly wrong. There has been considerable discussion about this term (see Holma, *Namen der Körperteile*, pages 150 and 157), the meaning of which has been advanced by Christian’s discussion in *OLZ* 1914, p. 397. From this it appears that it must designate a part of the body which could acquire a wider significance so as to be used as a synonym for “totality,” since it appears in a list of equivalent for Dur = *nap-ḥa-ru*, “totality,” *ka-lu-ma*, “all,” *a-bu-un-na-tum e-ši-im-tum*, “bony structure,” and *kul-la-tum*, “totality” (CT XII, 10, 7–10). Christian shows that it may be the “navel,” which could well acquire a wider significance for the body in general; but we may go a step further and specify the “umbilical cord” (tentatively suggested also by Christian) as the primary meaning, then the “navel,” and from this the “body” in general. The structure of the umbilical cord as a series of strands would account for designating it by a plural form *abunnâti*, as also for the fact that one could speak of a right and left side of the *appunnâti*. To distinguish between the “umbilical cord” and the “navel,” the ideograph Dur (the common meaning of which is *riksu*, “bond” [Delitzsch, *Sumer. Glossar.*, p. 150]), was used for the former, while for the latter Li Dur was employed, though the reading in Akkadian in both cases was the same. The expression “with (or at) the cutting of his umbilical cord” would mean, therefore, “from his birth”—since the cutting of the cord which united the child with the mother marks the beginning of the separate life. Lines 158–159, therefore, in concluding the address to Enkidu, emphasize in a picturesque way that what has been set forth is man’s fate for which he has been destined from birth. [See now Albright’s remarks on *abunnatu* in the *Revue d’Assyriologie* 16, pp. 173–175, with whose conclusion,

however, that it means primarily “backbone” and then “stature,” I cannot agree.]

In the break of about three lines at the bottom of column 4, and of about six at the beginning of column 5, there must have been set forth the effect of the address on Enkidu and the indication of his readiness to accept the advice; as in a former passage (line 64), Enkidu showed himself willing to follow the woman. At all events the two now proceed to the heart of the city. Enkidu is in front and the woman behind him. The scene up to this point must have taken place outside of Erech—in the suburbs or approaches to the city, where the meadows and the sheepfolds were situated.

[Line 174](#). *um-ma-nu-um* are not the “artisans,” as Langdon supposes, but the “people” of Erech, just as in the Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 1, 40, where the word occurs in connection with *i-dip-pi-ir*, which is perhaps to be taken as a synonym of *paḥâru*, “gather;” so also *i-dip-pir* (Tablet I, 2, 40) “gathers with the flock.”

[Lines 180](#)–182 must have contained the description of Enkidu’s resemblance to Gish, but the lines are too mutilated to permit of any certain restoration. See the corrections (Appendix) for a suggested reading for the end of line 181.

[Line 183](#) can be restored with considerable probability on the basis of the Assyrian version, Tablet I, 3, 3 and 30, where Enkidu is described as one “whose power is strong in the land.”

[Lines 186](#)–187. The puzzling word, to be read apparently *kak-ki-a-tum*, can hardly mean “weapons,” as Langdon proposes. In that case we should expect *kakkê*; and, moreover, to so render gives no sense, especially since the verb *ú-te-el-li-lu* is without much question to be rendered “rejoiced,” and not “purified.” *Kakkiatum*—if this be the correct reading—may be a designation of Erech like *ribîtim*.

[Lines 188](#)–189 are again entirely misunderstood by Langdon, owing to erroneous readings. See the corrections in the Appendix.

[Line 190](#). *i-li-im* in this line is used like Hebrew Elohîm, “God.”

[Line 191](#). *šakiššum* = *šakin-šum*, as correctly explained by Langdon.

[Line 192](#). With this line a new episode begins which, owing to the gap at the beginning of column 6, is somewhat obscure. The episode leads to the hostile encounter between Gish and Enkidu. It is referred to in column 2 of the fourth tablet of the Assyrian version. Lines 35–50—all that is preserved of this column—form in part a parallel to columns 5–6 of the Pennsylvania tablet, but in much briefer form, since what on the Pennsylvania tablet is the incident itself is on the fourth tablet of the Assyrian version merely a repeated summary of the relationship between the two heroes, leading up to the expedition against Ħu(m)baba. Lines 38–40 of column 2 of the Assyrian version correspond to lines 174–177 of the Pennsylvania tablet, and lines 44–50 to lines 192–221. It would seem that Gish proceeds stealthily at night to go to the goddess Ishḫara, who lies on a couch in the *bît êmuti*, the “family house” Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 2. 46–48). He encounters Enkidu in the street, and the latter blocks Gish’s path, puts his foot in the gate leading to the house where the goddess is, and thus prevents Gish from entering. Thereupon the two have a fierce encounter in which Gish is worsted. The meaning of the episode itself is not clear. Does Enkidu propose to deprive Gish, here viewed as a god (cf. line 190 of the Pennsylvania tablet = Assyrian version, Tablet I, 4, 45, “like a god”), of his spouse, the goddess Ishḫara—another form of Ishtar? Or are the two heroes, the one a counterpart of the other, contesting for the possession of a goddess? Is it in this scene that Enkidu becomes the “rival” (*me-iḫ-rù*, line 191 of the Pennsylvania tablet) of the divine Gish? We must content ourselves with having obtained through the Pennsylvania tablet a clearer indication of the occasion of the fight between the two heroes, and leave the further explanation of the episode till a fortunate chance may throw additional light upon it. There is perhaps a reference to the episode in the Assyrian version, Tablet II, 3^b, 35–36.

[Line 196](#). For *i-na-ag-šá-am* (from *nagâšu*), Langdon proposes the purely fanciful “embracing her in sleep,” whereas it clearly means “he approaches.” Cf. Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, page 645^a.

[Lines 197](#)–200 appear to correspond to Tablet IV, 2, 35–37, of the Assyrian version, though not forming a complete parallel. We may therefore supply at the beginning of line 35 of the Assyrian version *[ittaziz] Enkidu*, corresponding to line 197 of the Pennsylvania tablet. Line 36 of IV, 2, certainly appears to correspond to line 200 (*dan-nu-ti* = *da-na-ni-iš-šú*).

[Line 208](#). The first sign looks more like *šar*, though *ur* is possible.

[Line 211](#) is clearly a description of Enkidu, as is shown by a comparison with the Assyrian version I, 2, 37: *[pi]-ti-ik pi-ir-ti-šú uḫ-tan-na-ba kima* ^d*Nidaba*, “The form of his hair sprouted like wheat.” We must therefore supply Enkidu in the preceding line. Tablet IV, 4, 6, of the Assyrian version also contains a reference to the flowing hair of Enkidu.

[Line 212](#). For the completion of the line cf. Harper, *Assyrian and Babylonian Letters*, No. 214.

[Line 214](#). For *ribûtu mâti* see the note above to line 28 of column 1.

[Lines 215](#)–217 correspond almost entirely to the Assyrian version IV, 2, 46–48. The variations *ki-ib-su* in place of *šêpu*, and *kima lîm*, “like oxen,” instead of *ina bâb êmuti* (repeated from line 46), *ana šurûbi* for *êribam*, are slight though interesting. The Assyrian version shows that the “gate” in line 215 is “the gate of the family house” in which the goddess Ishhara lies.

[Lines 218](#)–228. The detailed description of the fight between the two heroes is only partially preserved in the Assyrian version.

[Line 218](#). *li-i-im* is evidently to be taken as plural here as in [line 224](#), just as *su-ki-im* (lines 27 and 175), *ri-bi-tim* (lines 4, 28, etc.), *tarbašim* (line 74), *aššamim* (line 98) are plural forms. Our text furnishes, as does also the Yale tablet, an interesting illustration of the vacillation in the Hammurabi period in the twofold use of *im*: (a) as an indication of the plural (as in Hebrew), and (b) as a mere emphatic ending (lines 63, 73, and 232), which becomes predominant in the post-Hammurabi age.

[Line 227](#). Gilgamesh is often represented on seal cylinders as kneeling, e.g., Ward Seal Cylinders Nos. 159, 160, 165. Cf. also Assyrian version V, 3, 6, where Gilgamesh is described as kneeling, though here in prayer. See further the commentary to the Yale tablet, line 215.

[Line 229](#). We must of course read *uz-za-šú*, “his anger,” and not *uṣ-ša-šú*, “his javelin,” as Langdon does, which gives no sense.

[Line 231](#). Langdon’s note is erroneous. He again misses the point. The stem of the verb here as in [line 230](#) (*i-ni-iḥ*) is the common *nâḥu*, used so constantly in connection with *pašâḥu*, to designate the cessation of anger.

[Line 234](#). *ištên* applied to Gish designates him of course as “unique,” not as “an ordinary man,” as Langdon supposes.

[Line 236](#). On this title “wild cow of the stall” for Ninsun, see Poebel in *OLZ* 1914, page 6, to whom we owe the correct view regarding the name of Gilgamesh’s mother.

[Line 238](#). *mu-ti* here cannot mean “husband,” but “man” in general. See above note to line 107. Langdon’s strange misreading *ri-eš-su* for *ri-eš-ka* (“thy head”) leads him again to miss the point, namely that Enkidu comforts his rival by telling him that he is destined for a career above that of the ordinary man. He is to be more than a mere prize fighter; he is to be a king, and no doubt in the ancient sense, as the representative of the deity. This is indicated by the statement that the kingship is decreed for him by Enlil. Similarly, *Ḫu(m)baba* or *Ḫuwawa* is designated by Enlil to inspire terror among men (Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 5, 2 and 5), *i-šim-šú* ^d*Enlil* = Yale tablet, l. 137, where this is to be supplied. This position accorded to Enlil is an important index for the origin of the Epic, which is thus shown to date from a period when the patron deity of Nippur was acknowledged as the general head of the pantheon. This justifies us in going back several centuries at least before Hammurabi for the beginning of the Gilgamesh story. If it had originated in the Hammurabi period, we should have had Marduk introduced instead of Enlil.

[Line 242](#). As has been pointed out in the corrections to the text (Appendix), *šú-tu-ur* can only be III, 1, from *atâru*, “to be in excess of.” It is a pity that the balance of the line is broken off, since this is the first instance of a colophon beginning with the term in question. In some way *šutûr* must indicate that the copy of the text has been “enlarged.” It is tempting to fill out the line *šú-tu-ur e-li [duppi labiri]*, and to render “enlarged from an original,” as an indication of an independent recension of the Epic in the Hammurabi period. All this, however, is purely conjectural, and we must patiently hope for more tablets of the Old Babylonian version to turn up. The chances are that some portions of the same edition as the Yale and Pennsylvania tablets are in the hands of dealers at present or have been sold to European museums. The war has seriously interfered with the possibility of tracing the whereabouts of groups of tablets that ought never to have been separated.

Yale Tablet.

Transliteration.

(About ten lines missing.)

Col. I.

11..... [ib]-ri(?)
12[mi-im-ma(?) šá(?)]-kú-tu wa(?)-ak-rum
13[am-mi-nim] ta-aḥ-ši-iḥ
14[an-ni]-a-am [e-pi]-šá-am
15..... mi-im[-ma šá-kú-tu(?)]ma-
16di-iš
17[am-mi]-nim [taḥ]-ši-iḥ
18[ur(?)]-ta-du-ú [a-na ki-i]š-tim
19ši-ip-ra-am it-[ta-šú]-ú i-na [nišê]
20it-ta-áš-šú-ú-ma
21i-pu-šú ru-ḥu-tam
22..... uš-ta-di-nu
23..... bu
24.....

(About 17 lines missing.)

40..... nam-.....
41..... u ib-[ri]
42..... ú-na-i-du

43[zi-ik]-ra-am ú-[tí-ir]-ru
44[a-na] ḥa-ri-[im]-tim
45[i]-pu(?) -šú a-na sa-[ka]-pu-ti

Col. II.

(About eleven lines missing.)

57... šú(?) -mu(?)
58ma-ḥi-ra-am [šá i-ši-šú]
59šú-uk-ni-šum-[ma]
60la-al-la-ru-[tu]
61um-mi ^d -[Giš mu-di-a-at ka-la-ma]
62i-na ma-[ḥar ^dŠamaš i-di-šá iš-ši]
63šá ú
64i-na- an(?) -[na am-mi-nim]
65ta-[aš-kun(?) a-na ma-ri-ia li-ib-bi la]
66ša-[li-la te-mid-su]
67.....

(About four lines missing.)

72i-na [šá ^dEn-ki-dū im-la-a] di-[im-tam]
73il-[pu-ut li]-ib-ba-šú-[ma]
74[zar-biš(?)] uš-ta-ni-[iḥ]
75[i-na šá ^dEn]-ki-dū im-la-a di-im-tam
76[il-pu-ut] li-ib-ba-šú-ma
77[zar-biš(?)] uš-ta-ni-[iḥ]
78[^dGiš ú-ta]-ab-bil pa-ni-šú
79[iz-za-kar-am] a-na ^dEn-ki-dū
80[ib-ri am-mi-nim] i-na-ka
81[im-la-a di-im]-tam

82[il-pu-ut li-ib-bi]-ka
 83[zar-biš tu-uš-ta]-ni-iḥ
 84[^dEn-ki-dū pi-šú i-pu-šá]-am-ma
 85iz-za-[kàr-am] a-na ^dGiš
 86ta-ab-bi-a-tum ib-ri
 87uš-ta-li-pa da-¹da-ni-ia
 88a-ḥa-a-a ir-ma-a-ma
 89e-mu-ki i-ni-iš
 90^dGiš pi-šú i-pu-šá-am-ma
 91iz-za-kàr-am a-na ^dEn-ki-dū

(About four lines missing.)

Col. III.

96..... [a-di ^dḪu]-wa-wa da-pi-nu
 97..... ra-[am(?)-ma]
 98..... [ú-ḥal]- li-ik
 99[lu-ur-ra-du a-na ki-iš-ti šá] ^{is}erini
 100..... lam(?) ḥal-bu
 101..... [li]-li-is-su
 102..... lu(?)-up-ti-šú
 103^dEn-ki-dū pi-šú i-pu-šá-am-ma
 104iz-za-kàr-am a-na ^dGiš
 105i-di-ma ib-ri i-na šadî(-i)
 106i-nu-ma at-ta-la-ku it-ti bu-lim
 107a-na ištên(-en) kas-gíd-ta-a-an nu-ma-at ki-iš-tum
 108[e-di-iš(?)] ur-ra-du a-na libbi-šá
 109^d[Ḫu-wa]-wa ri-ig-ma-šú a-bu-bu
 110pi-[šú] ^dBil-gi-ma
 111na-pi-iš-šú mu-tum

112am-mi-nim ta-aḥ-ši-iḥ
 113an-ni-a-am e-pi-šá-am
 114ga-[ba]-al-la ma-ḥa-ar
 115[šú]-pa-at ^dHu-wa-wa
 116(^d)Giš pi-šú i-pu-šá-am-ma
 117[iz-za-k]àr-am a-na ^dEn-ki-dū
 118..... su(?) -lu-li a-šá-ki²-šá
 119..... [i-na ki-iš]-tim
 120.....
 121ik(?)
 122a-na
 123mu-šá-ab [^dHu-wa-wa]
 124ḥa-aṣ-si-nu
 125at-ta lu(?)
 126a-na-ku lu-[ur-ra-du a-na ki-iš-tim]
 127^dEn-ki-dū pi-šú i-pu-[šá-am-ma]
 128iz-za-kàr-am a-na [^dGiš]
 129ki-i ni[il]-la-ak [iš-te-niš(?)]
 130a-na ki-iš-ti [šá ^{is}erini]
 131na-ši-ir-šá ^dGiš muḫ-[tab-lu]
 132da-a-an la ṣa[-li-lu(?)]
 133^dHu-wa-wa ^dpi-ir-[ḥu ša (?)]
 134^dAdad iš
 135šú-ú

Col. IV.

136áš-šúm šú-ul-lu-m[u ki-iš-ti šá^{is}erini]
 137pu-ul-ḥi-a-tim 7 [šú(?) i-šim-šú ^dEnlil]
 138^dGiš pi-šú i-pu [šá-am-ma]

139iz-za-kàr-am a-na [^dEn-ki-dũ]
140ma-an-nu ib-ri e-lu-ú šá-[ru-ba(?)]
141i-ṭib-ma it-ti ^dŠamaš da-ri-iš ú-[me-šú]
142a-we-lu-tum ba-ba-nu ú-tam-mu-šá-[ma]
143mi-im-ma šá i-te-ni-pu-šú šá-ru-ba
144at-ta an-na-nu-um-ma ta-dar mu-tam
145ul iš-šú da-na-nu ẓar-ra-du-ti-ka
146lu-ul-li-ik-ma i-na pa-ni-ka
147pi-ka li-iš-si-a-am ṭi-ḫi-e ta-du-ur
148šum-ma am-ta-ḫu-ut šú-mi lu-uš-zi-iz
149^dGiš mi³-it-ti ^dḪu-wa-wa da-pi-nim
150il(?)-ḫu-ut iš-tu
151i-wa-al-dam-ma tar-bi-a i-na šam-mu(?) Il(?)
152iš-ḫi-it-ka-ma la-bu ka-la-ma ti-di
153it- ku(?) [il(?)]-pu-tu-(?) ma
154..... ka-ma
155..... ši pi-ti
156..... ki-ma re'i(?) na-gi-la sa-rak-ti
157.... [ta-šá-s]i-a-am tu-lim-mi-in li-ib-bi
158[ga-ti lu]-uš-ku-un-ma
159[lu-u-ri]-ba-am ^{is}erini
160[šú-ma sá]-ṭa-ru-ú a-na-ku lu-uš-ta-ak-na
161[pu-tu-ku(?)] ib-ri a-na ki-iš-ka-tim lu-mu-ḫa
162[be-le-e li-iš-]-pu-ku i-na maḫ-ri-ni
163[pu-tu]-ku a-na ki-iš-ka-ti-i i-mu-ḫu
164wa-áš-bu uš-ta-da-nu um-mi-a-nu
165pa-ši iš-pu-ku ra-bu-tim
166ḫa-aš-si-ni 3 biltu-ta-a-an iš-tap-ku
167pa-aṭ-ri iš-pu-ku ra-bu-tim
168me-še-li-tum 2 biltu-ta-a-an
169ši-ip-ru 30 ma-na-ta-a-an šá a-ḫi-ši-na
170išid(?) pa-aṭ-ri 30 ma-na-ta-a-an ḫuraši

171[^dGiš ù [^dEn-ki-]dũ 10 biltu-ta-a-an šá-ak-nu]
 172.... ul-la . .[Uruk]^{ki} 7 i-di-il-šú
 173..... iš-me-ma um-ma-nu ib-bi-ra
 174[uš-te(?)]-mi-a i-na sũḫi šá Uruk^{ki} ri-bi-tim
 175..... [u-še(?)]-ša-šú ^dGis
 176[ina sũḫi šá(?) Uruk^{ki}] ri-bi-tim
 177[^dEn-ki-dũ(?) ú]-šá-ab i-na maḥ-ri-šú
 178..... [ki-a-am(?) i-ga]-ab-bi
 179[..... Uruk^{ki} ri]-bi-tim
 180 [ma-ḥa-ar-šú]

Col. V.

181^dGiš šá i-ga-ab-bu-ú lu-mu-ur
 182šá šú-um-šú it-ta-nam-ma-la ma-ta-tum
 183lu-uk-šú-su-ma i-na ki-iš-ti ^{iš}erini
 184ki-ma da-an-nu pi-ir-ḥu-um šá Uruk^{ki}
 185lu-ši-eš-mi ma-tam
 186ga-ti lu-uš-ku-un-ma lu-uk-[šú]⁴-su-ma ^{iš}erini
 187šú-ma šá-ṭa-ru-ú a-na-ku lu-uš-tak-nam
 188ši-bu-tum šá Uruk^{ki} ri-bi-tim
 189zi-ik-ra ú-ti-ir-ru a-na ^dGiš
 190ši-iḥ-ri-ti-ma ^dGiš libbi-ka na-ši-ka
 191mi-im-ma šá te-te-ni-pu-šú la ti-di
 192ni-ši-im-me-ma ^dḤu-wa-wa šá-nu-ú bu-nu-šú
 193ma-an-nu-um [uš-tam]-ḥa-ru ka-ak-ki-šú
 194a-na ištên(-en) [kas-gíd-ta-a]-an nu-ma-at kišti
 195ma-an-nu šá [ur-ra]-du a-na libbi-šá
 196^dḤu-wa-wa ri-ig-ma-šú a-bu-bu
 197pi-šú ^dBil-gi-ma na-pi-su mu-tum

198am-mi-nim taḥ-ši-iḥ an-ni-a-am e-pi-šá
 199ga-ba-al-la ma-ḥa-ar šú-pa-at ^dHu-wa-wa
 200iš-me-e-ma ^dGiš zi-ki-ir ma-li-[ki]-šú
 201ip-pa-al-sa-am-ma i-ši-iḥ a-na ib-[ri-šú]
 202i-na-an-na ib-[ri] ki-a-am [a-ga-ab-bi]
 203a-pa-al-aḥ-šú-ma a-[al-la-ak a-na kišti]
 204[lu]ul-[lik it-ti-ka a-na ki-iš-ti ^{iš}erini(?)]

(About five lines missing.)

210..... -ma
 211li -ka
 212ilu-ka li(?)-ka
 213ḥarrana li-šá-[tir-ka a-na šú-ul-mi]
 214a-na kar šá [Uruk^{ki} ri-bi-tim]
 215ka-mi-is-ma ^dGiš [ma-ḥa-ar ^dŠamaš(?)]
 216a-wa-at i-ga-ab- [bu-šú-ma]
 217a-al-la-ak ^dŠamaš katâ-[ka a-ša-bat]
 218ul-la-nu lu-uš-li-ma na-pi-[iš-ti]
 219te-ir-ra-an-ni a-na kar i-[na Uruk^{ki}]
 220ši-il-[la]m šú-ku-un [a-na ia-a-ši(?)]
 221iš-si-ma ^dGiš ib-[ri.....]
 222te-ir-ta-šú
 223is(?)
 224tam
 225.....
 226i-nu(?)-[ma]

(About two lines missing.)

Col. VI.

229[a-na-ku] ^dGiš [i-ik]-ka-di ma-tum
 230..... ḫarrana šá la al-[kam] ma-ti-ma
 231.... a-ka-lu la(?) i-di
 232[ul-la-nu] lu-uš-li-[mu] a-na-ku
 233[lu-ud-lul]-ka i-na [ḫ]u-ud li-ib-bi
 234..... [šú]-ḫu-ut-[ti] la-li-ka
 235[lu-še-šib(?)] - ka i-na kussê^{meš}
 236..... ú-nu-su
 237[bêlê^{meš}(?)ú-ti-ir]-ru ra-bu-tum
 238[ka-aš-tum] ù iš-pa-tum
 239[i-na] ga-ti iš-ku-nu
 240[il-]te-ki pa-ši
 241..... -ri iš-pa-as-su
 242..... [a-na] ili šá-ni-tam
 243[it-ti pa(?)] - tar-[šú] i-na ši-ip-pi-šú
 244..... i-ip-pu-šú a-la-kam
 245[ša]-niš ú-ga-ra-bu ^dGiš
 246[a-di ma]-ti tu-ut-te-ir a-na libbi Uruk^{ki}
 247[ši-bu]-tum i-ka-ra-bu-šú
 248[a-na] ḫarrani i-ma-li-ku ^dGiš
 249[la t]a-at-kal ^dGiš a-na e-[mu]-ḫi-ka
 250[a-]ka-lu šú-wa-ra-ma ú-ṣur ra-ma-an-ka
 251[li]-il-lik ^dEn-ki-dū i-na pa-ni-ka
 252[ur-ḫa]-am a-we-ir a-lik ḫarrana(-na)
 253[a-di] šá kišti ni-ri-bi-tim
 254[šá(?)] [^d]Ḫu-wa-wa ka-li-šú-nu ši-ip-pi-iḫ(?)-šú
 255[ša(?)a-lik] maḫ-ra tap-pa-a ú-šá-lim
 256[ḫarrana](-na)-šú šú-wa-ra-[ma ú-ṣur ra-ma-na-ka]
 257[li-šak-šid]-ka ir-[ni-ta]-ka ^dŠamaš
 258[ta]-ak-bi-a-at pi-ka li-kal-li-ma i-na-ka
 259li-ip-ti-ḫu pa-da-nam pi-ḫi-tam

260ḥarrana li-iš-ta-zi-ik a-na ki-ib-si-ka
 261šá-di-a li-iš-ta-zi-ik a-na šêpi-ka
 262mu-ši-it-ka aw-a-at ta-ḥa-du-ú
 263li-ib-la-ma ^dLugal-ban-da li-iz-zi-iz-ka
 264i-na ir-ni-ti-ka
 265ki-ma ši-iḥ-ri ir-ni-ta-ka-ma luš-mida(-da)
 266i-na na-ri šá ^dḤu-wa-wa šá tu-ša-ma-ru
 267mi-zi ši-pi-ka
 268i-na bat-ba-ti-ka ḥi-ri bu-ur-tam
 269lu-ka-a-a-nu mē ellu i-na na-di-ka
 270[ka-]su-tim me-e a-na ^dŠamaš ta-na-di
 271[li-iš]ta-ḥa-sa-as ^dLugal-ban-da
 272[^dEn-ki-]dū pi-su i-pu-šá-am-ma, iz-za-kàr a-na
^dGiš
 273[is(?)]-tu(?) ta-áš-dan-nu e-pu-uš a-la-kam
 274[la pa]la-aḥ libbi-ka ia-ti tu-uk-la-ni
 275[šú-ku-]un i-di-a-am šú-pa-as-su
 276[ḥarrana(?)]šá ^dḤu-wa-wa it-ta-la-ku
 277..... ki-bi-ma te-[ir]-šú-nu-ti

(Three lines missing.)

L.E.

281..... nam-ma-la
 282..... il-li-ku it-ti-ia
 283..... ba-ku-nu-ši-im
 284..... [ul]-la(?)-nu i-na ḥu-ud li-ib-bi
 285[i-na še-me-e] an-ni-a ga-ba-šú
 286e-diš ḥarrana(?) uš-te-[zi-ik]
 287a-lik ^dGiš lu-[ul-lik a-na pa-ni-ka]

288li-lik il-ka
289li-šá-ak-lim-[ka ḫarrana]
290^dGiš ù[^dEn-ki-dū]
291mu-di-eš
292bi-ri-[su-nu]

Translation.

(About ten lines missing.)

Col. I.

11..... (my friend?)
12[Something] that is exceedingly difficult,
13[Why] dost thou desire
14[to do this?]
15.... something (?) that is very [difficult (?)],
16[Why dost thou] desire
17[to go down to the forest]?
18A message [they carried] among [men]
19They carried about.
20They made a
21..... they brought
22.....
23.....

(About 17 lines missing.)

40.....
41..... my friend

42..... they raised
43answer [they returned.]
44[To] the woman
45They proceeded to the overthrowing

Col. II.

(About eleven lines missing.)

57..... name(?)
58[The one who is] a rival [to him]
59subdue and
60Wailing
61The mother [of Gišh, who knows everything]
62Before [Shamash raised her hand]
63Who
64Now(?) [why]
65hast thou stirred up the heart for my son,
66[Restlessness imposed upon him (?)]
67.....

(About four lines missing.)

72The eyes [of Enkidu filled with tears].
73[He clutched] his heart;
74[Sadly(?)] he sighed.
75[The eyes of En]kidu filled with tears.
76[He clutched] his heart;
77[Sadly(?)] he sighed.
78The face [of Gišh was grieved].
79[He spoke] to Enkidu:
80[“My friend, why are] thy eyes

81[Filled with tears]?
82Thy [heart clutched]
83Dost thou sigh [sadly(?)]?”
84[Enkidu opened his mouth] and
85spoke to Gišh:
86“Attacks, my friend,
87have exhausted my strength(?).
88My arms are lame,
89my strength has become weak.”
90Gišh opened his mouth and
91spoke to Enkidu:

(About four lines missing.)

Col. III.

96..... [until] Huwawa, [the terrible],
97.....
98..... [I destroyed].
99[I will go down to the] cedar forest,
100..... the jungle
101..... tambourine (?)
102..... I will open it.
103Enkidu opened his mouth and
104spoke to Gišh:
105“Know, my friend, in the mountain,
106when I moved about with the cattle
107to a distance of one double hour into the heart of
the forest,
108[Alone?] I penetrated within it,
109[To] Huwawa, whose roar is a flood,
110whose mouth is fire,

111whose breath is death.
112Why dost thou desire
113To do this?
114To advance towards
115the dwelling(?) of Huwawa?”
116Giřh opened his mouth and
117[spoke to Enkidu:
118”... [the covering(?)] I will destroy.
119...[in the forest]
120.....
121.....
122To
123The dwelling [of Huwawa]
124The axe
125Thou
126I will [go down to the forest].”
127Enkidu opened his mouth and
128spoke to [Gish:]
129“When [together(?)] we go down
130To the [cedar] forest,
131whose guardian, O warrior Gish,
132a power(?) without [rest(?)],
133Huwawa, an offspring(?) of
134Adad
135He

Col. IV.

136To keep safe [the cedar forest],
137[Enlil has decreed for it] seven-fold terror.”
138Gish [opened] his mouth and

139spoke to [Enkidu]:
140“Whoever, my friend, overcomes (?) [terror(?)],
141it is well (for him) with Shamash for the length of
[his days].
142Mankind will speak of it at the gates.
143Wherever terror is to be faced,
144Thou, forsooth, art in fear of death.
145Thy prowess lacks strength.
146I will go before thee.
147Though thy mouth calls to me; “thou art afraid to
approach.”
148If I fall, I will establish my name.
149Gish, the corpse(?) of H̄uwawa, the terrible one,
150has snatched (?) from the time that
151My offspring was born in
152The lion restrained (?) thee, all of which thou
knowest.
153.....
154..... thee and
155..... open (?)
156..... like a shepherd(?)
157[When thou callest to me], thou afflictest my heart.
158I am determined
159[to enter] the cedar forest.
160I will, indeed, establish my name.
161[The work(?)], my friend, to the artisans I will
entrust.
162[Weapons(?)] let them mould before us.”
163[The work(?)] to the artisans they entrusted.
164A dwelling(?) they assigned to the workmen.
165Hatchets the masters moulded:
166Axes of 3 talents each they moulded.
167Lances the masters moulded;

168Blades(?) of 2 talents each,
169A spear of 30 mina each attached to them.
170The hilt of the lances of 30 mina in gold
171Gish and [Enki]du were equipped with 10 talents
each
172..... in Erech seven its
173..... the people heard and
174[proclaimed(?)] in the street of Erech of the plazas.
175..... Gis [brought him out(?)]
176[In the street (?)] of Erech of the plazas
177[Enkidu(?)] sat before him
178..... [thus] he spoke:
179”..... [of Erech] of the plazas
180..... [before him]

Col. V.

181Gish of whom they speak, let me see!
182whose name fills the lands.
183I will lure him to the cedar forest,
184Like a strong offspring of Erech.
185I will let the land hear (that)
186I am determined to lure (him) in the cedar (forest)⁵.
187A name I will establish.”
188The elders of Erech of the plazas
189brought word to Gish:
190“Thou art young, O Gish, and thy heart carries thee
away.
191Thou dost not know what thou proposest to do.
192We hear that Huwawa is enraged.
193Who has ever opposed his weapon?

194To one [double hour] in the heart of the forest,
195Who has ever penetrated into it?
196Huwawa, whose roar is a deluge,
197whose mouth is fire, whose breath is death.
198Why dost thou desire to do this?
199To advance towards the dwelling (?) of Huwawa?”
200Gish heard the report of his counsellors.
201He saw and cried out to [his] friend:
202“Now, my friend, thus [I speak].
203I fear him, but [I will go to the cedar forest(?)];
204I will go [with thee to the cedar forest].

(About five lines missing.)

210.....
211May thee
212Thy god may (?) thee;
213On the road may he guide [thee in safety(?)].
214At the rampart of [Erech of the plazas],
215Gish kneeled down [before Shamash(?)],
216A word then he spoke [to him]:
217“I will go, O Shamash, [thy] hands [I seize hold of].
218When I shall have saved [my life],
219Bring me back to the rampart [in Erech].
220Grant protection [to me ?]!”
221Gish cried, ”[my friend]
222His oracle
223.....
224.....
225.....
226When (?)

(About two lines missing.)

Col. VI.

229”[I(?)] Gish, the strong one (?) of the land.
230..... A road which I have never [trodden];
231..... food do not (?) know.
232[When] I shall have succeeded,
233[I will praise] thee in the joy of my heart,
234[I will extol (?)] the superiority of thy power,
235[I will seat thee] on thrones.”
236..... his vessel(?)
237The masters [brought the weapons (?)];
238[bow] and quiver
239They placed in hand.
240[He took] the hatchet.
241..... his quiver.
242..... [to] the god(?) a second time
243[With his lance(?)] in his girdle,
244..... they took the road.
245[Again] they approached Gish!
246”[How long] till thou returnest to Erech?”
247[Again the elders] approached him.
248[For] the road they counselled Gis:
249“Do [not] rely, O Gish, on thy strength!
250Provide food and save thyself!
251Let Enkidu go before thee.
252He is acquainted with the way, he has trodden the
road
253[to] the entrance of the forest.
254of H̄uwawa all of them his
255[He who goes] in advance will save the companion.
256Provide for his [road] and [save thyself]!

257(May) Shamash [carry out] thy endeavor!
258May he make thy eyes see the prophecy of thy
mouth.
259May he track out (for thee) the closed path!
260May he level the road for thy treading!
261May he level the mountain for thy foot!
262During thy night⁶ the word that wilt rejoice
263may Lugal-banda convey, and stand by thee
264in thy endeavor!
265Like a youth may he establish thy endeavor!
266In the river of H̄uwawa as thou plannest,
267wash thy feet!
268Round about thee dig a well!
269May there be pure water constantly for thy libation
270Goblets of water pour out to Shamash!
271[May] Lugal-banda take note of it!”
272[Enkidu] opened his mouth and spoke to Gish:
273”[Since thou art resolved] to take the road.
274Thy heart [be not afraid,] trust to me!
275[Confide] to my hand his dwelling(?)!”
276[on the road to] H̄uwawa they proceeded.
277..... command their return

(Three lines missing.)

L.E.

281..... were filled.
282..... they will go with me.
283.....
284..... joyfully.
285[Upon hearing] this word of his,

286Alone, the road(?) [he levelled].
287“Go, O Gish [I will go before thee(?)].
288May thy god(?) go
289May he show [thee the road !]
290Gish and [Enkidu]
291Knowingly
292Between [them]

[Lines 13](#)–14 (also [line 16](#)). See for the restoration, [lines 112](#)–13.

[Line 62](#). For the restoration, see Jensen, p. 146 (Tablet III, 2^a,9.)

[Lines 64](#)–66. Restored on the basis of the Assyrian version, *ib.* line 10.

[Line 72](#). Cf. Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 4, 10, and restore at the end of this line *di-im-tam* as in our text, instead of Jensen’s conjecture.

[Lines 74](#), [77](#) and [83](#). The restoration *zar-biš*, suggested by the Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 4, 4.

[Lines 76](#) and [82](#). Cf. Assyrian version, Tablet VIII, 3, 18.

[Line 78](#). (*ú-ta-ab-bil* from *abâlu*, “grieve” or “darkened.” Cf. *uš-ta-kal* (Assyrian version, *ib.* line 9), where, perhaps, we are to restore *it-ta-[bil pa-ni-šú]*).

[Line 87](#). *uš-ta-li-pa* from *elêpu*, “exhaust.” See Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, p. 49a.

[Line 89](#). Cf. Assyrian version, *ib.* line 11, and restore the end of the line there to *i-ni-iš*, as in our text.

[Line 96](#). For *dapinu* as an epithet of *Ḫuwawa*, see Assyrian version, Tablet III, 2a, 17, and 3a, 12. *Dapinu* occurs also as a description of an ox (Rm 618, Bezold, *Catalogue of the Kouyunjik Tablets*, etc., p. 1627).

[Line 98](#). The restoration on the basis of *ib.* III, 2a, 18.

[Lines 96](#)–98 may possibly form a parallel to *ib.* lines 17–18, which would then read about as follows: “Until I overcome ̕uwawa, the terrible, and all the evil in the land I shall have destroyed.” At the same time, it is possible that we are to restore *[lu-ul]-li-ik* at the end of line 98.

[Line 101](#). *lilissu* occurs in the Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 6, 36.

[Line 100](#). For *̕albu*, “jungle,” see Assyrian version, Tablet V, 3, 39 (p. 160).

[Lines 109](#)–111. These lines enable us properly to restore Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 5, 3 = Haupt’s edition, p. 83 (col. 5, 3). No doubt the text read as ours *mu-tum* (or *mu-u-tum*) *na-pis-su*.

[Line 115](#). *šupatu*, which occurs again in line 199 and also line 275. *šú-pa-as-su* (= *šupat-su*) must have some such meaning as “dwelling,” demanded by the context. [Dhorme refers me to *OLZ* 1916, p. 145].

[Line 129](#). Restored on the basis of the Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 6, 38.

[Line 131](#). The restoration *muktablu*, tentatively suggested on the basis of CT XVIII, 30, 7b, where *muktablu*, “warrior,” appears as one of the designations of Gilgamesh, followed by *a-lik pa-na*, “the one who goes in advance,” or “leader”—the phrase so constantly used in the ̕uwawa episode.

[Line 132](#). Cf. Assyrian version, Tablet I, 5, 18–19.

[Lines 136](#)–137. These two lines restored on the basis of Jensen IV, 5, 2 and 5. The variant in the Assyrian version, *šá niše* (written *Uku^{meš}* in one case and *Lu^{meš}* in the other), for the numeral 7 in our text to designate a terror of the largest and most widespread character, is interesting. The number 7 is similarly used as a designation of Gilgamesh, who is called *Esigga imin*, “seven-fold strong,” i.e., supremely strong (CT XVIII, 30, 6–8). Similarly, Enkidu, *ib.* line 10, is designated *a-rá imina*, “seven-fold.”

[Line 149](#). A difficult line because of the uncertainty of the reading at the beginning of the following line. The most obvious meaning of *mi-it-tu* is “corpse,” though in the Assyrian version *šalamtu* is used (Assyrian version, Tablet V, 2, 42). On the other hand, it is possible—as Dr. Lutz suggested to me—that *mittu*, despite the manner of writing, is identical with *miṭṭú*, the name of a divine weapon, well-known from the Assyrian creation myth (Tablet IV, 130), and other passages. The combination *miṭ-tu šá-ku-ú-*, “lofty weapon,” in the Bilingual text IV, R², 18 No. 3, 31–32, would favor the meaning “weapon” in our passage, since *[šá]-ku-tu* is a possible restoration at the beginning of line 150. However, the writing *mi-it-ti* points too distinctly to a derivative of the stem *mātu*, and until a satisfactory explanation of lines 150–152 is forthcoming, we must stick to the meaning “corpse” and read the verb *il-ku-ut*.

[Line 152](#). The context suggests “lion” for the puzzling *la-bu*.

[Line 156](#). Another puzzling line. Dr. Clay’s copy is an accurate reproduction of what is distinguishable. At the close of the line there appears to be a sign written over an erasure.

[Line 158](#). *[ga-ti lu-]uš-kun* as in [line 186](#), literally, “I will place my hand,” i.e., I purpose, I am determined.

[Line 160](#). The restoration on the basis of the parallel [line 187](#). Note the interesting phrase, “writing a name” in the sense of acquiring “fame.”

[Line 161](#). The *kiškattê*, “artisans,” are introduced also in the Assyrian version, Tablet VI, 187, to look at the enormous size and weight of the horns of the slain divine bull. See for other passages Muss-Arnolt *Assyrian Dictionary*, p. 450^b. At the beginning of this line, we must seek for the same word as in line 163.

[Line 162](#). While the restoration *belê*, “weapon,” is purely conjectural, the context clearly demands some such word. I choose *belê* in preference to *kakkê*, in view of the Assyrian version, Tablet VI, 1.

[Line 163](#). *Putuku* (or *putukku*) from *patâku* would be an appropriate word for the fabrication of weapons.

[Line 165](#). The *rabûtim* here, as in [line 167](#), I take as the “master mechanics” as contrasted with the *ummianu*, “common workmen,” or journeymen. A parallel to this forging of the weapons for the two heroes is to be found in the Sumerian fragment of the Gilgamesh Epic published by Langdon, *Historical and Religious Texts from the Temple Library of Nippur* (Munich, 1914), No. 55, 1–15.

[Lines 168](#)–170 describe the forging of the various parts of the lances for the two heroes. The *šipru* is the spear point Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, p. 886^b; the *išid paṭri* is clearly the “hilt,” and the *mešelitum* I therefore take as the “blade” proper. The word occurs here for the first time, so far as I can see. For 30 minas, see Assyrian version, Tablet VI, 189, as the weight of the two horns of the divine bull. Each axe weighing 3 *biltu*, and the lance with point and hilt 3 *biltu* we would have to assume 4 *biltu* for each *pašu*, so as to get a total of 10 *biltu* as the weight of the weapons for each hero. The lance is depicted on seal cylinders representing Gilgamesh and Enkidu, for example, Ward, *Seal Cylinders*, No. 199, and also in Nos. 184 and 191 in the field, with the broad hilt; and in an enlarged form in No. 648. Note the clear indication of the hilt. The two figures are Gilgamesh and Enkidu—not two Gilgameshes, as Ward assumed. See above, page 34. A different weapon is the club or mace, as seen in Ward, Nos. 170 and 173. This appears also to be the weapon which Gilgamesh holds in his hand on the colossal figure from the palace of Sargon (Jastrow, *Civilization of Babylonia and Assyria*, Pl. LVII), though it has been given a somewhat grotesque character by a perhaps intentional approach to the scimitar, associated with Marduk (see Ward, *Seal Cylinders*, Chap. XXVII). The exact determination of the various weapons depicted on seal-cylinders merits a special study.

[Line 181](#). Begins a speech of Huwawa, extending to [line 187](#), reported to Gish by the elders (line 188–189), who add a further warning to the youthful and impetuous hero.

[Line 183](#). *lu-uk-šú-su* (also [l. 186](#)), from *akâšu*, “drive on” or “lure on,” occurs on the Pennsylvania tablet, line 135, *uk-ki-ši*, “lure on” or “entrap,” which Langdon erroneously renders “take away” and thereby misses the point completely. See the comment to the line of the Pennsylvania tablet in question.

[Line 192](#). On the phrase *šanû bunu*, “change of countenance,” in the sense of “enraged,” see the note to the Pennsylvania tablet, l.31.

[Line 194](#). *nu-ma-at* occurs in a tablet published by Meissner, *Altbabyl. Privatrecht*, No. 100, with *bît abi*, which shows that the total confine of a property is meant; here, therefore, the “interior” of the forest or heart. It is hardly a “by-form” of *nuptum* as Muss-Arnolt, *Assyrian Dictionary*, p. 690^b, and others have supposed, though *nu-um-tum* in one passage quoted by Muss-Arnolt, *ib.* p. 705^a, may have arisen from an aspirate pronunciation of the *p* in *nubtum*.

[Line 215](#). The kneeling attitude of prayer is an interesting touch. It symbolizes submission, as is shown by the description of Gilgamesh’s defeat in the encounter with Enkidu (Pennsylvania tablet, l. 227), where Gilgamesh is represented as forced to “kneel” to the ground. Again in the Assyrian version, Tablet V, 4, 6, Gilgamesh kneels down (though the reading *ka-mis* is not certain) and has a vision.

[Line 229](#). It is much to be regretted that this line is so badly preserved, for it would have enabled us definitely to restore the opening line of the Assyrian version of the Gilgamesh Epic. The fragment published by Jeremias in his appendix to his *Izdubar-Nimrod*, Plate IV, gives us the end of the colophon line to the Epic, reading *di ma-a-ti* (cf. *ib.*, Pl. I, 1. ... *a-ti*). Our text evidently reproduces the same phrase and enables us to supply *ka*, as well as the name of the hero Gišh of which there are distinct traces. The missing word, therefore, describes the hero as the ruler, or controller of the land. But what are the two signs before *ka*? A participial form from *pakâdu*, which one naturally thinks of, is impossible because of the *ka*, and for the same reason one cannot supply the word for shepherd (*nakidu*). One might think of *ka-ak-ka-du*, except that *kakkadu* is not used for “head” in the sense of

“chief” of the land. I venture to restore *[i-ik-]ka-di*, “strong one.” Our text at all events disposes of Haupt’s conjecture *iš-di ma-a-ti* (JAOS 22, p. 11), “Bottom of the earth,” as also of Ungnad’s proposed *[a-di pa]-a-ti*, “to the ends” (Ungnad-Gressmann, *Gilgamesch-Epos*, p. 6, note), or a reading *di-ma-a-ti*, “pillars.” The first line of the Assyrian version would now read

šá nak-ba i-mu-ru [^dGis-gi(n)-maš i-ik-ka]-di ma-a-ti,

i.e., “The one who saw everything, Gilgamesh the strong one (?) of the land.”

We may at all events be quite certain that the name of the hero occurred in the first line and that he was described by some epithet indicating his superior position.

[Lines 229](#)–235 are again an address of Gilgamesh to the sun-god, after having received a favorable “oracle” from the god (line 222). The hero promises to honor and to celebrate the god, by erecting thrones for him.

[Lines 237](#)–244 describe the arming of the hero by the “master” craftsman. In addition to the *pašu* and *paṭru*, the bow (?) and quiver are given to him.

[Line 249](#) is paralleled in the new fragment of the Assyrian version published by King in *PSBA* 1914, page 66 (col. 1, 2), except that this fragment adds *gi-mir* to *e-mu-ki-ka*.

[Lines 251](#)–252 correspond to column 1, 6–8, of King’s fragment, with interesting variations “battle” and “fight” instead of “way” and “road,” which show that in the interval between the old Babylonian and the Assyrian version, the real reason why Enkidu should lead the way, namely, because he knows the country in which Huwawa dwells (lines 252–253), was supplemented by describing Enkidu also as being more experienced in battle than Gilgamesh.

[Line 254](#). I am unable to furnish a satisfactory rendering for this line, owing to the uncertainty of the word at the end. Can it be “his household,” from the stem which in Hebrew gives us מִשְׁפָּחָה “family?”

[Line 255](#). Is paralleled by col. 1, 4, of King's new fragment. The episode of Gišh and Enkidu proceeding to Ninsun, the mother of Gish, to obtain her counsel, which follows in King's fragment, appears to have been omitted in the old Babylonian version. Such an elaboration of the tale is exactly what we should expect as it passed down the ages.

[Line 257](#). Our text shows that *irnittu* (lines 257, 264, 265) means primarily "endeavor," and then success in one's endeavor, or "triumph."

[Lines 266](#)–270. Do not appear to refer to rites performed after a victory, as might at a first glance appear, but merely voice the hope that Gišh will completely take possession of Ħuwawa's territory, so as to wash up after the fight in Ħuwawa's own stream; and the hope is also expressed that he may find pure water in Ħuwawa's land in abundance, to offer a libation to Šhamašh.

[Line 275](#). On šú-pa-as-su = šupat-su, see above, to l. 115.

[Note on Sabitum (above, [p. 11](#))

In a communication before the Oriental Club of Philadelphia (Feb. 10, 1920), Prof. Haupt made the suggestion that *sa-bi-tum* (or *tu*), hitherto regarded as a proper name, is an epithet describing the woman who dwells at the seashore which Gilgamesh in the course of his wanderings reaches, as an "innkeeper". It is noticeable that the term always appears without the determinative placed before proper names; and since in the old Babylonian version (so far as preserved) and in the Assyrian version, the determinative is invariably used, its consistent absence in the case of *sabitum* (Assyrian Version, Tablet X, 1, 1, 10, 15, 20; 2, 15–16 [*sa-bit*]; Meissner fragment col. 2, 11–12) speaks in favor of Professor Haupt's suggestion. The meaning "innkeeper", while not as yet found in Babylonian-Assyrian literature is most plausible, since we have *sabū* as a general name for 'drink', though originally designating perhaps more specifically sesame wine (Muss-Arnolt, Assyrian Dictionary, p. 745^b) or distilled brandy, according to Prof. Haupt. Similarly, in the Aramaic dialects, *s^eb^ha* is used for "to drink" and in the Pael to "furnish drink". Muss-Arnolt in his Assyrian Dictionary, 746^b,

has also recognized that *sabitum* was originally an epithet and compares the Aramaic *s^eb^hoyâthâ*(p1) “barmaids”. In view of the bad reputation of inns in ancient Babylonia as brothels, it would be natural for an epithet like *sabitum* to become the equivalent to “public” women, just as the inn was a “public” house. *Sabitum* would, therefore, have the same force as *šamḫatu* (the “harlot”), used in the Gilgamesh Epic by the side of *ḫarimtu* “woman” (see the note to line 46 of Pennsylvania Tablet). The Sumerian term for the female innkeeper is *Sal Geštinna* “the woman of the wine,” known to us from the Hammurabi Code §§108–111. The bad reputation of inns is confirmed by these statutes, for the house of the *Sal Geštinna* is a gathering place for outlaws. The punishment of a female devotee who enters the “house of a wine woman” (*bît Sal Geštinna* §110) is death. It was not “prohibition” that prompted so severe a punishment, but the recognition of the purpose for which a devotee would enter such a house of ill repute. The speech of the *sabitum* or innkeeper to Gilgamesh (above, [p. 12](#)) was, therefore, an invitation to stay with her, instead of seeking for life elsewhere. Viewed as coming from a “public woman” the address becomes significant. The invitation would be parallel to the temptation offered by the *ḫarimtu* in the first tablet of the Enkidu, and to which Enkidu succumbs. The incident in the tablet would, therefore, form a parallel in the adventures of Gilgamesh to the one that originally belonged to the Enkidu cycle. Finally, it is quite possible that *sabitum* is actually the Akkadian equivalent of the Sumerian *Sal Geštinna*, though naturally until this equation is confirmed by a syllabary or by other direct evidence, it remains a conjecture. See now also Albright’s remarks on *Sabitum* in the A. J. S. L. 36, pp. 269 *seq.*]

1 Scribal error for *an*.

2 Text apparently *di*.

3 Hardly *ul*.

4 Omitted by scribe.

5 *Kišiti* omitted by scribe.

6 I.e., at night to thee, may Lugal-banda, etc.

Corrections to the Text of Langdon's Edition of the Pennsylvania Tablet.¹

Column 1.

5. Read *it-lu-tim* (“heroes”) instead of *id-da-tim* (“omens”).
6. Read *ka-ka-bu* instead of *ka-ka-'a*. This disposes of Langdon's note 2 on p. 211.
- 9 Read *ú-ni-iš-šú-ma*, “I became weak” (from *enêšu*, “weak”) instead of *ilam iš-šú-ma*, “He bore a net”(!). This disposes of Langdon's note 5 on page 211.
10. Read *Uruk^{ki}* instead of *ad-ki*. Langdon's note 7 is wrong.
12. Langdon's note 8 is wrong. *ú-um-mid-ma pu-ti* does not mean “he attained my front.”
14. Read *ab-ba-la-áš-šú* instead of *at-ba-la-áš-šú*.
15. Read *mu-di-a-at* instead of *mu-u-da-a-at*.
20. Read *ta-ḫa-du* instead of an impossible *[sa]-ah-ḫa-ta*—two mistakes in one word. Supply *kima Sal* before *taḫadu*.
22. Read *áš-šú* instead of *šú*; and at the end of the line read *[tu-ut]-tu-ú-ma* instead of *šú-ú-zu*.
23. Read *ta-tar-ra-[as-su]*.

24. Read *[uš]-ti-nim-ma* instead of *[iš]-ti-lam-ma*.
28. Read at the beginning *šá* instead of *ina*.
29. Langdon's text and transliteration of the first word do not tally. Read *ḥa-aš-ši-nu*, just as in line 31.
32. Read *aḥ-ta-du* ("I rejoiced") instead of *aḥ-ta-ta*.

Column 2.

4. Read at the end of the line *di-da-šá(?) ip-tí-[e]* instead of *Di-?-al-lu-un* (!).
5. Supply ^d*En-ki-dū* at the beginning. Traces point to this reading.
19. Read *[gi]-it-ma-[lu]* after ^d*Giš*, as suggested by the Assyrian version, Tablet I, 4, 38, where *emûku* ("strength") replaces *nepištu* of our text.
20. Read *at-[ta kima Sal ta-ḥa]-bu-[ub]-šú*.
21. Read *ta-[ra-am-šú ki-ma]*.
23. Read as one word *ma-a-ag-ri-i-im* ("accursed"), spelled in characteristic Hammurabi fashion, instead of dividing into two words *ma-a-ak* and *ri-i-im*, as Langdon does, who suggests as a translation "unto the place yonder(?) of the shepherd"(!).
24. Read *im-ta-ḥar* instead of *im-ta-gar*.
32. Supply *ili(?)* after *ki-ma*.
33. Read *šá-ri-i-im* as one word.
35. Read *i-na [áš]-ri-šú [im]-ḥu-ru*.

36. Traces at beginning point to either *ù* or *ki* (= *itti*). Restoration of lines 36–39 (perhaps to be distributed into five lines) on the basis of the Assyrian version, Tablet I, 4, 2–5.

Column 3.

14. Read *Kàš* (= *šikaram*, “wine”) *ši-ti*, “drink,” as in line 17, instead of *bi-iš-ti*, which leads Langdon to render this perfectly simple line “of the conditions and the fate of the land”(!).

21. Read *it-tam-ru* instead of *it-ta-bir-ru*.

22. Supply [*lùšú*]-*I*.

29. Read *ú-gi-ir-ri* from *garû* (“attack”), instead of separating into *ú* and *gi-ir-ri*, as Langdon does, who translates “and the lion.” The sign used can never stand for the copula! Nor is *girru*, “lion!”

30. Read *Síb^{meš}*, “shepherds,” instead of *šab-[ši]-eš*!

31. *šib-ba-ri* is not “mountain goat,” nor can *ut-tap-pi-iš* mean “capture.” The first word means “dagger,” and the second “he drew out.”

33. Read *it-ti-[lu] na-ki-[di-e]*, instead of *itti immer nakie* which yields no sense. Langdon’s rendering, even on the basis of his reading of the line, is a grammatical monstrosity.

35. Read *giš* instead of *wa*.

37. Read perhaps *a-na [na-ki-di-e i]- za-ak-ki-ir*.

Column 4.

4. The first sign is clearly *iz*, not *ta*, as Langdon has it in note 1 on page 216.

9. The fourth sign is *su*, not *šú*.

10. Separate *e-eš* (“why”) from the following. Read *ta-ḫi-[il]*, followed, perhaps, by *la*. The last sign is not certain; it may be *ma*.

11. Read *lim-nu* instead of *mi-nu*. In the same line read *a-la-ku ma-na-aḫ-[ti]-ka* instead of *a-la-ku-zu(!) na-aḫ ... ma*, which, naturally, Langdon cannot translate.

16. Read *e-lu-tim* instead of *pa-a-ta-tim*. The first sign of the line, *tu*, is not certain, because apparently written over an erasure. The second sign may be *a*. Some one has scratched the tablet at this point.

18. Read *uk-la-at âli (?)* instead of *ug-ad-ad-lil*, which gives no possible sense!

Column 5.

2. Read *[wa]-ar-ki-šú*.

8. Read *i-ta-wa-a* instead of *i-ta-me-a*. The word *pi-it-tam* belongs to line 9! The sign *pi* is unmistakable. This disposes of note 1 on p. 218.

9. Read *Mi = šalmu*, “image.” This disposes of Langdon’s note 2 on page 218. Of six notes on this page, four are wrong.

11. The first sign appears to be *si* and the second *ma*. At the end we are perhaps to supply *[šá-ki-i pu]-uk-ku-ul*, on the basis of the Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 2, 45, *šá-ki-i pu-[uk-ku-ul]*.

12. Traces at end of line suggest *i-pa(?) -ka-du*.

13. Read *i-[na mâti da-an e-mu]-ki i-wa*.
18. Read *ur-šá-nu* instead of *ip-šá-nu*.
19. Read *i-šá-ru* instead of *i-tu-ru*.
24. The reading *it-ti* after ^d*Giš* is suggested by the traces.
25. Read *in-ni-[ib-bi-it]* at the end of the line.
28. Read *ip-ta-ra-[aš a-la]-ak-tam* at the end of the line, as in the Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 2, 37.
30. The conjectural restoration is based on the Assyrian version, Tablet IV, 2, 36.

Column 6.

3. Read *i-na ši-ri-[šú]*.
5. Supply *[il-li-ik]*.
21. Langdon's text has a superfluous *ga*.
22. Read *uz-za-šú*, "his anger," instead of *uš-ša-šú*, "his javelin" (!).
23. Read *i-ni-iḫ i-ra-as-su*, i.e., "his breast was quieted," in the sense of "his anger was appeased."
31. Read *ri-eš-ka* instead of *ri-eš-su*.

In general, it should be noted that the indications of the number of lines missing at the bottom of columns 1–3 and at the top of columns 4–6 as given by Langdon are misleading. Nor should he have drawn any lines at the bottom of columns 1–3 as though the tablet were complete. Besides in very many cases the space indications of what is missing within a line are

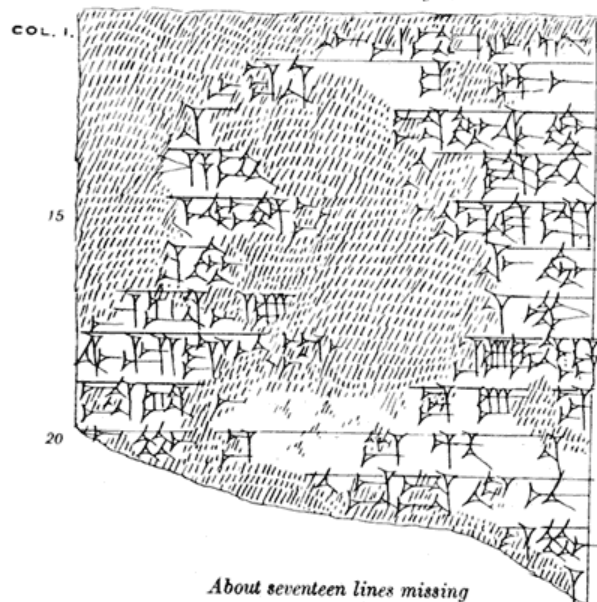
inaccurate. Dr. Langdon also omitted to copy the statement on the edge: 4 šú-ši, i.e., “240 lines;” and in the colophon he mistranslates šú-tu-ur, “written,” as though from šaṭâru, “write,” whereas the form is the permansive III, 1, of atâru, “to be in excess of.” The sign *tu* never has the value *tu*! In all, Langdon has misread the text or mistransliterated it in over forty places, and of the 204 preserved lines he has mistranslated about one-half.

¹ The enumeration here is according to Langdon’s edition.

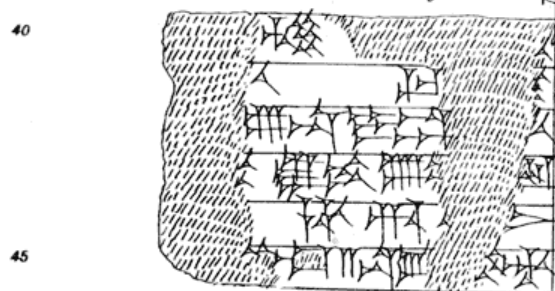
Plates

Plate I.

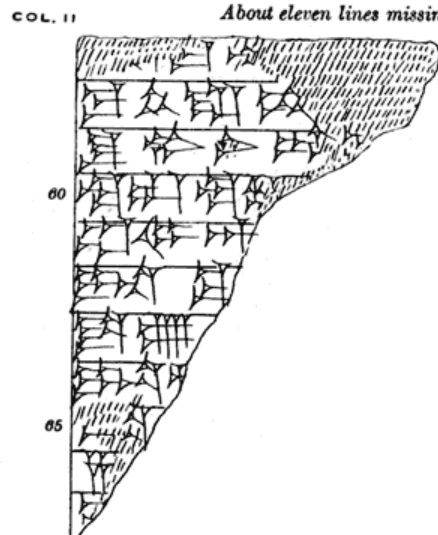
About ten lines missing



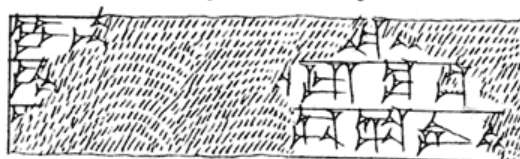
About seventeen lines missing



About eleven lines missing

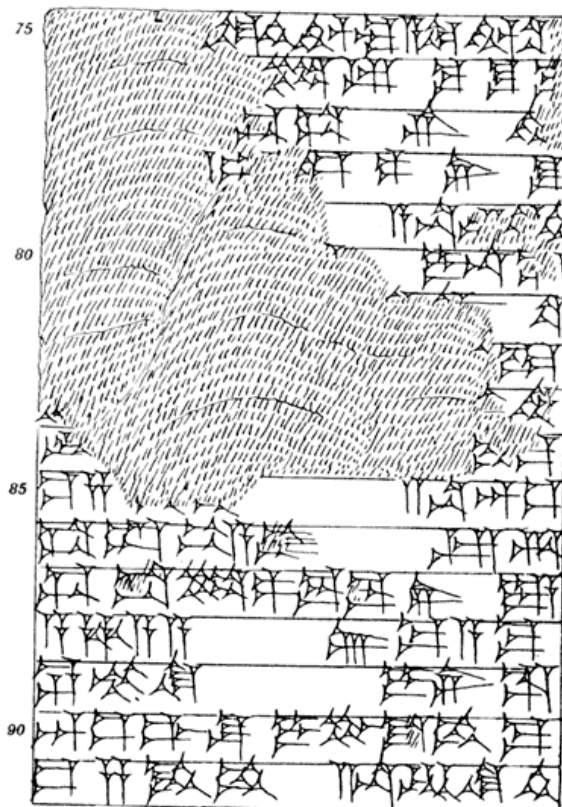


About four lines missing

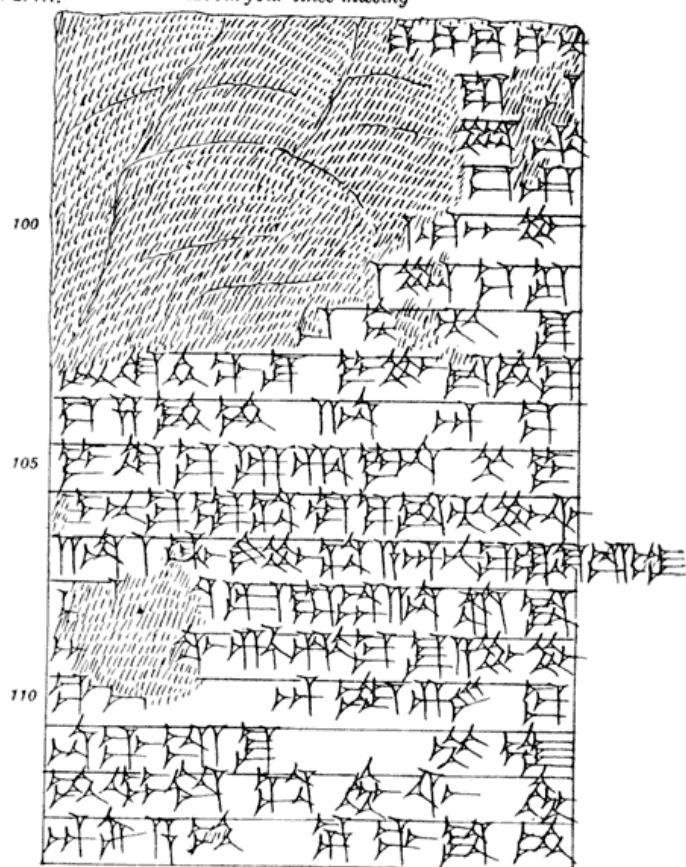


The Yale Tablet.

Plate II.



COL. III. *About four lines missing*



The Yale Tablet.

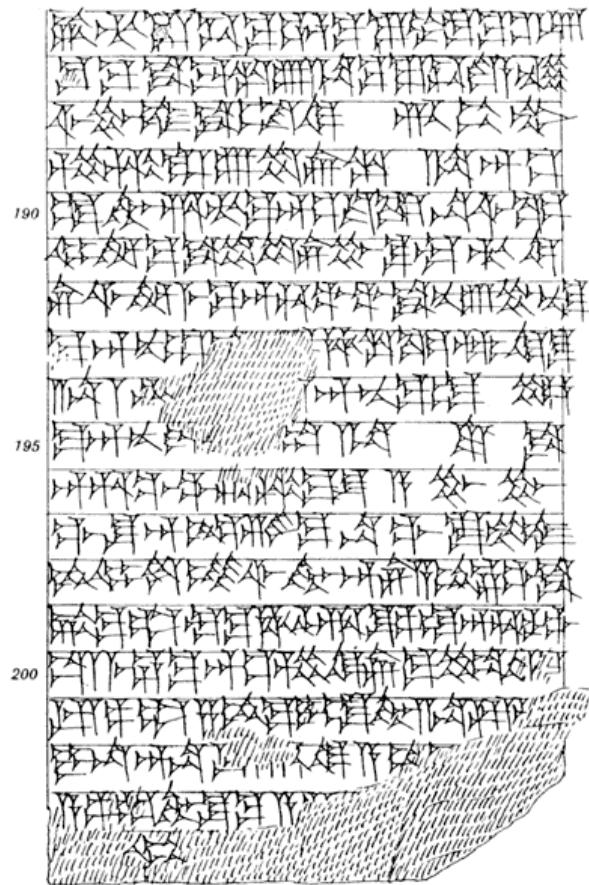
Plate III.

The Yale Tablet.

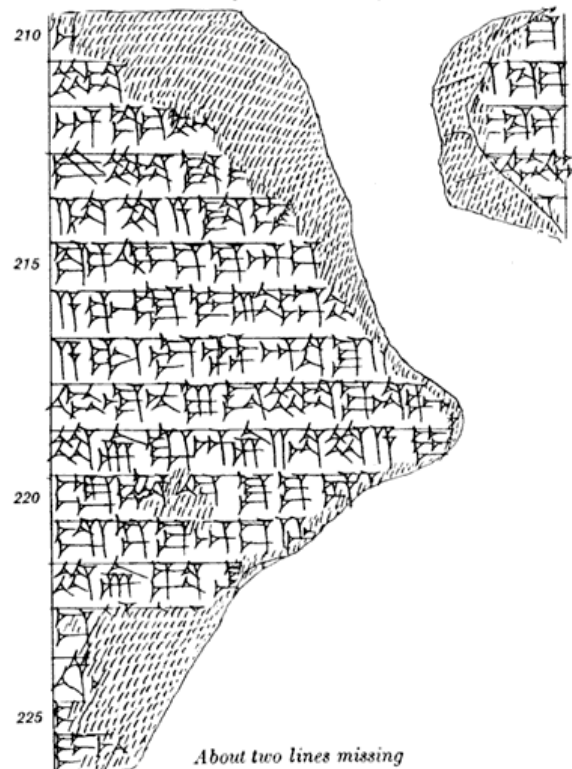
Plate IV.

The Yale Tablet.

Plate V.



About five lines missing



About two lines missing

The Yale Tablet.

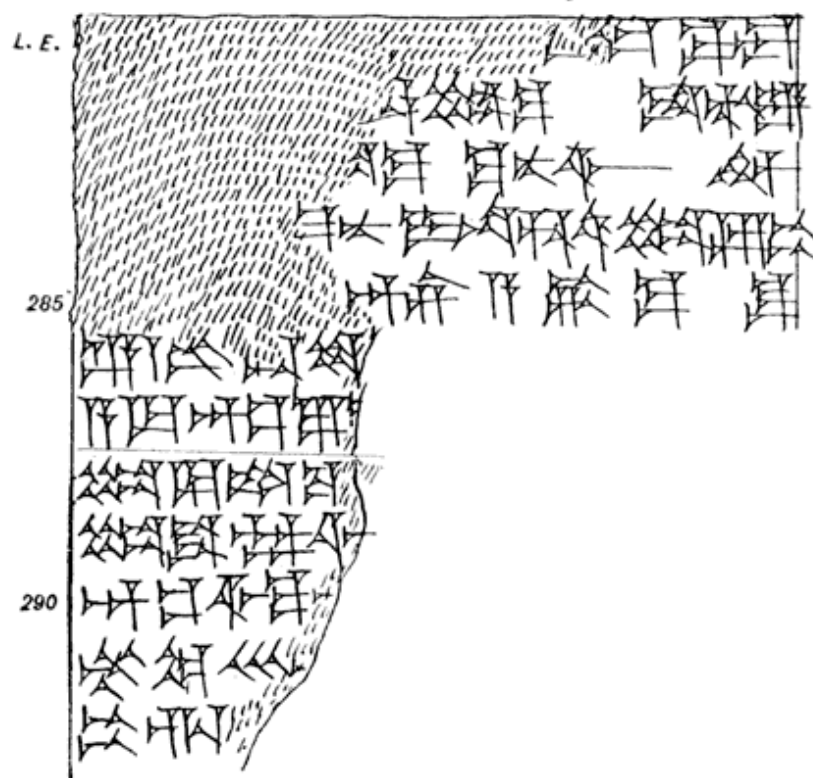
Plate VI.

The Yale Tablet.

Plate VII.



About three lines missing



The Yale Tablet.

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